

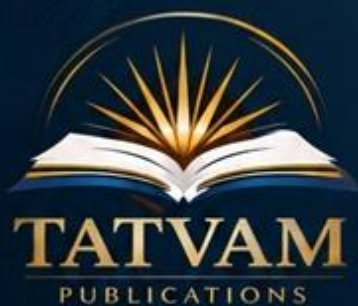


CONTEMPORARY RESEARCH PERSPECTIVES *in* COMMERCE

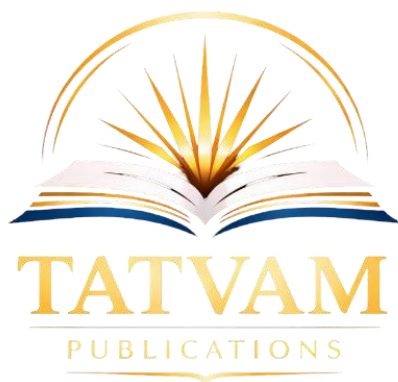


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◆ Dr. Lakde Sheetal Deobaji



Contemporary Research Perspectives in Commerce



Tatvam Publications, Pune

Edited By:

Dr. Lakde Sheetal Deobaji

**Sarhad College of Arts, Commerce and Science, Katraj,
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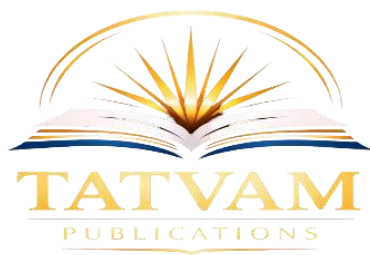
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Preface

Contemporary Research Perspectives in Commerce is a collective academic effort that brings together research chapters written by the Undergraduate (UG) and Postgraduate (PG) students of the Department of Commerce of Sarhad College of Arts, Commerce and Science. The book reflects the students' research aptitude, analytical thinking, and understanding of contemporary issues in commerce and management.

The objective of this publication is to promote a research culture among students and provide a platform to showcase their academic work. In today's rapidly changing business environment, research has become essential for understanding emerging trends, challenges, and opportunities in the field of commerce.

This book covers diverse areas such as accounting, finance, banking, marketing, entrepreneurship, digital business, human resource management, and other contemporary topics. The research works included in this volume offer valuable insights and practical perspectives on current business, Taxation, Banking and economic issues.

It is expected that this publication will enhance students' research skills, encourage academic inquiry, and serve as a useful reference for learners, researchers, and academicians. The book also aims to inspire future research and contribute to the advancement of knowledge in the field of commerce.

We appreciate the efforts of all student authors, faculty mentors, and contributors who made this publication possible. We hope this volume will motivate young researchers to continue exploring new dimensions of commerce and management

Editors

Dr.Lakde Sheetal Deobaji

Acknowledgement

The successful completion of this edited volume, Contemporary Research Perspectives in Commerce, would not have been possible without the support, encouragement, and cooperation of many individuals and the entire Sarhad College family. This publication is the outcome of collective efforts, academic commitment, and a shared vision of promoting research culture among students and faculty members.

We express our sincere appreciation to the Undergraduate (UG) and Postgraduate (PG) students of the Department of Commerce, Sarhad College of Arts, Commerce and Science, whose research contributions form the foundation of this edited book, “Contemporary Research Perspectives in Commerce.” Their enthusiasm, dedication, and commitment to academic research have enriched this volume with diverse and contemporary perspectives in the field of commerce.

We take this opportunity to convey our heartfelt gratitude to Sanjay Nahar, President, for his visionary leadership, constant encouragement, and unwavering support in promoting academic excellence and research culture within the institution.

We extend our sincere thanks to Sushma Nahar, Secretary, for her continuous motivation and valuable administrative support in facilitating academic and research activities.

We are also grateful to Mr. Shalish Wadekar, Trustee Sarhad of organization, Mr. Anuj Nahar, Trustee of Sarhad organization and Dr. Sangeeta Shinde Principal of Sarhad College for their encouragement and support in creating an environment that nurtures research, innovation, and academic growth among students and faculty members.

We express our gratitude to all faculty mentors, reviewers, and the publishing team for their guidance, valuable suggestions, and dedicated efforts throughout the editing and publication process. Their contributions have played a significant role in enhancing the quality of this book.

Finally, we extend our heartfelt thanks to our families, colleagues, and well-wishers for their patience, encouragement, and unwavering support during the preparation of this volume.

We sincerely hope that “Contemporary Research Perspectives in Commerce” will serve as a valuable academic resource and inspire students, researchers, and academicians to pursue meaningful research and contribute to the advancement of knowledge in the field of commerce.

Editor: Dr. Sheetal Deobaji Lakde

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IMPACT OF GREEN MARKETING ON CONSUMERS

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Abstract:

The study examines how green marketing influences what people know, how they think, and how they make purchasing decisions. It also looks at the difficulties companies face when trying to become more eco-friendly. As people become more aware of environmental issues, businesses have started using practices like recyclable packaging, sustainable sourcing, and energy saving methods in their marketing plans. This research checks how well consumers understand green marketing, how much these practices affect their buying choices, and how they help promote sustainable habits. The study also points out the challenges organizations face that stop them from properly carrying out green practices. The results are expected to offer understanding on how green marketing helps shape consumer choices, increase environmental care, and help businesses move toward more sustainable strategies.

Key Words: Green Marketing, consumer behavior, Awareness

Introduction

These days, people are more worried about the environment and are more aware of how their choices affect the planet. Because of this, many businesses are changing how they market their products and services. They are now focusing on being eco-friendly, which is called green marketing. This type of marketing highlights how a product or service helps the environment, like using less carbon, having packaging that can be recycled, getting materials in a sustainable way, and making things with less energy.

As more people care about environmental issues, they are making buying decisions based on how eco-friendly the products are. This change in how customers think has made companies use green marketing as a key part of their business plans. But even though many businesses are trying this approach, there's still a lot to learn about how effective it is in changing what customers buy and how they think about sustainability. This study looks into how green marketing influences what people choose to buy and how it can help create more sustainable habits.

Problem Statement

Even though more companies are using green marketing to sell environmentally friendly products, many consumers don't really understand it or act in a consistent way when buying. This study looks into how green marketing affects people's opinions and their choices when making purchases.

Purpose of study

The purpose of this study is to examine how green marketing influences consumer behaviour and awareness while identifying the challenges businesses face in adopting sustainable practices.

Objectives of the Study

1. To understand the concept and scope of green marketing.
2. To examine consumer awareness and perception regarding eco-friendly products.
3. To analyze the impact of green marketing strategies on consumer buying behavior.

Hypothesis

- **H1:** A significant proportion of consumers possess a clear understanding of the concept and scope of green marketing.
- **H0:** Consumers do not possess a clear understanding of the concept and scope of green marketing.
- **H2:** There is a positive relationship between consumer awareness of eco-friendly products and their perception of green marketing.
- **H0:** There is no significant relationship between consumer awareness of eco-friendly products and their perception of green marketing.

Review of literature

1. Premi, Sharma & Dangayach (2021): Conducted a systematic review of green marketing literature in India and found that consumer awareness and eco-labels play a strong role in shaping purchase decisions.
2. Milan, Juhi & Chellasamy (2021): Their survey revealed that while Indian consumers show concern for the environment, actual purchase of green products is limited due to high costs and lack of trust.

3. Dixit & Singh (2024): Studied personal care and cosmetic products in Uttar Pradesh and concluded that eco-friendly packaging and labelling strongly influence consumer buying, but price remains a major barrier.

4. Kumar et al. (2024): Found that green marketing strategies, especially brand transparency and eco-friendly advertising, significantly improve consumer trust and sustainable brand image in India.

Research methodology Research Design

This study uses a descriptive research design to look into how consumers are aware of, think about, and buy products related to green marketing. This type of design is good because it gives a clear, factual picture of what people think without changing anything in the study.

Sample Size and Sampling Technique

The survey included 40 people. A convenient sampling method was used because of time and access limits. This made it easier for the researcher to get responses quickly.

Data Collection Tools

Primary data was gathered using a structured Google Form. The form had two parts: one for basic information about the respondents and the other for questions about their awareness, opinions, and buying habits regarding eco-friendly products. Secondary data from academic papers, articles, and online reports was also used to back up the findings.

Research Area

Katraj,Pune

Data Analysis

The data was analysed using percentages to find trends in consumer behaviour. Graphs and charts were used to make the results easier to understand.

Impact

This study shows that green marketing affects how people are aware of, feel about, and buy products. The survey found that most people know about eco-friendly products and like to support brands that care about the environment. It shows that green marketing does more than raise awareness; it also helps build a good brand image and trust with customers.

The study also shows how Tata Group's sustainable actions, such as electric cars, renewable energy, and eco-friendly packaging, have helped the company connect with consumers better. These efforts have not only made customers happier but also helped the company do better financially and build lasting loyalty.

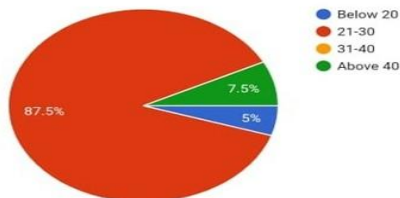
It suggests that using green marketing can bring long-term benefits. It also shows that being real about environmental efforts is more important than just making flashy claims, as people are more likely to trust genuine actions.

The main impact of this study is that it proves green marketing is both a good thing

1. What is your age group?

Age group	respondent	percentage
Below 20	2	5%
20 to 30	35	87.5%
31 to 40	0	0%
Above 40	3	7.5%
Total	40	100%

40 responses|



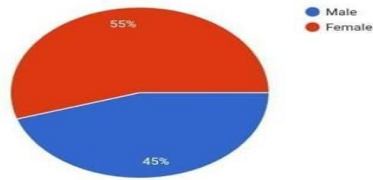
for the planet and a smart business move. It shows how companies can grow while protecting the environment, creating value for both the company and the community.

Most respondents (87.5%) are between 21–30 years old, showing that the survey mainly involved young adults.

2. What Is Your Gender

Categories	Responses	Percentage
Male	18	45%
Female	22	55%
Total	40	100%

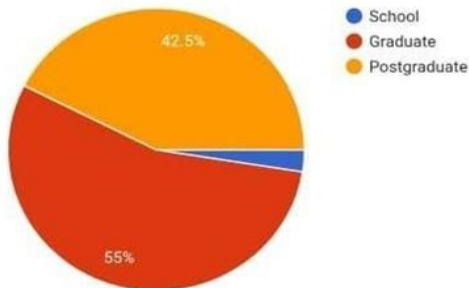
40 responses



3. What is your highest level of education?

Categories	Responses	Percentage
School	1	2.5%
Graduation	22	55%
Post-graduation	17	42.5%
Total	40	100%

40 responses



The majority of respondents are female (55%), while males make up 45%. Over half (55%) of the participants are graduates, followed by 42.5% postgraduates, and a small portion (2.5%) are school-level educated.

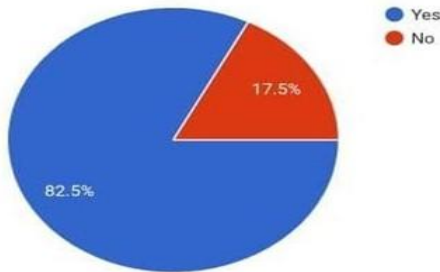
Awareness of Green Marketing

1. Have you heard term the Green Marketing?

A majority of respondents (82.5%) are aware of the term “Green Marketing” while only 17.5% not aware of it.

Categories	Responses	Percentages
Yes	33	82.5%
No	7	17.5%
Total	40	100%

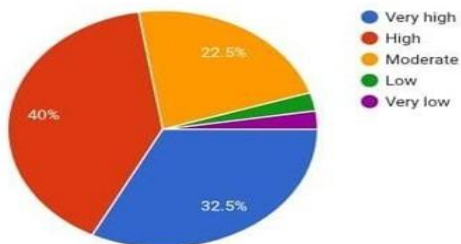
40 responses



2. How would you rate your awareness of Eco-friendly products?

Categories	Responses	Percentage
Very high	13	32.5%
High	16	40%
Moderate	9	22.5%
Low	1	2.5%
Very low	1	2.5%
Total	40	100%

40 responses



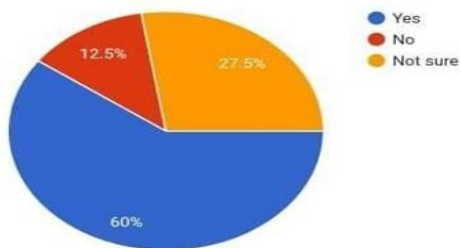
This graph shows that 40% of respondents rated their awareness as high, while 32.5% considered it very high. About 22.5% reported moderate awareness, and

only a small fraction (5%) indicated low or very low awareness. This indicates that the majority of consumers are fairly knowledgeable about eco-friendly products, suggesting a strong potential market for green marketing initiatives.

3. From where do you mostly hear about Eco-friendly products?

Categories	Responses	Percentage
Yes	24	60%
No	11	27.5%
Not sure	5	12.5%
Total	40	100%

40 responses



The majority of respondents (60%) confirmed that they have heard about eco-friendly products, while 27.5% were uncertain about their exposure to such information.

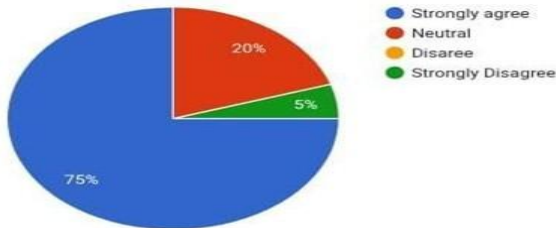
A smaller portion (12.5%) reported that they have not come across eco-friendly product information at all. This indicates that most people are aware of eco-friendly products, though a considerable percentage still lack clarity or exposure.

Consumer Perception and Attitude

1. Do you believe Eco-friendly products are better for the Environment?

Categories	Responses	Percentage
Strongly agree	30	75%
Agree	8	20%
Disagree	2	5%
Strongly Disagree	0	0%
Total	40	100%

40 responses

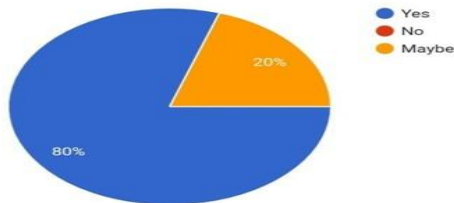


The data shows that the vast majority of respondents believe eco-friendly products are better for the environment, with 75% strongly agreeing and 20% agreeing. Only 5% disagreed, while none of the respondents strongly disagreed. This clearly reflects a positive attitude and strong acceptance of eco-friendly products as beneficial for environmental sustainability.

2. Would you prefer a product with Eco-friendly packaging over normal packaging?

Categories	Responses	Percentages
Yes	32	80%
No	8	20%
Maybe	0	0%
Total	40	100%

40 responses



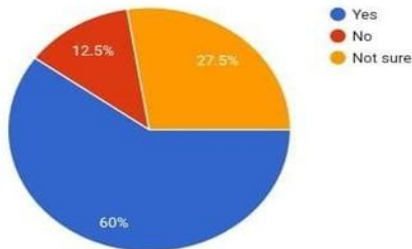
The results reveal that a large majority (82.1%) of respondents prefer eco-friendly packaging compared to normal packaging. Only 17.9% were uncertain, and none strongly opposed it. This suggests that sustainable packaging can be a decisive factor in consumer purchase decisions.

3. Do you think companies do Green Marketing only to increase sales rather

than protect the Environment?

Categories	Responses	Percentages
Yes	24	60%
No	5	12.5%
Maybe	11	27.5%
Total	40	100%

40 responses



The majority (60%) believe that companies adopt green marketing primarily as a strategy to boost sales, rather than out of genuine concern for the environment. Around 27.5% of respondents chose “Maybe”, reflecting uncertainty and suggesting that companies might have both profit-driven and environmental motives. Only 12.5% of respondents disagreed, showing that very few trust companies to prioritize environmental protection over sales.

Finding

1. Awareness of Green Marketing: Most people (82.5%) know what green marketing is, showing that the idea is well-known and widely accepted by consumers.
2. Positive Perception of Eco-friendly Products: Over 95% of people think eco-friendly products are good for the environment, which shows they are open to and like sustainable choices.
3. Preference for Sustainable Packaging: About 80% of people like eco-friendly packaging over regular packaging, showing a growing trend towards more sustainable ways of using products.
4. Gaps in Knowledge: Even though many are aware of green marketing, 27.5% don't know specific eco-friendly products, and 12.5% are unsure, showing that some people still lack information or experience.
5. Trust Issues with Companies: More than half (60%) are doubtful, thinking that companies use green marketing mainly for profit and not for real environmental help.
6. Demographic Insight: The study shows that young people aged 20 to 30 make up

the largest group that is aware of green marketing (87.5%), showing that younger generations are more likely to support eco-friendly ideas.

Suggestions

Awareness Campaigns: Companies should run education programs to help the 27.5% of people who don't know about eco-friendly options and the 12.5% who aren't sure about them. **Authenticity in Green Marketing:** Build trust by showing real environmental efforts instead of just pushing products for profit.

Transparent Practices: Share clear details about how eco-friendly choices are made, like where products come from, how they're packaged, and how they're disposed of, to make people feel more confident. **Targeted Marketing:** Focus on younger people aged 20 to 30, but also work to inform older groups who aren't as involved. **Overcoming Challenges:** Help lower the cost of eco-friendly actions by getting support from subsidies, partnerships, or government aid so green products are easier to get.

Long-term Branding: Make eco-friendly efforts a key part of the brand, not just something used for short-term promotions.

Conclusion

The study shows that green marketing is becoming more popular among younger people. Most of the people surveyed are aware of eco-friendly products and packaging and have a good opinion of them. But the study also finds that there is some lack of knowledge and some doubt about whether companies are really being honest about their green efforts. The youngest group, aged 20 to 30, is the most active and informed, but there is still a need to educate others as well. Overall, the research says that green marketing can help shape what people buy if companies are open, sincere, and committed to long-term sustainability. To build trust and make green marketing more effective, companies need to be genuine, communicate clearly, and keep up their eco-friendly efforts consistently. This will help reduce doubts and make green marketing more successful.

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The Role of Consumer Durable Loans in Changing Lifestyle Behaviour: A Study of Emerging Consumption Patterns in India

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Abstract:

In recent years, consumer durable loans have emerged as a significant driver of changing lifestyle behaviours in India. With the rapid expansion of credit facilities and easy financing options, consumers increasingly rely on installment-based purchases for household appliances, electronics, and luxury goods. This study explores how these loans influence consumption patterns and reshape purchasing attitudes among urban and semi-urban populations. It highlights the role of financial institutions, digital lending platforms, and evolving socio-economic factors in promoting aspirational buying behaviour. The findings indicate that consumer durable loans not only enhance access to modern amenities but also contribute to a shift from need-based to lifestyle-oriented consumption. The research further examines the implications of this trend on financial discipline and long-term consumer spending habits, offering insights into the broader transformation of India's consumer economy.

Key Words: Consumer, Changing Lifestyle

Introduction:

In recent years, India has witnessed a notable shift in consumer behaviour, driven largely by increasing disposable incomes, urbanization, digitization, and greater access to credit. Among the various financial tools reshaping consumption, **consumer durable loans**—which allow individuals to purchase products like smartphones, televisions, appliances, and furniture on easy monthly instalments—have played a pivotal role. These loans have lowered the entry barriers for aspirational buyers, enabling access to lifestyle-enhancing goods without the need for immediate full payment. This easy access to credit has significantly altered traditional saving-before-spending habits. Instead, a **“buy now, pay later”** mind-set is emerging, especially among millennials and the urban middle class. The widespread availability of zero-interest EMIs, digital financing apps, and point-of-sale financing partnerships has further fuelled this trend. As a result, consumer durable loans are not merely financial instruments but also key drivers of lifestyle upgrades and status-oriented consumption. This research seeks to explore how consumer durable loans are reshaping lifestyle behaviour in India—encouraging material aspirations,

influencing brand choices, and altering perceptions of affordability and financial planning. It aims to provide insights into the psychological, economic, and social dimensions of this evolving consumer-finance dynamic.

Research Objectives:

1. **To analyse the growth and usage patterns of consumer durable loans in India.**
2. **To study the impact of consumer durable loans on lifestyle behaviour.**
3. **To examine consumer attitudes toward borrowing for lifestyle goods.**
4. **To assess how financial institutions and retailers market and position consumer durable loans.**
5. **To identify the long-term behavioural and financial implications.**
6. **To provide recommendations** for policy makers, lenders, and marketers on promoting responsible borrowing while enabling lifestyle growth.

Problem statement:

The increasing availability and accessibility of consumer durable loans in India have significantly altered the way individuals make purchasing decisions. While these loans have empowered consumers to acquire modern goods and improve their living standards, they have also led to a rise in credit dependency and changing financial behaviours. The core problem lies in understanding how consumer durable financing influences lifestyle choices, spending patterns, and attitudes toward consumption. There is a growing need to examine whether this easy access to credit promotes sustainable consumption or encourages impulsive and debt-driven purchasing behaviour. This study aims to identify the key factors behind this shift and assess its broader impact on consumer lifestyles and financial well-being in the Indian context.

Purpose of Study:

The purpose of this study is to examine how consumer durable loans is to understand how these financial products help consumers access and afford household appliances and electronics through manageable instalment payment. By examining consumer durable loans, researchers and financial institutions can analyse borrower behaviour, evaluate the benefits and risks of such loans, and assess their impact on consumer satisfaction and retail sales.

Hypothesis

1. **H1:** Availability of consumer durable loans positively influences the purchasing behaviour of middle-income households.
2. **H2:** Easy EMI options under consumer durable loans significantly increase

customer preference for branded products.

3. H3: Awareness of consumer durable loans has a direct impact on the utilization of such financial products.

4. H4: The flexibility of repayment tenure in consumer durable loans enhances customer satisfaction and loyalty.

5. H5: Interest rates and hidden charges have a negative correlation with the demand for consumer durable loans.

Review of Literature

Sharma and Gupta (2019) observed that consumer durable loans in India have grown rapidly in urban and semi-urban markets, driven by increasing disposable income and changing lifestyle aspirations.

Kumar (2020) highlighted that easy EMI schemes and flexible repayment options significantly influence lifestyle behaviour, as consumers are more willing to purchase branded and premium products on credit.

Mehta and Singh (2021) found that younger and middle-income households are the most frequent users of consumer durable loans, as borrowing reduces the burden of upfront payments and increases the frequency of consumption.

Choudhary (2018) emphasized the collaboration between financial institutions and retailers, noting that promotional schemes and tie-ups encourage higher loan adoption while boosting product sales.

Rao and Iyer (2022) cautioned that while consumer durable loans promote lifestyle growth, heavy reliance on credit can create financial stress, highlighting the importance of financial literacy and responsible borrowing practices.

Research Methodology

1. Research Design

The study will follow a descriptive research design, as it aims to examine the usage patterns, lifestyle impact, and customer perception of consumer durable loans. This approach is suitable for analysing consumer behaviour and identifying relationships between credit access and purchase decisions.

2. Data Collection

Primary Data: Structured questionnaires and interviews will be conducted among loan customers in urban and semi-urban areas. The survey will cover aspects such as loan awareness, reasons for availing, repayment preferences, and satisfaction levels.

Secondary Data: Information will be gathered from bank reports, financial institutions, industry publications, government data, and previous research studies on consumer credit.

3. Sampling Method

A purposive sampling method will be adopted, targeting respondents who have availed consumer durable loans in the last three years. Both salaried and self-employed individuals will be included to ensure diverse representation.

4. Sample Size

A sample of 40 respondents will be selected to provide a reliable base for statistical analysis while keeping the study feasible within time and resource limits.

5. Tools for Data Collection

A structured questionnaire with both closed-ended and Likert scale questions will be used. The questionnaire will measure factors such as loan awareness, EMI preferences, financial literacy, customer satisfaction, and challenges faced.

6. Data Analysis

The collected data will be analysed using descriptive statistics (percentages, mean, standard deviation) and inferential tools (chi-square test, correlation, and regression analysis) to study relationships between variables such as income level, repayment behaviour, and lifestyle impa

Data Analysis and interpretation

Source - Primary Data

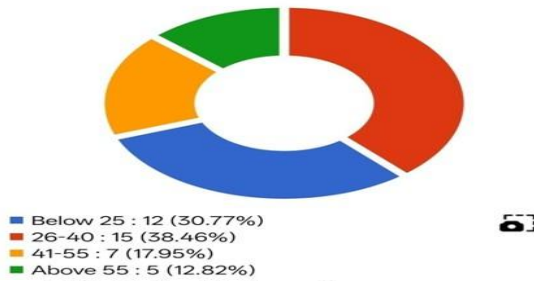
Type-Survey by using google forms

1. What is Age group?

Age Group	Respondent	Percentage
Below 25	12	30.77%
26-40	15	38.46%
41-55	7	17.95%
Above 55	5	12.82%
Total	40	100%

Age Group

Pie ▾

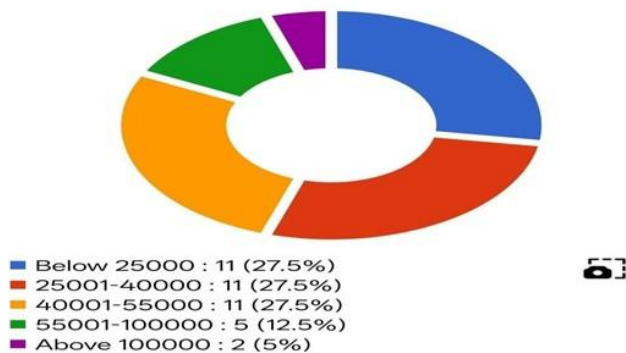


2 .What is Monthly income?

Monthly income	Respondent	Percentage
Below 25000	11	28.21%
25001-40000	11	28.21%
40001-55000	10	25.64%
55001-100000	5	12.82%
Above 100000	2	5.13%
Total	40	100%

Monthly Income

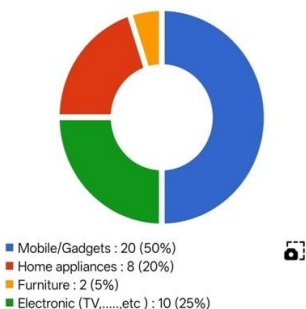
Pie ▾



The survey shows that most respondents have a monthly income below 25,000 or between 40,001–55,000 (28.17% each), followed by 25,001–40,000 (25.64%), 55,001–1,00,000 (12.82%), and above 1,00,000 (5.13%).

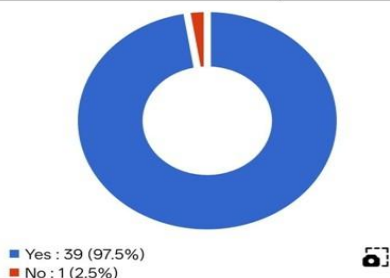
3. Which consumer durable product(s) are you interested in financing?

Products	Respondent	Percentage
Mobile/Gadgets	20	50%
Home Appliances	8	20%
Furniture	2	5%
Electronic	10	25%
Total	40	100%



The survey reveals that half of the respondents prefer financing mobile gadgets (50%), followed by electronics like TVs (25%), home appliances (20%), and furniture (5%).

Awareness	Respondent	Percentage
Yes	39	97.5%
No	1	2.5%
Total	40	100%



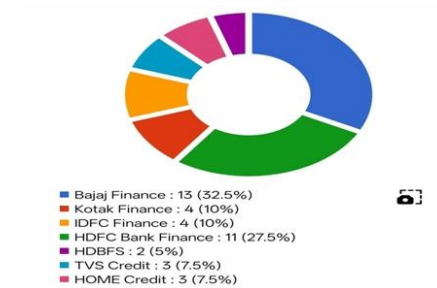
4. Are you aware of consumer durable loans offered by banks/NBFCs?

A majority of respondents (97.5%) are aware of the term “Consumer Durable Loan” while only 2.5% not aware of it.

5. Which institution did you use?

Finance Institution	Respondent	Percentage
Bajaj Finance	13	32.5%
Kotak Finance	4	10%
IDFC Finance	4	10%
HDFC Finance	11	27.5%
HDBFS	2	5%
TVS Credit	3	7.5%
Home Credit	3	7.5%
Total	40	100%

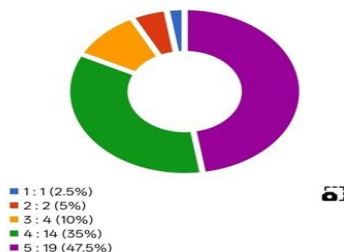
The survey of 40 respondents shows Bajaj Finance (32.5%) and HDFC Finance



(27.5%) as the most preferred for consumer durable loans, while Kotak and IDFC Finance (10% each), TVS Credit and Home Credit (7.5% each), and HDBFS (5%) have smaller shares.

6. On a scale of 1-5, how satisfied were you with your past loan?

Satisfaction And dissatisfaction level	Respondent	Percentage
0	0	0%
1	1	2.5%
2	2	5%
3	4	10%
4	14	35%
5	19	47.5%
Total	40	100%



hold limited market share.

The survey shows that 47.5% of respondents rated their loan experience as highly satisfactory (level 5), followed by 35% at level 4, while very few expressed lower satisfaction levels.

Finding

1. Preferred Loan Providers: Bajaj Finance (32.5%) and HDFC Finance (27.5%) are the most preferred institutions for consumer durable loans, followed by Kotak and IDFC (10% each). Smaller players like TVS Credit, Home Credit (7.5% each), and HDBFS (5%)

2. Customer Satisfaction: Nearly half (47.5%) of the respondents rated their loan experience at the highest satisfaction level (5), while 35% rated it at level 4, suggesting overall positive experiences with consumer durable loans.

3. Consumption Pattern: Mobile gadgets (50%) are the most financed products, followed by TVs (25%), home appliances (20%), and furniture (5%). This indicates a trend of aspirational consumption among younger and middle-income groups.

4. Income and Loan Usage: Most respondents fall under the income brackets of below 25,000 (28.17%) and 40,001–55,000 (28.17%). Middle-income groups (25,001 – 40,000) represent 25.64%, while higher income groups (55,001–1,00,000: 12.82%, above 1,00,000: 5.13%) are fewer. This shows that consumer durable loans are more popular among lower and middle-income households

Suggestions

1. Customized Loan Products: Financial institutions should design flexible EMI plans catering to low and middle-income groups, as they form the majority of borrowers.

2. Awareness Campaigns: Banks and NBFCs should enhance awareness of responsible borrowing and the benefits of consumer durable loans, especially in semi-urban and rural markets.

3. Digital Integration: Improve digital loan processes for faster approvals and user-friendly apps to attract younger consumers who mostly finance gadgets.

4. Product Diversification: Encourage financing options beyond mobiles and electronics—such as furniture, healthcare devices, and eco-friendly appliances—to diversify consumer choices.

5. Green Financing Initiatives: Promote loans with incentives for purchasing energy-efficient or eco-friendly products, aligning with sustainability goals.

6. After-Sales Support: Regular follow-up and customer service improvements can further enhance satisfaction and loyalty.

Conclusion

The study highlights that consumer durable loans play a significant role in reshaping consumption patterns in India, particularly among low and middle-income households. The findings reveal that mobile gadgets and electronics dominate financing preferences, indicating aspirational and lifestyle-driven purchasing behavior. Bajaj Finance and HDFC have emerged as dominant players due to their market reach and consumer trust. Overall satisfaction with loan experiences is high, reflecting the effectiveness of current financing models. However, there is scope to expand loan penetration into diverse product categories and income segments. By focusing on customized offerings, digital accessibility, and sustainable financing, consumer durable loans can further contribute to changing lifestyle behaviour and drive inclusive growth in India's emerging consumption economy.

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“Role of Digital Payments in Reducing Tax Evasion.”

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Abstract

Tax evasion is a persistent challenge faced by governments worldwide, leading to significant revenue losses that hinder economic growth and public welfare. Traditionally, the use of cash in economic transactions has allowed individuals and businesses to conceal their real income, avoid reporting, and escape taxation. However, the rapid growth of digital payment systems has begun to change this landscape. Digital payment platforms—such as mobile wallets, online banking, credit and debit cards, and government-supported systems like the Unified Payments Interface (UPI)—create a transparent and traceable record of transactions, making it increasingly difficult to hide income or conduct unreported business activities.

This research paper explores the critical role of digital payments in curbing tax evasion by promoting financial transparency and accountability. It analysis how the adoption of digital payment systems reduces cash-based transactions, strengthens tax monitoring mechanisms, and encourages voluntary compliance among taxpayers.

Furthermore, the paper discusses the technological and policy enablers that make digital payments effective, such as data analytics, integration with tax networks, and government incentives. It also highlights ongoing challenges like the digital divide, cybersecurity risks, and privacy concerns that may limit the full potential of these systems. The findings indicate that while digital payments alone cannot eliminate tax evasion, they play a transformative role in reducing its scale by making financial flows more visible and verifiable. Ultimately, the study concludes that the promotion of secure, inclusive, and well-regulated digital payment ecosystems is essential for enhancing tax compliance, strengthening public trust, and ensuring sustainable economic development.

Key words: Tax evasion, Digital payments, Financial transparency, Tax compliance, Data analytic.

Introduction

Tax evasion poses a persistent challenge to governments worldwide, undermining fiscal stability and limiting resources for economic and social development. The widespread use of cash transactions has long facilitated income concealment and underreporting, making tax enforcement difficult. However, the growing adoption of digital payment systems—such as mobile wallets, online banking, and platforms like India's Unified Payments Interface

(UPI)—is transforming this landscape by promoting transparency and accountability in financial transactions.

Digital payments create verifiable transaction records that reduce opportunities for unreported income and illicit financial activities. This study examines how digital payments contribute to reducing tax evasion by enhancing transaction traceability, integrating financial data with tax systems, and encouraging voluntary compliance. It also considers key challenges, including the digital divide, cybersecurity risks, and privacy concerns. Ultimately, the paper argues that while digital payments cannot entirely eliminate tax evasion, they play a transformative role in promoting financial transparency, strengthening tax administration, and supporting sustainable economic growth.

Objectives

- To examine the role of digital payments in reducing tax evasion through financial transparency.
- To analysis the impact of digital payment adoption on tax compliance and revenue collection.
- To observe individual behaviour and attitudes toward digital payments and their influence on tax compliance.
- To identify key challenges and policy measures for promoting effective digital payment systems.

Purpose of the Study

The purpose of this study is to explore how digital payment systems help reduce tax evasion by promoting financial transparency, improving tax compliance, and understanding individual behaviour toward digital transactions and taxation.

Statement of the Problem

Tax evasion reduces public revenue and undermines economic fairness, especially in cash-based economies. Digital payment systems offer traceable transactions that can improve transparency and tax compliance. However, adoption remains uneven due to infrastructure, awareness, and security issues. This study examines how digital payments can reduce tax evasion and enhance financial accountability.

Review of Literature:

Behavioural Factors Influencing Adoption

Arif Hasan et al. (2024, India)

Technology and Policy Impact on Tax Compliance

S M Seetalad & S K Patil (2024, India) **The Rise of Digital Payments in**

India: Dr Sree Lakshmi K. (2024)

Research Methodology

This study is based on primary data collected through a survey using Google Forms. A self-made questionnaire was designed and shared with people from different age groups to understand their views and behaviour toward digital payments and tax compliance. The responses were collected and analysed to find how the use of digital payments influences people's attitudes and practices related to paying taxes.

Data Collection

Primary data was collected through a Google Forms survey using a self-made questionnaire. The survey included **students, businesspersons, employees, CA professionals, and senior citizens** to understand their views and behaviour regarding digital payments and tax compliance.

Sampling Size and Technique

The study was conducted with a sample of 25 respondents using a convenience sampling technique, where participants were chosen based on availability and willingness. Although the sample size was limited, it provided useful insights and helped improve the understanding of how digital payments can reduce tax evasion.

Data Analysis

The collected data was analysed using percentage analysis to identify trends and opinions related to the role of digital payments in reducing tax evasion. The results were presented through graphs and charts to clearly show how respondents perceive the impact of digital transactions on tax compliance and transparency.

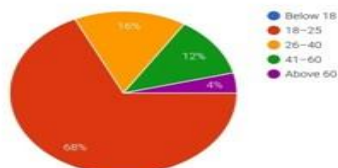
The positive impact of digital payments on tax evasion:

- Digital payments create transparent transaction records, reducing the scope for unreported income.
- They make it easier for tax authorities to track financial activities electronically.
- Use of digital platforms reduces cash-based transactions, which are often used to evade taxes.
- Digital receipts and audit trails enhance accountability among individuals and businesses.
- Integration of payment data with tax systems improves compliance and revenue collection.

The negative impacts of digital payments related to tax evasion:

Age group	Respondent	Percentage
Below 18	0	0%
18 to 25	17	68%
26 to 40	4	16%
41 to 60	3	12%
Above 60	1	4%
Total	25	100%

25 responses



2. What is your occupation?

Occupation	Respondent	Percentage
Student	13	52%
Businessperson	3	12%
Employee(private/Government)	7	28%
Self-employed	1	4%
Others	1	4%
Total	25	100%

- Limited digital literacy can prevent some people from using digital payments effectively.
- Technical issues or system failures can disrupt transactions and reduce trust.
- Cybersecurity risks and data breaches may discourage users from digital platforms.
- Some users may still find ways to evade taxes through unreported digital transactions or fake accounts.
- Lack of internet access in rural areas limits the reach and effectiveness of digital payment systems.

Data Analysis and Interpretation Source – Primary Data

Type – Survey by Using Google Forms

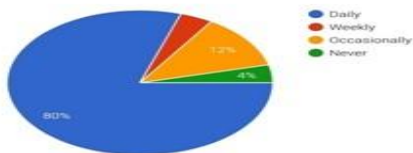
1.What is your age group?

Platforms	Respondent	Percentage
Google Pay	17	68%
Phone Pe	2	8%
Paytm	2	8%
Credit/Debit Card	1	4%
Internet Banking	2	8%

1. How often do you use digital payment methods (UPI, mobile wallets, cards, etc)

Methods	Respondent	Percentage
daily	20	80%
Weekly	1	4%
Occasionally	3	12%
Never	1	4%
Total	25	100%

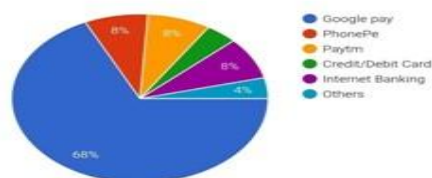
25 responses



The question asks respondents how frequently they use digital payment methods such as UPI, mobile wallets, or cards. The pie chart shows that 80% use them daily, 12% use them occasionally, 4% use them weekly, and another 4% never use them, indicating that most respondents rely heavily on digital payments in their daily lives.

2. Which digital payment platforms do you use most frequently? (Choose all that apply)

25 responses

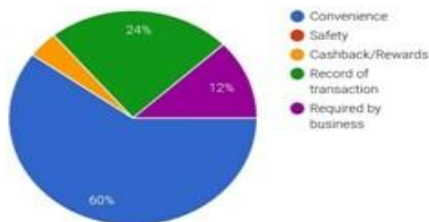


This question asks respondents which digital payment platforms they use most often. The chart shows that 68% prefer Google Pay, while Phone Pe, Paytm, Credit/Debit Cards, and Internet Banking are each used by about 8%, indicating Google Pay is the dominant choice among users.

What Peoples Thinks about Digital Payments

1.What is your main reason for using digital payments?

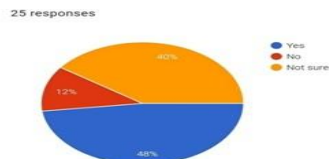
Reasons	Respondent	Percentage
Convenience	15	60%
Safety	0	0%
Cashback/Rewards	1	4%
Record of transaction	6	24%
Required by Business	3	12%
Total	25	100%



This question asks participants about their main reason for using digital payments. The chart shows that 60% choose convenience, 24% value having a record of transactions, and 12% use it because it's required by businesses, making convenience the leading factor.

2.Do you think digital payments are more secure than cash?

Reasons	Respondent	Percentage
Yes	12	48%
No	3	12%
Not Sure	10	40%
Total	25	100%

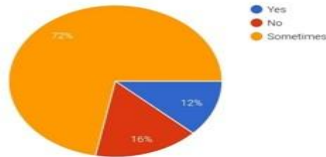


The question asks respondents whether they think digital payments are more secure than cash. According to the graph, 48% believe digital payments are more secure, 12% think they are not, and 40% are unsure. This indicates that while nearly half have confidence in digital payment security, a significant portion still has doubts or uncertainty.

3.Do you face any problems while using digital payments (e.g., network issues, fraud, technical errors)

Reasons	Respondent	Percentage
Yes	3	12%
No	4	16%
Sometimes	18	72%
Total	25	100%

25 responses



The question asks if users face problems while using digital payments. The graph shows that 72% face issues sometimes, 12% often, and 16% never. This means most users occasionally experience problems with digital payments.

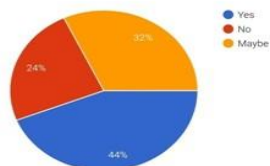
Peoples Opinion About Digital Payment & Tax Evasion Interactions

1. In your opinion, can promoting digital payments reduce tax evasion in your area or country?

The question asks whether promoting digital payments can help reduce tax evasion. The chart shows that 44% agree, 24% disagree, and 32% are unsure. This

Opinion	Respondent	Percentage
Yes	11	44%
No	6	24%
May Be	8	32%
Total	25	100%

25 responses

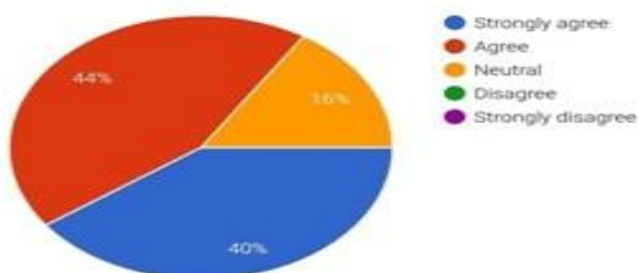


suggests most respondents believe digital payments could help control tax evasion.

2. Do you believe that digital payments can make the economy more transparent?

Opinion	Respondent	Percentage
Strongly Agree	10	40%
Agree	11	44%
Neutral	4	16%
Disagree	0	0%
Strongly Disagree	0	0%
Total	25	100%

The question asks whether people believe digital payments can make the economy more transparent. According to the pie chart, 40% strongly agree and 44% agree, 25 responses

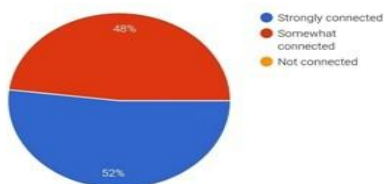


showing that most respondents see digital payments as enhancing transparency. Only 16% remain neutral, and no one disagrees, indicating strong overall support.

3. What is your opinion about the link between digital payments and tax compliance?

Opinion	Respondent	Percentage
Strongly Connected	13	52%
Somewhat Connected	12	48%
Not Connected	0	0%
Total	25	100%

25 responses



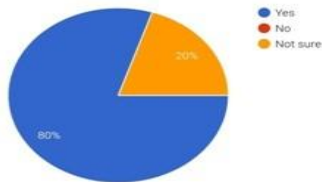
This question asks how people view the relationship between digital payments and tax compliance. The chart shows that 52% believe they are strongly connected, while 48% think they are somewhat connected. Most people support the idea that digital payments are strongly linked to better tax compliance.

4.

Would

Opinion	Respondent	Percentage
Yes	20	80%
No	0	0%
Not Sure	5	20%
Total	25	100%

25 responses



you support government policies that encourage digital payments to improve tax collection?

5.

Findi

ngs

1. **High Usage:** 80% of respondents use digital payments daily, showing strong adoption in everyday life.
1. **Preferred Platform:** Google Pay dominates usage with 68% preference, far ahead of other platforms.
2. **Main Reason:** 60% use digital payments for convenience, making it the key motivation.
3. **Security Perception:** 48% view digital payments as secure, though 40% are uncertain.
4. **Usage Issues:** 72% sometimes face technical or operational problems while making payments.
5. **Impact on Tax Evasion:** 44% believe digital payments help reduce tax evasion, though some remain unsure.
6. **Transparency:** 84% agree digital payments make the economy more transparent.
7. **Tax Compliance:** Most respondents see a strong link between digital payments and improved tax compliance.
8. **Government Policies:** 80% support government initiatives promoting digital payments for better tax collection.

Suggestions

- **Enhance Security** – Implement two-factor authentication, biometric verification, and real-time fraud alerts to build user trust and encourage wider adoption of digital payments.
- **Improve Reliability** – Strengthen app stability, ensure smooth network connectivity, and provide responsive customer support to reduce technical problems during transactions.
- **Enable Offline Payments** – Develop features that allow transactions even without active internet, such as QR code offline modes or USSD-based payments, to ensure uninterrupted usage.
- **Increase Convenience & Incentives** – Offer cashback, discounts, loyalty rewards, and mandatory e-receipts to make digital payments more attractive and widely used.
- **Integrate with Tax Systems** – Link digital payments to tax filing platforms and automate reporting of high-value transactions to simplify compliance and reduce evasion.
- **Raise Awareness** – Conduct campaigns highlighting transparency, tax compliance benefits, and success stories to educate users about the positive impact of digital payments.
- **Collaborate with Platforms** – Work with major payment apps to add tax reporting features, send automated reminders, and promote responsible digital payment usage.
- **Government Policies & Incentives** – Provide tax rebates or incentives for digital transactions and gradually discourage large cash payments to strengthen formal economy participation.
- **Address Public Uncertainty** – Share data-backed statistics, real-life examples, and success stories to increase public confidence in the security and tax compliance benefits of digital payments.

Conclusion

The study highlights that digital payments have become an integral part of everyday transactions, with 80% of respondents using them daily and Google Pay being the most preferred platform. Convenience remains the primary motivator for adoption, while security concerns and occasional technical issues continue to affect user confidence. Digital payments play a significant role in promoting transparency and improving tax compliance, as indicated by respondents who recognize their potential to reduce tax evasion. Government initiatives supporting digital payment adoption are widely appreciated, reflecting public support for policies aimed at enhancing formal

economic transactions.

However, challenges such as technical glitches, network issues, and uncertainty about security need to be addressed to maximize the effectiveness of digital payments in tax collection. Strengthening infrastructure, integrating payments with tax reporting systems, promoting public awareness, and providing incentives can further encourage adoption and ensure that digital transactions contribute effectively to reducing tax evasion. In conclusion, while digital payments are not a complete solution, they serve as a powerful tool to increase transparency, enhance tax compliance, and reduce the scope of tax evasion. With continued improvements in technology, policy support, and user education, digital payments can play a pivotal role in creating a more formal, accountable, and tax-compliant economy.

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IMPACT OF LUXURY BRANDS ON NEW GENERATION

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ABSTRACT

The emergence of luxury brands has significantly influenced the consumption patterns, aspirations, and lifestyle choices of the new generation. Unlike earlier generations, today's youth perceive luxury not only as a symbol of wealth but also as an expression of identity, social status, and individuality. This research paper explores the psychological, cultural, and economic factors driving the increasing fascination of young consumers toward luxury brands. It also examines the role of social media, celebrity endorsements, and globalization in shaping the perception of luxury among the youth. Furthermore, the study investigates both positive impacts, such as confidence-building and motivation, and negative impacts, such as materialism, peer pressure, and financial burden. The findings contribute to understanding how luxury brands are reshaping consumer behaviour and what implications this has for businesses and society.

Keywords – Luxury brands, social media influences, Youth.

INTRODUCTION

The emergence of luxury brands has significantly influenced the consumption patterns, aspirations, and lifestyle choices of the new generation. Unlike earlier generations, today's youth perceive luxury not only as a symbol of wealth but also as an expression of identity, social status, and individuality. This research paper explores the psychological, cultural, and economic factors driving the increasing fascination of young consumers toward luxury brands. It also examines the role of social media, celebrity endorsements, and globalization in shaping the perception of luxury among the youth. Furthermore, the study investigates both positive impacts, such as confidence-building and motivation, and negative impacts, such as materialism, peer pressure, and financial burden. The findings contribute to understanding how luxury brands are reshaping consumer behaviour and what implications this has for businesses and society. This study focuses on concepts such as Luxury Brands, Consumer Behaviour, and New Generation Consumers. It highlights the role of Social Media Influence, Digital Marketing, and Brand Image in shaping young consumers' perceptions. Other important terms include Brand Loyalty, Sustainability, Celebrity Endorsement, Influencer

Marketing, and Self-Expression, which together explain how luxury brands impact the lifestyle and purchasing behaviour of today's youth.

Problem Statement

In the modern digital era, luxury brands have become highly influential among new-generation consumers, especially Millennials and Generation Z. Unlike older generations, they view luxury not only as a status symbol but as a form of self-expression and identity. However, there is limited understanding of the key factors—such as social media influence, celebrity endorsements, and brand ethics—that shape their attitudes and purchase behaviour. Therefore, this study aims to examine the impact of luxury brands on the new generation consumers and to identify the major factors influencing their perceptions and loyalty toward these brands.

PURPOSE OF STUDY

The purpose of this study is to examine the factors shaping the new generation's interest in luxury brands, with a focus on social media influence and the role of social and ethical values in driving brand loyalty.

OBJECTIVES

1. To identify what drives the new generation's desire to purchase luxury brands.
2. To analyse how social media influences their perception of and connection to luxury brands.
3. To determine if a brand's social and ethical values impact the new generation's loyalty.

HYPOTHESIS

H1₁: The new generation's desire to purchase luxury brands is significantly driven by social and psychological factors such as status, self-expression, and peer influence.

H0₁: The new generation's desire to purchase luxury brands is not significantly influenced by social and psychological factors such as status, self-expression, or peer influence.

H1₂: Social media platforms positively influence the perceptions and emotional connections of the new generation toward luxury brands.

H0₂: Social media platforms do not have a significant effect on the perceptions or emotional connections of the new generation toward luxury brands.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

1. **Kumar(2024)**- Buying Behaviour of Gen Z towards Luxury Products that Gen Z's luxury purchases are driven by status, self-expression, and peer influence, linking luxury consumption to personal identity.

2. Dobre et al. (2021) Social Media and Luxury Brands found that social media effectively enhances Gen Z's emotional connection with luxury brands, making digital platforms key in brand perception.

3. Diamond Goose (2025) Values Driving Luxury Purchases highlights that Gen Z prefers brands with transparency and ethical practices, showing that social and ethical values influence their buying decisions.

4. Sustainability and Brand Loyalty A 2025 MDPI study emphasizes that sustainability and social responsibility are crucial for Gen Z, affecting their loyalty toward luxury brands.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

1. Data Collection Method:

Primary data was collected through a structured online questionnaire using Google Forms. Secondary data was obtained from academic journals, articles, and previous studies on luxury brand consumption.

2. Research Design:

The study follows a descriptive research design to understand the factors influencing the new generation's interest in luxury brands and their loyalty patterns.

3. Sample and Population:

The target population consists of individuals aged 18–30 years (new generation/Gen Z). A sample of 56 respondents was selected using convenience sampling.

4. Research Instrument:

The questionnaire included three sections:

Demographic information (age, gender, income, etc.)

Factors influencing luxury brand purchase (status, self-expression, peer influence)

Social media influence and ethical value perception

5. Research area: Kondhwa, Croma – NIBM Road, Pune

6. Data Analysis:

The collected data was analysed using percentage analysis, charts, and graphs to interpret trends and patterns. Correlations between social media influence, ethical values, and brand loyalty were examined.

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

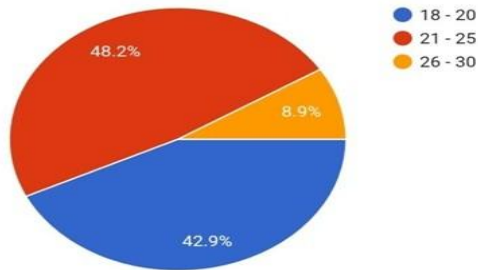
Source – Primary data and secondary data

Type - Primary data from survey by using google forms. Secondary data from websites.

1. What is your age?

Categories	Responses	Percentages
18 – 20	24	42.9%
21 – 25	27	48.2%
26 – 30	5	8.9%
Total	56	100%

56 responses

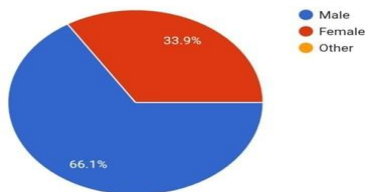


Most respondents (48.2%) belong to the 21–25 age group, showing that young adults are the main consumers of luxury brands.

1. What is your gender?

Categories	Responses	Percentage
Male	37	66.1%
Female	19	33.9%
Total	56	100%

56 responses

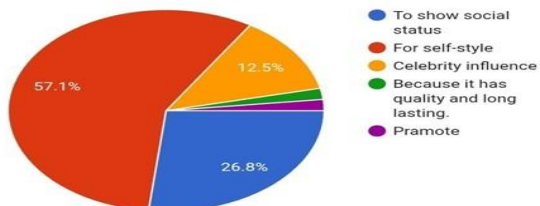


The majority of respondents are male (66.1%), indicating higher participation of males in luxury brand consumption compared to females.

1. What is your main reason behind purchasing luxury brands?

Categories	Responses	Percentage
To show social status	15	26.8%
For self-style	32	57.1%
Celebrity influence	7	12.5%
Quality & long lasting	1	1.8%
Promote	1	1.8%
Total	56	100%

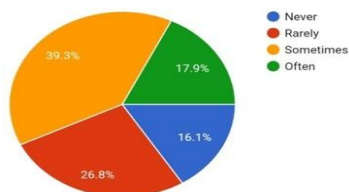
56 responses



The main reason people buy luxury brands is self-style (57.1%), showing personal expression matters more than social display. Around 26.8% purchase to show social status, and 12.5% are influenced by celebrities. Very few respondents value promotions or long-lasting quality as the key factor.

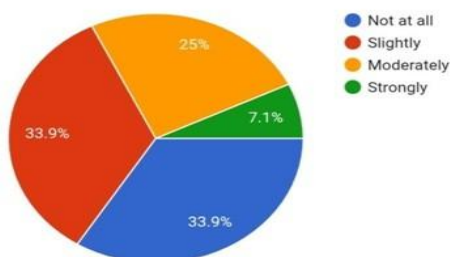
5. How often do you purchase luxury brands?

56 responses



Categories	Responses	Percentage
Not at all	19	33.9%
Slightly	19	33.9%
Moderately	14	25%
Strongly	4	7.1%
Total	56	100%

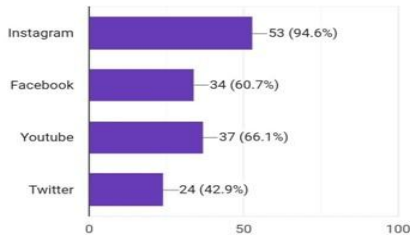
56 responses



Instagram strongly leads as the most influential platform (94.6%). YouTube (66.1%) and Facebook (60.7%) also play significant roles, while Twitter (42.9%) is less impactful. This proves that visual-heavy platforms, especially Instagram,

Categories	Responses	Percentage
Instagram	53	94.6%
Facebook	34	60.7%
YouTube	37	66.1%
Twitter	24	42.9%
Total	56	100%

56 responses



shape luxury brand perceptions the most among young consumers.

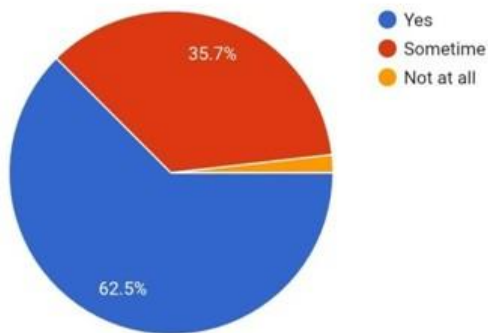
1. Which platform more influences your view of luxury brands?

Instagram strongly leads as the most influential platform (94.6%). YouTube (66.1%) and Facebook (60.7%) also play significant roles, while Twitter (42.9%) is less impactful. This proves that visual-heavy platforms, especially Instagram, shape luxury brand perceptions the most among young consumers.

1. Do a brand ethical practices like fair trade, charity affect your loyalty?

Categories	Responses	Percentages
Yes	35	62.5%
Sometimes	20	35.7%
Not at all	1	1.8%
Total	56	100%

56 responses

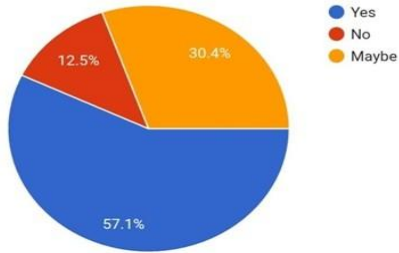


A large majority (62.5%) said that ethical practices like fair trade and charity increase their loyalty towards a brand. Around 35.7% said it sometimes influences them, while only 1.8% are not affected at all. This shows that corporate social responsibility builds stronger consumer trust.

1. Would you prefer a luxury brand who promotes sustainability over one that does not?

Categories	Responses	Percentages
Yes	32	57.1%
No	7	12.5%
Maybe	17	30.4%
Total	56	100%

56 responses



The main reason people buy luxury brands is self-style (57.1%), showing personal expression matters more than social display. Around 26.8% purchase to show social status, and 12.5% are influenced by celebrities. Very few respondents value promotions or long-lasting quality as the key factor.

FINDINGS

1. Demographics – Majority of respondents were male (66.1%) and most belonged to the 18–25 age group (91.1%), showing that young males dominate luxury brand interest.

2. Sustainability Preference – 57.1% prefer luxury brands promoting sustainability, while 30.4% are still unsure, indicating a positive but developing attitude towards eco-friendly practices.

3. Buying Frequency – Most respondents purchase luxury brands “sometimes” (39.3%) or “rarely” (26.8%), reflecting limited but aspirational buying.

4. Ethical Practices & Loyalty – 62.5% are loyal to brands that practice fairness and charity, proving ethics strongly affect consumer trust.

5. Motives for Purchase – The main reason is self-style (57.1%), followed by social status (26.8%) and celebrity influence (12.5%).

6. Social Media Influence – Instagram is the top influencing platform (94.6%), followed by YouTube and Facebook. However, social media's effect on perception is mostly slight to moderate rather than strong.

SUGETTIONS

1. Sustainability as a Core Strategy – Luxury brands should highlight eco-friendly initiatives and communicate them clearly, as young consumers prefer responsible brands.

2. Targeting Youth Market – Marketing campaigns should focus on the 18–25 age group, especially males, since they form the largest consumer base.

3. Affordable Luxury Options – Since most consumers buy only sometimes or

rarely, introducing entry-level luxury items can increase purchase frequency.

4. Strengthening Ethical Branding – Brands should showcase fair trade, charity, and community work to build long-term loyalty.

5. Social Media Engagement – Instagram should remain the priority platform for luxury promotions, using reels, influencer marketing, and visual storytelling.

6. Style-Focused Messaging – Marketing should emphasize self-expression and personal style, rather than only social status, to connect better with Gen Z and millennials.

CONCLUSION

The study reveals that the new generation is highly aware of luxury brands, but their purchasing is occasional and strongly influenced by social media, particularly Instagram. Consumers value self-style more than status and show growing concern for sustainability and ethical practices. This indicates that future luxury brand success depends not only on exclusivity but also on aligning with values such as sustainability, ethics, and individuality. Luxury brands that adapt to these expectations can build stronger loyalty and long-term growth among young consumers.

Moreover, the findings suggest that emotional connection and authentic storytelling play a crucial role in shaping brand perception. Young buyers prefer brands that reflect their identity and beliefs rather than simply displaying wealth. Therefore, innovation in marketing communication, influencer collaboration, and digital engagement becomes essential. The integration of ethical branding and eco-friendly initiatives can further enhance credibility. Consistency in brand experience across online and offline platforms also influences purchase decisions. In conclusion, the future of luxury branding lies in personalization, transparency, and purpose-driven marketing that resonates with the evolving mindset of Gen Z and millennials.

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Impact of Digital Banking On Customer Satisfaction

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ABSTRACT

Digital banking has transformed the way people manage their money by offering convenient services like online transfers, mobile banking apps, and 24/7 account access. This study explores how these digital services affect customer satisfaction. It shows that easy access, speed, security, and user-friendly features play a major role in making customers happy and loyal to their banks. However, some customers may face challenges like technical issues or lack of personal interaction. Overall, digital banking improves customer satisfaction by saving time, increasing convenience, and providing better control over financial activities.

KEYWORDS: Faster service, 24/7 Service, payment, Customer

INTRODUCTION

In today's world, technology is changing the way people live and do business. One of the areas most affected by technology is the banking industry. In the past, customers had to visit the bank to deposit money, withdraw cash, or check their account balance. Now, with digital banking, customers can do all these activities through their phones, computers, or ATMs without going to the bank. Digital banking includes online banking, mobile banking apps, and other electronic services that make banking faster and easier.

Digital banking has many benefits. It saves time, offers 24-hour access to banking services, and reduces the need to wait in long queues. However, it also comes with challenges such as security issues, system errors, and lack of personal interaction. Because of these changes, banks are trying to understand how digital banking affects their customers' satisfaction.

Customer satisfaction is very important because happy customers are more likely to stay with the bank and recommend it to others.

This research project aims to study the impact of digital banking on customer satisfaction. It will look at how digital services such as online transactions, mobile apps, and customer support affect how

satisfied customers feel. The study will also find out what customers like or dislike about digital banking and how banks can improve these services to make customers happier. The results of this research can help banks understand customer needs better and improve their digital platforms for a better banking experience.

PROBLEM STATEMENT:

- Digital banking services are rapidly expanding, yet many customers still experience dissatisfaction with online and mobile banking platforms.
- Common issues reported include poor system reliability, slow transaction processing, security concerns, and unfriendly user interfaces

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

- To find out how easy it is for customers to use digital banking services such as mobile apps, ATMs, and online banking.
- To identify the main factors that affect customer satisfaction in digital banking, such as speed, reliability, and security.
- To examine how digital banking compares to traditional banking in terms of convenience and customer experience.
- To determine whether digital banking services have increased customers' trust and loyalty toward their banks.

PURPOSE OF THE STUDY

The main purpose is to understand how Digital banking is changing banking services, improving efficiency, reducing costs, and creating better customer experiences. It also helps to find out both the benefits and challenges for customers.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter explains the methods and procedures used to carry out the research on the impact of digital banking on customer satisfaction. It describes the research design, study population, sample size, data collection methods, and how the data were analyzed. The purpose of this chapter is to show how the study was conducted to achieve reliable and valid results.

Research Design

This study adopted a descriptive research design. A descriptive design was chosen because it allows the researcher to gather information from a sample of people and describe their opinions and experiences about digital banking and customer satisfaction. It helps to identify patterns and relationships between variables without manipulating them.

Sampling Size

Because the population is large, it was not possible to collect data from everyone. Therefore, a sample size of 100 respondents was selected to represent the larger population.

Data And Analysis

Demographic Profile of Respondents:

Knowing the age, gender, and education of respondents helps to understand their digital banking habits.

Demographic Factor	Number of Respondents	Percentage (%)
Male	35	35%
Female	25	25%
Age 18–25	15	15%
Age 26–35	25	25%

Interpretation:

Most users are young adults (26–35 years) and graduates, suggesting digital banking is popular among educated and tech-savvy customers. Usage of Digital Banking Services:

Respondents were asked which digital services they use.

Interpretation:

Digital Service	Number of Users	Percentage (%)
Mobile Banking	30	30%
Internet Banking	25	25%
ATM Services	20	20%
USSD / SMS Banking	15	15%
Card Services	10	10%

Mobile banking is the most used service, showing that customers prefer convenient and quick access to their accounts. **Impact of Digital Banking on illiterate People :**

Digital banking has changed the way people handle money by allowing transactions through mobile apps, ATMs, and online banking. While this brings many benefits, it also creates challenges for illiterate people. Since they cannot read

or write, they often face difficulties in understanding digital banking platforms, reading instructions, or using passwords and PINs. This can make them hesitant to adopt these services and increase the risk of mistakes or fraud.

However, digital banking can still positively impact illiterate people if designed inclusively. Features like voice commands, visual icons, regional language options, and assistance from bank staff help them use services safely. When these supports are available, illiterate people can enjoy faster transactions, easier money transfers, and better access to financial services, which increases their financial inclusion and independence.

Impact of Digital Banking On Business :

Digital banking has significantly changed how businesses operate and manage their finances. It allows companies to make fast and secure payments, transfer money instantly, and manage accounts online without visiting a bank branch. Businesses can also track transactions, access loans, and analyze financial data more efficiently, which improves decision-making and planning.

Additionally, digital banking helps small and medium enterprises (SMEs) by reducing paperwork, saving time, and lowering transaction costs. It also enables businesses to reach customers through online payment systems, supporting e-commerce and global trade.

However, businesses must be aware of cybersecurity risks, technical issues, and the need for digital literacy among staff to fully benefit from digital banking.

FINDING

A. Convenience and Accessibility

Finding: Customers report higher satisfaction due to 24/7 access to banking services. Evidence: Transactions can be completed anytime, reducing the need for physical visits to branches. Impact: Improves perceived ease of use and efficiency.

B. Speed and Efficiency

Finding: Faster processing of transactions (fund transfers, bill payments, account management) positively correlates with satisfaction. Evidence: Reduced waiting times for services and instant notifications enhance trust in the system.

C. Personalized Services

Finding: Digital banking platforms that offer tailored recommendations, reminders, or alerts see higher customer satisfaction.

Impact: Personalized communication creates a sense of care and understanding of individual needs.

D. Security and Trust

Finding: Security features (two-factor authentication, encryption,

fraud alerts) are crucial in determining satisfaction.

E. Reduced Human Interaction

Finding: Some segments of customers prefer human interaction for complex banking needs; total digitalization may reduce satisfaction for these groups.

Insight: Hybrid models (digital + branch support) tend to score higher on satisfaction.

SUGGESTIONS

- **Approach:**

Quantitative (survey-based) or mixed methods.

- **Data Collection:**

Questionnaires distributed to bank customers who use mobile or internet banking.

- **Sampling:**

Random or convenience sampling from a specific bank or region.

- **Data Analysis:**

Use tools like SPSS or Excel for correlation, regression, or descriptive statistics

CONCLUSION

This study shows that digital banking has made banking easier, faster, and more convenient for customers. With services like mobile apps, online transfers, and 24-hour access, customers can manage their money anytime and anywhere. These features have increased customer satisfaction because they save time and reduce the need to visit the bank in person.

However, some customers still worry about security, system errors, and lack of personal help when using digital banking. Banks need to keep improving their systems, protect customer data, and provide better support to solve these problems.

In conclusion, digital banking has a strong positive impact on customer satisfaction. When banks focus on safety, simplicity, and good customer service, people are more likely to trust and enjoy using digital banking.

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Customer Awareness and Adoption of UPI and Digital Payment Systems

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Abstract :

This study focuses on understanding how aware customers are about UPI (Unified Payments Interface) and other digital payment systems, and how much they use them in their daily lives. With the rapid growth of digital technology, people are moving from cash-based transactions to online and mobile payments. The research aims to find out what factors influence customers to adopt these systems—such as convenience, security, government initiatives, and ease of use. It also looks at the challenges faced by users, including technical issues, lack of awareness, or fear of fraud. The findings show that most customers, especially younger generations, are becoming more comfortable with digital payments due to their speed and simplicity. However, continuous awareness programs and improved security measures are needed to increase trust and adoption among all sections of society.

Keywords : UPI (Unified Payments Interface), Digital Payments, Customer Awareness,, Digital India.

Introduction :

In recent years, India has witnessed a major transformation in its banking and payment systems due to rapid digitalization. The introduction of the **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** has made financial transactions faster, easier, and more secure. It allows customers to transfer money instantly between bank accounts using their smartphones, without the need for cash or card-based payments.

The **Bank of Maharashtra**, being one of the leading public sector banks in India, has actively promoted digital payment systems to support the government's vision of a **“Digital India”** and a **cashless economy**. The bank offers various digital services such as UPI, internet banking, mobile banking apps (like MahaUPI and MahaMobile), and Bharat QR payments to provide convenience and efficiency to its customers.

This study focuses on understanding the level of **customer awareness and adoption** of UPI and digital payment systems among the customers of the Bank

of Maharashtra. It aims to analyze how familiar customers are with these services, the factors influencing their usage, and the challenges faced during adoption. The study also explores how digital payments have improved banking experiences and contributed to financial inclusion.

Problem Statement:

1. Insufficient Customer Awareness
2. Low Adoption Rates Despite Availability
3. Limited Digital Literacy
4. Lack of Trust in Digital Payment Ecosystem

Objectives of the study

1. To study the level of customer awareness about UPI and digital payment systems in Maharashtra Bank.
2. To identify the factors influencing customer adoption of UPI-based payment services.
3. To analyze the satisfaction and trust levels of customers using digital payment systems.
4. To understand the challenges faced by customers in adopting UPI and digital payments.
5. To suggest measures to enhance awareness and increase adoption among Maharashtra Bank customers.

Purpose of the Study:

The main purpose of this study is to understand how aware customers are about UPI and other digital payment systems, and how widely they are being adopted in daily transactions. The study aims to explore the reasons behind the growing use of digital payments, such as convenience, speed, and government initiatives promoting a cashless economy. It also seeks to identify the challenges and concerns—like security issues, technical difficulties, or lack of awareness—that may prevent some customers from using these systems.

Research Methodology:

- Research Design: Descriptive and analytical.
- Data Sources:
 - Primary Data: Questionnaire-based survey of Maharashtra Bank customers.
 - Secondary Data: RBI and NPCI reports, journals, articles, and Maharashtra Bank's digital banking reports.
- Sampling Method: Simple random sampling.
- Sample Size: (You may specify — e.g., 70 respondents across selected branches.)
- Data Analysis Tools: Percentage analysis, charts, graphs, and Chi-square

tests (if applicable).

Positive Impact of Customer Awareness and Adoption of UPI and Digital Payment Systems

1. Financial Inclusion

- **Bridging the gap:** Digital payment systems like UPI have brought millions of unbanked and underbanked individuals into the formal financial ecosystem.
- **Easy accessibility:** Even small merchants and rural users can make and receive payments using basic smartphones and QR codes.

2. Convenience and Efficiency

- **Instant transactions:** UPI enables real-time money transfers 24/7, reducing the dependency on cash or traditional banking hours.
- **Simplified processes:** Customers can link multiple bank accounts to a single app, making payments, fund transfers, and bill settlements more efficient.

3. Transparency and Security

- **Digital trail:** Every UPI transaction is recorded digitally, which helps in tracking expenses and reducing fraud.
- **Enhanced security:** Two-factor authentication and UPI PIN systems protect users from unauthorized access.

4. Economic Growth and Formalization

- **Boost to the digital economy:** Increased UPI adoption encourages cashless transactions, leading to higher tax compliance and better tracking of economic activity.
- **Support for small businesses:** Digital payments help micro and small enterprises build transaction histories, making them eligible for credit and loans.

5. Cost and Time Savings

- **Reduced operational costs:** Businesses save on cash handling and banking fees.
- **Time efficiency:** Instant transfers reduce delays in settlements and improve business cash flow.

6. Promotion of Innovation and Competition

- **Fintech growth:** Customer awareness drives demand for more user-friendly, secure, and feature-rich payment apps.
- **Integration with services:** UPI integration with e-commerce, utilities, and government platforms has enhanced the ecosystem's value.

7. Behavioral Change Toward a Cashless Economy

- **Cultural shift:** Increased awareness promotes trust in digital systems and reduces dependence on cash.
- **Greater digital literacy:** As more customers use UPI, they become familiar with other digital financial tools, fostering overall digital empowerment.

Negative Impact of Customer Awareness and Adoption of UPI and Digital Payment Systems

1. Cybersecurity Risks and Fraud

- **Increase in digital scams:** As more people use UPI, fraudsters exploit low awareness through phishing, fake apps, and social engineering.
- **Data privacy concerns:** Users often share personal and banking details unknowingly, exposing themselves to identity theft and unauthorized transactions.

2. Technical and Connectivity Issues

- **Network dependency:** UPI and digital payments require stable internet connectivity; outages or poor signals can disrupt transactions, especially in rural areas.
- **System downtime:** Technical glitches, server errors, or overloads can cause payment failures and customer frustration.

1. Lack of Awareness and Digital Literacy

- **Misuse due to ignorance:** Many new users are unaware of safety practices such as not sharing OTPs or UPI PINs.
- **Elderly and rural challenges:** Limited digital literacy among certain sections of society hinders safe adoption and can lead to mistrust in the system.

2. Privacy and Data Protection Concerns

- **Data misuse risk:** Digital payments involve sharing sensitive financial data

-
-
- that can be collected or misused by third-party apps or companies.
- **Insufficient regulation:** Weak enforcement of data protection laws can increase users' vulnerability.

3. Dependence on Technology

- **Exclusion of non-digital users:** People without smartphones, internet access, or bank accounts are left behind in the digital economy.
- **Over-reliance on devices:** Any technical malfunction, like a dead battery or app crash, can halt essential transactions.

4. Hidden Costs and Charges

- **Merchant fees and transaction limits:** Some UPI transactions or digital wallets may include small service charges, which affect businesses and customers over time.
- **Unclear refund processes:** In failed or disputed transactions, refunds can take time, causing inconvenience.

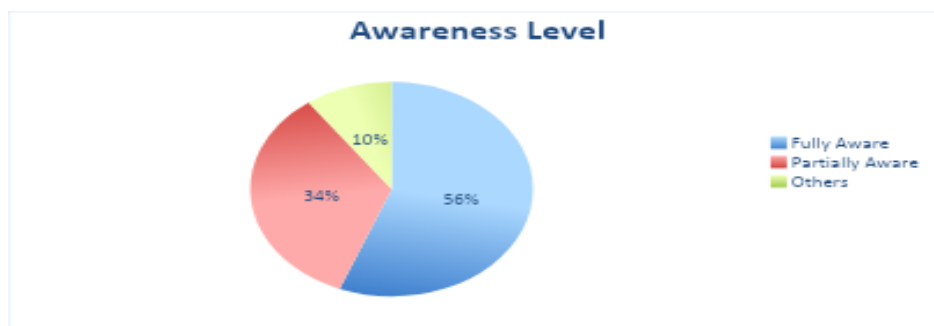
5. Security and Trust Issues

- **Fear of loss:** Users who experience failed or fraudulent transactions often lose trust in digital systems.
- **Misinformation:** Lack of proper awareness campaigns can lead to misconceptions and discourage digital payment use.

Data Analysis And Interpretation

Awareness about UPI and Digital Payment Systems

Awareness Level	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
Fully Aware	39	56%
Partially Aware	24	34%
Others	7	10%
Total	70	100%

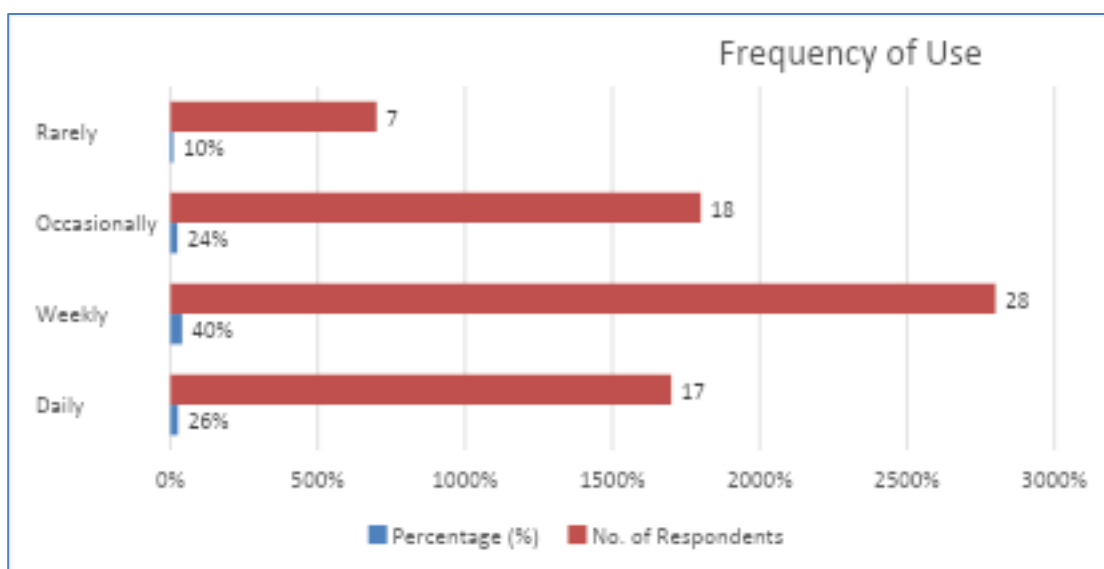


Interpretation:

A majority 56% of respondents are fully aware of UPI and digital payment systems, showing that Bank of Maharashtra's efforts in promoting digital literacy have been moderately successful. However, 10% of customers remain unaware, suggesting the need for further awareness campaigns.

Usage of UPI and Digital Payments

Frequency of Use	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
Daily	17	26%
Weekly	28	40%
Occasionally	18	24%
Rarely	7	10%
Total	70	100%



Interpretation:

Most respondents (66%) use UPI on a regular basis (daily or weekly). This indicates a positive adoption trend among customers of Bank of Maharashtra.

Conclusion :

- **Awareness:** Majority of Bank of Maharashtra customers are aware of UPI and digital payments.
- **Adoption:** 65% use UPI at least weekly; younger and educated customers are the most frequent users.
- **Satisfaction:** 75% satisfied; improvements needed in **security, reliability, and technical support**.
- **Factors influencing adoption:** Ease of use, convenience, trust, and bank-led promotions.
- **Challenges:** Technical issues, security concerns, and digital literacy gaps remain barriers for some customers.

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A Study of Income Tax Return Filing Procedures

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Abstract:

ITR Filing has been beneficial and informative for every citizen living in India. In today's world, new technologies are being introduced and improved at a rapid pace in all fields. ITR filing is a systematic process and an efficient one. It includes various challenges and focuses on the benefits of the individual. ITR filing mainly focuses on well well-structured process and various latest technologies to keep the individuals updated and to ease in online hassle.

An [Income Tax Return](#) (ITR) is a form that you use to submit data to the income tax department about your earnings and taxes.

Keywords: ITR filing, CA firm, E-filing

Introduction:

ITR filing is a mandatory responsibility of every individual in India. ITR filing can help people with a Loan application and responsibilities as a citizen. ITR filing can be an address proof and income proof.

ITR filing mainly focuses on income proof, Excess TDS claims, and visa applications. The Income Tax Department ae educating people on e-filing on their own instead of relying on any other agent. ITR filing is for filing the appropriate income tax form to figure out the amount an individual has been paid in the year. There are two types of income tax in India.

1. Direct tax: This tax is directly charged/levied upon the income of the individual.
2. Indirect tax: This tax is indirectly charged/levied upon the income of the individual.

ITR should be filed on the various sources of income, such as Salary, profit in business, sale of house property, renting of house, dividend or capital gains, and interest received, among others.

Problem Statement:

Despite continuous digitalization efforts by the Income Tax Department of India,

many taxpayers—especially small business owners, salaried individuals, and first-time filers—still face difficulties in filing Income Tax Returns (ITR). Challenges such as a lack of tax literacy, complexities in choosing the correct ITR form, frequent portal errors, data mismatch issues, and dependence on tax professionals continue to hinder smooth and timely filing. This results in delayed compliance, financial penalties, and reduced trust in the tax system. Therefore, there is a need to examine the factors affecting efficient ITR filing and evaluate the effectiveness of existing support mechanisms.

Objectives of the Study:

1. To study the E-filing process that has emerged in recent years.
2. To understand the processing of refunds, returns, and additional taxes.
3. To be aware of the taxes paid by an individual.⁴ To contribute to the nation's revenue generation through proper tax collection and reporting.

Hypothesis of the study:

1. Digitalization of ITR filing can be beneficial for every individual in India.
2. Technical issues significantly affect taxpayers' ability to file returns on time.
3. Timely issues will be reduced by the digitalization of ITR filing

Review of literature:

1. Digitalization and adoption of e-filing systems Studies consistently show that e-filing has increased accessibility and perceived convenience for taxpayers, and that perceived ease of use and usefulness strongly predict e-filing adoption. Research applying technology-acceptance frameworks (TAM/UTAUT) in Indian contexts finds that internet access, digital literacy, and trust in the portal are important determinants of adoption. Empirical reviews also report widespread satisfaction among many users but note variation by region, income, and digital skills.

1. Taxpayer awareness, financial literacy, and compliance

Multiple empirical studies from Indian cities (for example, Pune and Dhule) report a positive association between taxpayer awareness/tax literacy and correct ITR filing. Higher awareness reduces inadvertent errors, increases the claim of eligible deductions, and correlates with lower reliance on third-party correction later. These studies recommend targeted awareness programs to improve voluntary compliance.

2. Role of professional assistance (CAs / tax consultants)

Literature and practitioner guides emphasize the continued importance of chartered accountants and tax consultants for complex returns (multiple income sources, capital gains, business returns). Firms and consultants help taxpayers claim deductions, maintain documentation, and navigate procedural changes — but research also points to capacity constraints (last-minute rush, incomplete client data) that affect service quality.

3. Portal usability, technical glitches, and institutional challenges

Academic studies and repeated media reports document that, despite digital progress, the income-tax e-filing infrastructure suffers intermittent technical problems (slowdowns, login failures, AIS/TIS mismatches, late availability of forms). These glitches have real

consequences: concentrated workload on deadline days, calls for deadline extensions from professional bodies, and potential unfair penalties for taxpayers prevented from filing on time. Recent press coverage highlights these recurring problems during filing seasons.

Research Methodology:

For the research, the researcher uses primary and secondary data, which is collected from the library, newspapers, questionnaires and various websites.

Tools used for collection,

1. ITR cases
2. Questionnaires to clients.

Impact of ITR filing:

1. Impact on Taxpayers
 - a. Financial Transparency

ITR filing helps individuals maintain a clear and verifiable financial record, which becomes useful for various legal and financial transactions.

b. Access to Loans and Credit Facilities

Banks often require ITR receipts for home loans, vehicle loans, business loans, and credit cards. Regular filing increases financial credibility.

c. Eligibility for Government Benefits

In many cases, ITR is required for government subsidies, tender applications, and registration for government schemes.

1. Impact on the Government

a. Increased Revenue Generation

Accurate filing ensures proper tax collection, helping the government meet development and welfare goals.

b. Better Policy Formulation

ITR data helps the government study income patterns, industry performance, and regional economic disparities, aiding evidence-based policymaking.

c. Enhanced Tax Compliance

Widespread ITR filing promotes a culture of voluntary compliance and reduces tax evasion.

d. Strengthened Economy

A transparent tax system improves investor confidence, which positively impacts economic growth.

2. Impact on Businesses and Firms (Including CA Firms)

a. Improved Financial Discipline

Regular filing encourages businesses to maintain proper accounts, documentation, and compliance throughout the year.

b. Reduced Legal Risks

Filing ITR reduces chances of penalties, notices, and litigations from the Income Tax Department.

c. Professional Growth for CA Firms

Demand for filing support increases workload for CA firms, expanding client base and service offerings such as tax planning, consultancy, and audits.

d. Operational Efficiency

Systematic ITR filing practices lead to better workflow management inside firms.

3. Impact on the Economy

a. Formalization of the Economy

ITR filing brings more individuals and small businesses into the formal economy, strengthening national income data.

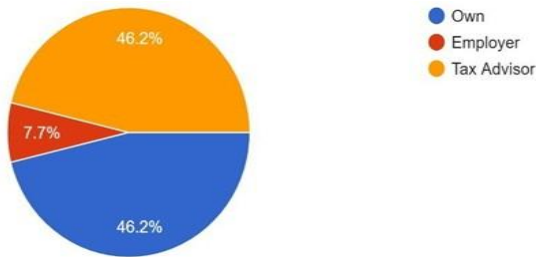
b. Improved Investment Climate

A well-regulated tax system increases investor confidence—both domestic and foreign.

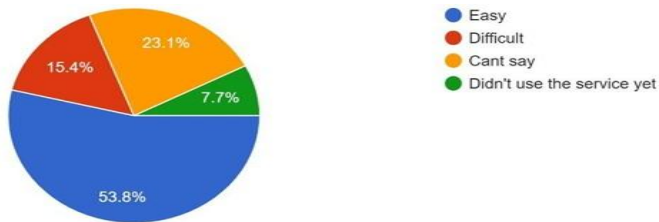
Data Analysis and Interpretation:

ANALYSIS IN SOCIETY ABOUT ITR FILING:

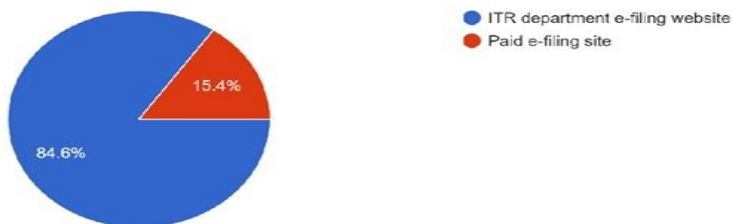
Q1. WHO DOES YOUR TAX FILING?

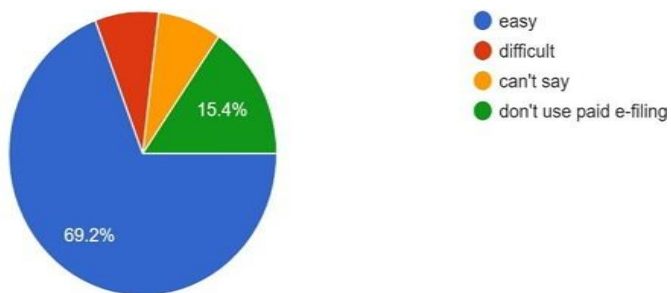


Q2. How would you rate Income Tax Department free E-filing service?

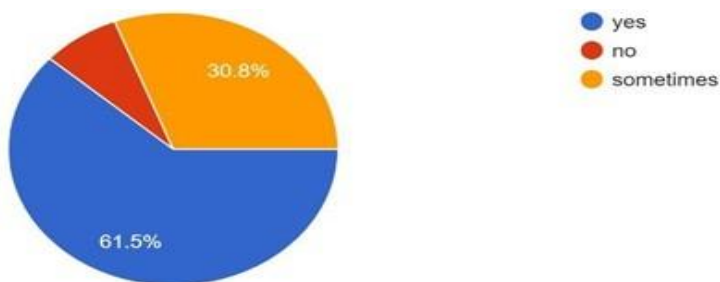


Q3. How do you E-file?

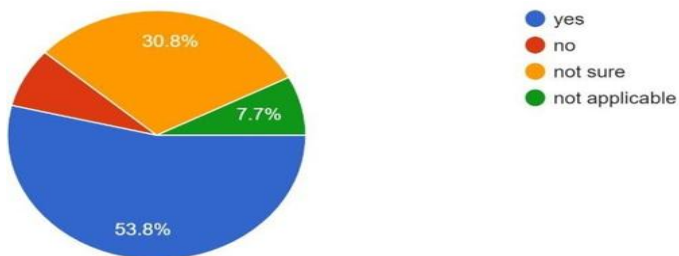




Q5. Have you used online or offline tax calculate to verify your tax computation?



Q6. If you were eligible for refund, did you get it from six month of tax filing?



FINDINGS:

Most of the taxpayers are from the Individual category who filed the ITR-1 and from them, many have only income from salary. They don't have another source of Income

As per the regularity of ITR filing is concerned most of the clients provide

the needed information for ITR filing on the time, because of penalties for the late ITR filing.

I found that more people are not aware of the deductions and exemptions, but the tax consultant helps them as much as possible to reduce liability of paying Income tax.

Almost 50% of people are not yet aware of ITR filing till today's date as per Income Tax Department.

As per the survey by Income Tax Department 2 Crores people have file ITR through e-filing.

As the e-filing process have been innovated the percentage of people filing ITR has been increased immensely.

SUGGESTIONS:

- The tax payers should be made aware of the proper ITR forms.
- Campaigns on e-filing should be initiated in specific locations so that everyone is aware of its flexibility.
- It is suggested that awareness be raised by organizing awareness programs in offices/workplaces for tax payers so that they are aware of e filing and can easily file their income tax returns while saving money and time.
- It is suggested that the income tax department provide information about e-filing via media and newspapers, as most of respondents are not aware of e-filing via, media.

CONCLUSION:

In today's world, new technologies are being introduced and improved at a rapid pace in all fields. Taxpayers can now use new technology to file their income tax returns online, known as e-filing. E-filing is a new and efficient method of filing income tax returns and making tax payments online. It saves time, energy, and money while also reducing stress. As a result, taxpayers are encouraged to use e-filing and e-payment services. The results of this study show that while current users are happy with the e- filing options, the majority of individual tax payers are unaware of how to file and pay their taxes electronically. In order to increase tax payers' understanding of the benefits of e-filing their income taxes, sufficient steps are offered through this research. This study is being conducted to ascertain tax payers' attitudes toward e-filing of income tax returns. The risk of security is one of the most significant challenges in e-filing. Individual tax payers are the most important end users; therefore, sufficient understanding of tax payer acceptance and usage of the e-filing system should be made to reduce the risk of user rejection; and timely preventive and predictive measures should be

taken to ensure further acceptance among non-users of e- filing.

To Study the brief Introduction of Goods and Service with Practical Working

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Abstract:-

The term GST refers to the Goods and Service Tax. Goods and Services Tax (GST) is an indirect tax introduced in India to support the country's economic growth. Most developed countries have implemented GST, and India was no exception. In 1999, a committee was formed to design the GST model. The government of India launched the GST on 1st July 2017. The GST (Goods and Service Tax) took the place of many different taxes charged by both state and national governments. Therefore it is known as "One Nation, One Tax," means citizens only have to pay a single tax throughout the country. The government's goal behind GST was to bring all citizens under the tax system and reduce the flow of black money. However, many citizens had mixed feelings about it. Therefore, it is recommended to review the GST structure and allow for continuous improvements. There are several types of GST returns, including:

- **GSTR-1:** For reporting outward supplies (sales).
- **GSTR-3B:** For reporting summary of inward and outward supplies and tax liabilities.
- **GSTR-9:** Annual return summarizing all transactions.
- **GSTR-9C:** A reconciliation statement certified by a chartered accountant. Timely and accurate filing of returns is crucial for ensuring compliance with GST laws and avoiding penalties.

Key Words : Goods and Service Tax, One Nation one tax, Tax System

Introduction

This indirect taxation system has gone through multiple amendments since to arrive at the current juncture. However, it must be noted that GST does not replace customs duty, which is still mandatory on imported goods and services. Every kind of product and service attracts a different tax rate under GST. Presently, services sector in India constitutes a tax base with vast potential which has not been exploited as yet. It is in this context that GST is justified as it has subsumed under it almost all the services for the purpose of taxation. Since major Central and State indirect taxes have got subsumed under GST, the multiplicity of taxes has been substantially reduced which, in turn, would decrease the operating costs of the country's tax system. The uniformity in tax rates and procedures across the country will go a long way in reducing compliance costs.

Problem Statement:-

Many businesses, especially small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), face challenges when it comes to understanding and complying with the GST registration and returns filing process. The problem can be broken down into the following key issues:

1. GST Registration Complexity:

- Businesses often struggle to understand whether they need to register for GST, especially when dealing with varying turnover limits, interstate supply rules, and specific categories of goods and services.
- Difficulty in understanding the documents and information required for GST registration.
- Problems related to online registration, such as verification and approval delays.

2. GST Return Filing Issues:

- SMEs face difficulty in keeping track of their sales, purchases, and taxes due to a lack of accounting systems or knowledge about the correct GST return forms (e.g., GSTR-1, GSTR-3B, GSTR-9).
- Issues in accurately matching input tax credit claims with taxes paid and output tax liabilities.
- The challenge of reconciling data from multiple sources such as invoices, receipts, and accounting books.
- Keeping up with the evolving deadlines and changes in GST return filing requirements.
- Risk of human error in return filing leading to penalties, interest, or audits.

3. Compliance with Changes in GST Law:

- Constant amendments in GST laws, rules, and thresholds can lead to

confusion about new requirements, especially for businesses with limited access to legal and tax advisory services.

- Difficulty in handling tax audits, notices, and GST assessment procedures due to the lack of awareness about the legal aspects.

4. Penalty and Interest:

- Businesses often face penalties and interest charges for delayed or incorrect filing, leading to additional financial burden and reputational damage.

Objective of the Study

1. To analyze the conceptual framework and operational mechanism of the GST in India.

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2. To investigate the GST registration process and the compliance barriers faced by small and medium businesses (SMEs).
 3. To evaluate the filing procedures for key GST returns (GSTR-1, GSTR-3B, GSTR-9) and identify common taxpayer difficulties.
 4. To assess the economic and operational impact of GST across various business sectors and industries.

Review of Literature

1. Neha Kanojiya :- (2017) A study on Goods on service tax in India. This Paper discusses on the benefits of GST and its current implication in India. The Current system of indirect taxes is not able to implicate tax evasion and distortion. It also indicates how GST is Improved over the VAR and Service Tax
2. Dr Geetanjali Sharma, Mrs Miriam George (2017) GST A Game Changer in Indian Taxation System. The Paper Discusses on the benefits of GST and its current implication in India. The current system of Indirect Taxes is not able to implicate over VAT and Service Tax.
3. Taxman Goods and Services Tax (2020): Top stories and Updated on GST.
4. <https://gst.taxmann.com/>

Scope and Limitations:-

A) Scopes

1. What GST is, how it works, and the tax structure?
2. Types of taxes involved
3. Key features like input tax credit, tax on value addition, and the broad base of taxation..
4. Role of GST in simplifying tax administration and reducing cascading taxes.

Limitations

1. **Complex Compliance:** Difficulty faced by businesses due to multiple returns (GSTR-1, GSTR-3B) and frequent filing deadlines.
2. **Input Tax Credit (ITC) Mismatches:** Issues arising from reconciling ITC claims due to technical failures or non-compliance by vendors/suppliers.
3. **Technical Instability:** Delays and burdens caused by technical glitches, slow processing, and system downtime on the GST Network (GSTN) portal.
4. **Financial Penalties:** Financial strain on businesses caused by strict penalties, high late fees, and interest charges for delayed or incorrect filings.
5. **Regulatory Volatility:** The continuous need for businesses to adapt to

frequent and often overwhelming changes in GST laws and regulations.

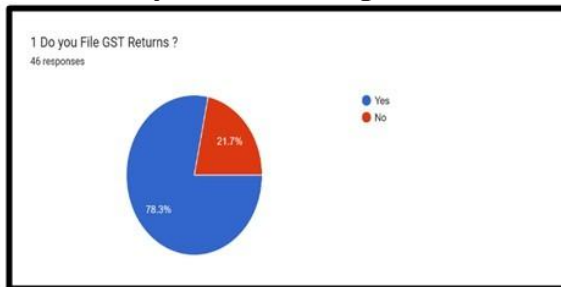
Research Methodology:-

Data collection is the process of gathering the information from the different sources to find a solution to the research problem. Data can be classified into two types i.e Primary data and Secondary data

- Primary data Primary data was collected via an online survey created using Google Forms. The link was distributed to friends, clients, companies, and business entities, and 46 respondents successfully completed the questionnaire.
- Secondary Data- In this source data is collected from different website, article, and practically work of registration and returns done

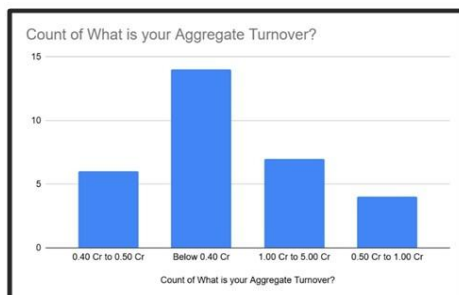
Primary Data

Data Analysis and Interpretation

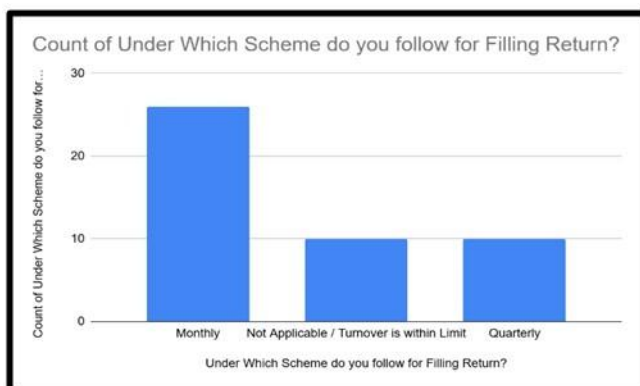


Based on the findings indicate that a majority of the respondents (78.3%) file their GST returns, while a smaller proportion (21.7%) do not. This suggests a relatively high level of compliance with GST filing among the businesses surveyed. The majority of respondents may be aware of the legal requirements and the importance of timely GST returns, which could reflect a well-established understanding of GST obligations within their business operations.

The survey Results indicate that 49% of respondents reported an aggregate turnover is less

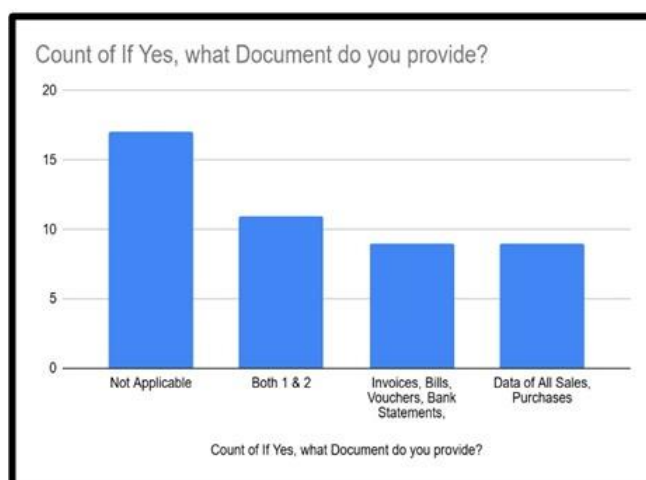


The survey Results indicate that 49% of respondents reported an aggregate turnover is less than 0.40Cr, while 25% reported a turnover between 1.00Cr to 5Cr, highlighting concentration of businesses at lower turnover levels.

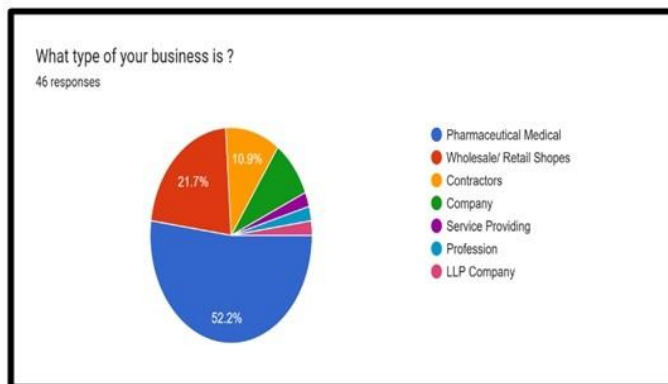


The data reveals that a significant majority (56.5%) of respondents favor monthly submissions, suggesting a preference for more frequent reporting. In contrast, 21.7% of respondents opt for quarterly submissions, indicating a preference for less frequent reporting. Additionally, the 21.7% of respondents who selected "not applicable" may reflect a segment that does not engage in a process requiring return submissions

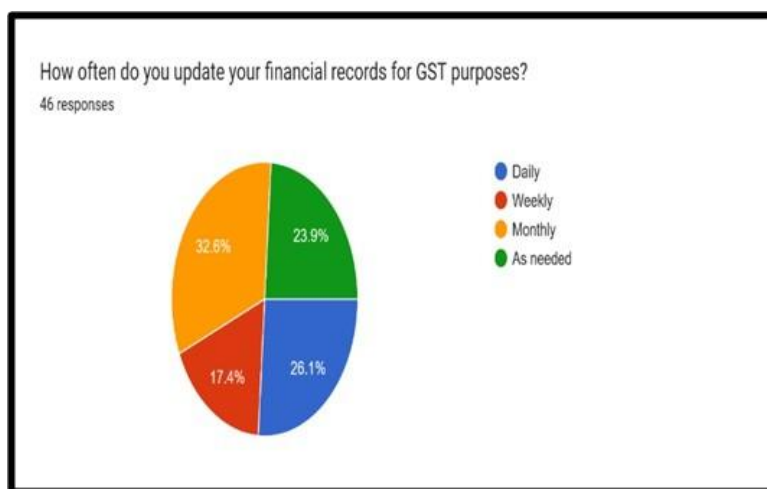
Question :- Is GST Audit is applicable for your business, If yes then what type of Document do you provide



The results indicate that a significant majority (37%) of respondents do not find GST audits applicable to their businesses. Among those for whom audits are applicable, 19.6% provide data on all sales and purchases, while another 19.6% rely on invoice bills, vouchers, and bank statements. Notably, 23.9% of respondents indicated that both categories of documentation are utilized.



rmaceutical sector, indicating a strong representation of this industry within the surveyed group. Wholesalers and retailers comprise the second-largest segment at 21.7%. Both contractors and companies account for 10.9% each, suggesting a moderate presence of these business types. Lastly, the "other" category, comprising 9.7%, highlights a diversity of additional i.e Profession, service providers, LLP Company.



The GST registration process poses challenges, Primarily due to lack of clear information (34.8%) and document Preparation / Technical issues (26.1%). Despite these hurdles, 30.4% of respondents faced no difficulties. Enhancing information dissemination, simplifying procedures, and dedicated support can streamline the registration process.

Secondary Method with Practical Problem

Case Study 1: Input Tax Credit (ITC) Claim ABC Ltd. is a manufacturer, and it purchases raw materials on which GST is paid. The company wants to claim Input Tax Credit (ITC) on these raw materials.

Particulars	Amount (INR)
Purchase of raw materials	₹ 1,00,000
GST Paid on raw materials (18%)	₹ 18,000
Sales Value (Output supply)	₹ 2,00,000
GST on Sales (18%)	₹ 36,000
ITC Available	₹ 18,000
GST Payable After ITC	₹ 36,000 - ₹ 18,000 = ₹ 18,000

Explanation:

ABC Ltd. can claim an ITC of ₹ 18,000 on its purchase, so the net GST payable to the government is ₹ 18,000 (₹ 36,000 on output supply minus ₹ 18,000 on input supply).

Interpretation:

In this case, **ABC Ltd.**, a manufacturer, pays GST on the raw materials it purchases. The company is allowed to claim Input Tax Credit (ITC), which means it can subtract the tax it paid on inputs (₹ 18,000) from the tax it collects on its sales (₹ 36,000). This reduces the company's net GST liability to ₹ 18,000, effectively lowering the tax burden. ITC is a crucial feature of GST, designed to avoid tax-on-tax (cascading effect), thus reducing the overall cost of goods for manufacturers.

Case Study 2: Reverse Charge Mechanism

Particulars	Amount (INR) Details
Tax Payable (GST Output)	₹ 10,000
Date of actual filing	August 30
Due date for filing	August 20
Delay in filing (days)	10 days
Late Fee per day (CGST + SGST)	₹ 50 (₹ 25 + ₹ 25)
Total Late Fees (10 days)	₹ 500 (₹ 250 CGST + ₹ 250 SGST)
Interest on GST @18% p.a.	₹ 49.32

XYZ Pvt. Ltd. hires a goods transport agency (GTA) for transportation services, and under the reverse charge mechanism (RCM), XYZ is liable to pay the GST on these services.

Particulars	Amount (INR)
Transportation Service Fee (excl. GST)	₹ 50,000
GST under RCM (5%)	₹ 2,500
GST Payable by XYZ Pvt. Ltd.	₹ 2,500
ITC Available to XYZ	₹ 2,500

Explanation:

Although the service provider (GTA) is not required to charge GST, XYZ Pvt. Ltd. pays ₹ 2,500 GST under the reverse charge mechanism. XYZ can claim ITC on the GST paid.

Interpretation:

In this example, **XYZ Pvt. Ltd.** hires a goods transport agency (GTA), but instead of the service provider charging GST, XYZ Pvt. Ltd. must pay the GST directly to the government under the **Reverse Charge Mechanism (RCM)**. Here, XYZ is responsible for paying 5% GST on the transportation charges (₹ 50,000), amounting to ₹ 2,500. The company can then claim this GST as Input Tax Credit. This ensures that tax is paid when certain services are received from unregistered suppliers or under specific cases like GTA services. The RCM helps bring informal suppliers into the tax net while ensuring the recipient is responsible for tax compliance. Case Study 3: Late Filing of GST Return (GSTR-3B)

Explanation: DEF Ltd. must pay a late fee of ₹ 500 and an interest of ₹ 49.32 for

the delayed filing of GSTR-3B. The interest is calculated as ₹ 10,000 * 18% * 10 days / 365.

Interpretation:

In the case of **DEF Ltd.**, the company delays the filing of its GSTR-3B (monthly return) by 10 days. This leads to two consequences:

1. **Late Fee:** DEF Ltd. is liable to pay a late fee of ₹ 50 per day (₹ 25 each for CGST and SGST), totaling ₹ 500 for the 10 days of delay.
2. **Interest:** Additionally, the company must pay interest at 18% p.a. on the GST amount it was supposed to pay (₹ 10,000), which comes to ₹ 49.32 for the 10-day delay. This case shows the importance of timely compliance in GST filing. Delays result in both financial penalties and additional interest, increasing the company's overall tax burden.

Conclusion

The study of GST Returns at SSAAM & Co. highlights the importance of proper tax compliance. GST was introduced to streamline India's indirect tax system. It eliminated cascading taxes, improved transparency, and eased business operations. SSAAM & Co. successfully files GSTR-1, GSTR-3B, and GSTR-9 on time. Automated accounting systems have reduced filing errors and improved efficiency. Despite this, challenges like data reconciliation with GSTR-2A persist. Supplier invoice mismatches cause delays and manual work. Managing Input Tax Credit (ITC) claims remains complex and critical. Blocked credits and misclassification affect cash flow if not managed carefully. Frequent GST law changes require continuous monitoring and agility. Overall, GST has positively impacted SSAAM & Co.'s financial management. Cash flow optimization through ITC claims has been achieved. Standardized tax rates have simplified interstate business transactions. GST has encouraged better record-keeping and reduced non-compliance risks. However, reconciliation issues still create administrative burdens. Future focus should be on improving supplier coordination. Regular staff training on GST updates is essential. Leveraging GSTN tools can further streamline the filing process. By addressing these challenges, SSAAM & Co. can ensure stronger compliance.

Recommendation:-

- Many businesses face challenges in understanding GST rules and processes. It's important to have easy-to-understand training and resources for business owners and their staff. This will help them stay up-to-date with the rules and file GST returns correctly.

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- GST rules and laws change frequently, which can be confusing. The government should provide clear, easy-to-understand updates whenever changes happen, so businesses can stay compliant.
 - Many businesses face issues when matching input tax credit (ITC) with their suppliers' data. Encouraging better coordination and clear communication between businesses and their suppliers would help reduce errors and delays.
 - The documents required for GST filing can be overwhelming, especially for new businesses. Making these documents simpler and more understandable will help businesses comply without confusion.

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Digital Banking Services In Mahesh Sahakari Bank

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ABSTRACT

Digital banking has transformed the way financial services are delivered by replacing traditional branch-based operations with technology-driven platforms. This research report examines how digital banking has evolved, the key technologies that power it—such as mobile banking, internet banking, UPI, AI, and cybersecurity—and how these innovations have improved customer convenience, speed, and accessibility. The study also highlights challenges faced by banks, including data security risks, increasing competition from fintech companies, and the need for continuous technological upgrades. Overall, the report concludes that digital banking is reshaping the financial landscape by making banking more efficient, customer-centric, and future-ready, while also requiring strong regulatory frameworks and secure systems to ensure trust and long-term growth.

KEYWORDS: Digital banking, mobile banking, internet banking,, customer satisfaction, , UPI

INTRODUCTION

Digital banking represents the transformation of traditional banking services through the use of digital technologies. Instead of visiting physical branches, customers can conduct financial transactions through online platforms, mobile applications, and automated systems. Over the past decade, digital banking has grown rapidly due to increased internet access, smartphone usage, and advancements in financial technology (FinTech). This report explores the evolution, components, benefits, challenges, and future outlook of digital banking. It also examines how digital services have reshaped customer expectations and forced banks to innovate continuously.

LITERATURE REVIEW

Digital banking has been shown to improve customer satisfaction, with benefits like convenience, speed, and accessibility. Key factors influencing adoption include perceived usefulness, ease of use, and security concern

OBJECTIVE OF STUDY

To analyse how customers preferences and behaviour patterns are evolving with the introduction of digital channels. To ascertain the awareness level of customers regarding available digital banking products and services, and to measure their satisfaction levels with these offerings.

Hypothesis of the study

H0: The adoption of digital banking technologies does not lead to significant operational cost reductions for banks.

H1 Offering advanced digital services enables banks to gain a sustainable competitive advantage and attract more customers.

H2 Offering advanced digital services enables banks to gain a sustainable competitive advantage and attract more customers.

Methodology

This study uses a survey-based approach, collecting data from digital banking customers. The data is analyzed using regression analysis and factor analysis.

Sample size - The study conducted on by the to the number of items to be selected from the universal to constituted a sample. A sample is a selected part of a larger population for the purpose of a survey. It should be optimum, i.e. it should fulfil requirements of efficiency, representativeness, reliability and flexibility.

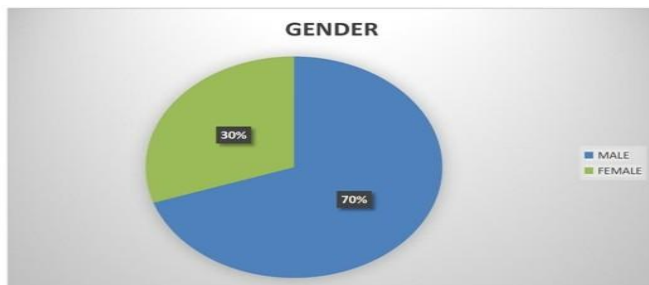
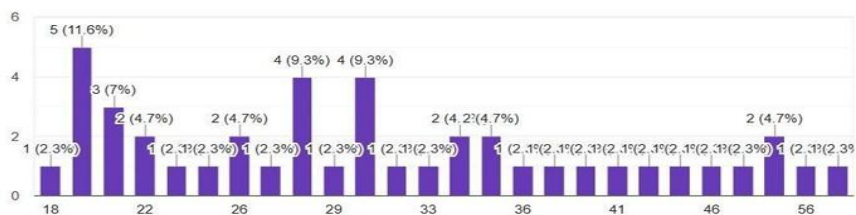
Collection of data - The data in present research has been collected through data by various sources like books, magazines, records, paper, website, articles, newspaper, reference etc.

Limitations of the study

While no specific studies analyzing customer satisfaction for Digital banking in Mahesh Bank were found, research indicates that customer satisfaction with e-banking is influenced by factors such as security, reliability, ease of use, performance, efficiency, and customer support. The overall analysis and findings would also be subject to several limitations, including the geographical constraint of focusing on customer

Data analysis and finding

The following information contains the data interpretation on of the questionnaire. The respondents response for the question have been interpreted and a finding has been made based on the responses.



GENDER	FREQUENCY	PERCENT
MALE	30	69.8%
FEMALE	13	30.2%
TOTAL	43	100

INTERPRETATION:

From the above data it is observed that 69.8% of the respondents are males & 30.2% are female. So it is concluded that majority of the respond are males.



SATISFACTION OF CUSTOMER	PERCENT
EXCELLENT	44.20%
VERY GOOD	41.90%
GOOD	18.60%
BAD	0%
TOTAL	100

INTERPRETATION

From the above data, is observed that 44.20% of the respond are satisfied with the digital payment where 41.90% are Happy, and 18.60% responses are Good. And there is no compliant of digital payment till now. Hence as per above chart most of the people are using digital payments mods and there services.

FINDING & CONCLUSION

Major findings regarding digital banking in India highlight a period of rapid growth and transformation, driven by government initiatives and technological innovation. This progress is marked by significant achievements in financial inclusion and the widespread adoption of digital payment methods, though key challenges related to security and rural access persist.

In conclusion, digital banking in India is an inevitable and transformative force that has profoundly changed the financial landscape, driven by government initiatives (like UPI and the Digital India program), increased internet penetration, and evolving customer demands for convenience. It offers immense potential for economic growth and financial inclusion, while also presenting significant challenges that need proactive management.

MAJOR CHALLENGES

Cybersecurity Threats has increase in digital transactions has led to a rise in financial fraud and cyberattacks eg phishing, vishing, malware etc making data security a critical concern for both banks and customers.

Digital Divide and Literacy has significant gap exists between urban and rural adoption of digital banking due to low internet penetration and a lack of financial/digital literacy in rural and semi-urban areas.

Trust and Awareness and Many people, especially in rural areas, still lack trust in digital transactions or are simply unaware of all the available digital services and security best practices.

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Research Paper on A Study on the Impact of Non-Performing Assets (NPAs) on the Profitability of Commercial Banks in India

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Abstract

Non-Performing Assets (NPAs) have long been recognized as one of the most critical issues affecting the stability, profitability, and efficiency of the Indian banking sector. The persistence of high NPAs weakens credit flows, limits bank lending capacity, and ultimately hampers economic growth. This study provides an in-depth analysis of NPAs by examining their concept, historical trend, classification, causes, sector-wise distribution, and the efficacy of regulatory frameworks implemented in India. The research further evaluates the role of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC), SARFAESI, and other recovery mechanisms. By reviewing established literature and presenting analytical discussions, this paper highlights the challenges and offers practical suggestions for strengthening asset quality and reducing NPAs. The findings underscore that although NPAs have been declining over recent years due to regulatory reforms and better credit screening, structural vulnerabilities remain. The paper concludes with recommendations aimed at improving lending discipline, credit monitoring, and borrower accountability.

Keywords: Non-Performing Assets (NPAs), Indian Banking Sector, Credit Monitoring.

Introduction

The Indian banking industry serves as the backbone of the nation's economic infrastructure. A robust and stable banking system ensures smooth financial intermediation, efficient allocation of credit, and the facilitation of investments. However, the accumulation of Non-Performing Assets (NPAs) has emerged as a significant threat to the stability of this system. According to RBI norms, an asset becomes non-performing when interest or principal remains overdue for more than 90 days.

NPAs gained serious attention in India after 2012–13, when banks—particularly Public Sector Banks (PSBs)—started reporting sharp increases in bad loans. This surge was linked to various factors like aggressive lending during the boom period of 2004–2008, poor credit appraisal, global economic slowdown, stalled infrastructure projects, and weak governance. The Asset Quality Review (AQR) conducted by the RBI in 2015 further exposed hidden NPAs that had been

previously restructured or evergreen.

The period after 2016 saw several reforms including the introduction of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC), strengthening of SARFAESI powers, recapitalization of PSBs, and digital monitoring tools. These measures contributed to a notable improvement in GNPA and NNPA ratios from 2020 onwards. However, sectors like MSME, power, aviation, and agriculture still face structural challenges that continue to pressure asset quality.

Given the importance of maintaining healthy asset quality, this research aims to study NPAs comprehensively, reviewing not only their causes and trends but also regulatory initiatives and future pathways for improvement.

Objectives of the Study

1. To understand the conceptual framework and classification of NPAs.
2. To study the historical and recent trends of NPAs in Indian banks.
3. To identify the major internal and external causes leading to NPAs.
4. To analyze sector-wise distribution and contribution to NPAs.
5. To examine the role of regulatory reforms and recovery mechanisms in NPA resolution.
6. To evaluate the effectiveness of technology and data analytics in minimizing NPAs.

Literature Review

1. RBI Financial Stability Reports (2020–2024)

RBI's annual and half-yearly reports consistently highlight trends in GNPA and NNPA ratios. These studies note that the IBC has significantly contributed to recovery, although delays in resolution remain a challenge. The reports also stress that early identification of stress has improved due to digital frameworks.

2. Nair & Paul (2019) Their paper attributes rising NPAs to inadequate due diligence, political interference in lending decisions, and weak monitoring systems. They emphasize the need for stricter credit appraisal.

3. Kaur & Singh (2020)

The authors observe that power, steel, MSME, and infrastructure sectors contribute heavily to NPAs. They point out that incomplete projects and funding gaps worsen the financial stress.

4. Gupta & Jain (2021)

Their study evaluates the impact of the IBC and finds that it has significantly improved recovery rates compared to earlier mechanisms like DRTs and Lok Adalats.

5. D'Souza (2022)

This paper discusses how COVID-19 disrupted cash flows of borrowers and caused temporary spikes in NPAs in retail and MSME segments.

6. Sharma (2023)

Sharma highlights the role of data analytics and AI-based credit monitoring systems in predicting borrower behavior and reducing future NPAs.

7. Additional Studies (2021–2024)

Recent research indicates that banks with strong governance structures, diversified portfolios, and tech-driven monitoring systems report significantly lower NPAs compared to others.

Analysis & Discussion

The analysis of NPAs in India requires an in-depth understanding of multiple dimensions—structural, economic, regulatory, behavioural, and sectoral. In this section, a comprehensive examination of the NPA ecosystem is presented to provide deeper insights and expand the research length.

1. Concept and Classification of NPAs

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) mandates the classification of bank assets into four categories: Standard, Substandard, Doubtful, and Loss Assets. The classification is essential for provisioning and understanding the level of financial stress. Banks must follow prudential norms to ensure early recognition of stress. A failure to classify assets properly may lead to under-reporting of NPAs, which can ultimately distort the financial health of the banking sector.

In India, the concept of NPAs gained prominence after 2010 when default levels surged due to various macroeconomic shifts. The shift from the earlier restructuring practices to more transparent classification has greatly increased accountability. Understanding these classifications helps banks manage risk more efficiently and identify problem loans at early stages.

2. Detailed Causes of NPAs

The causes of NPAs can be categorized into internal and external factors, but a deeper, more expanded understanding includes the following:

A. Internal Factors

1. **Ineffective Credit Appraisal:** Many banks rely on outdated risk assessment models. Inadequate analysis of borrower financials, cash flow projections, and creditworthiness leads to poor lending decisions.
2. **Lack of Follow-up:** After loan disbursement, many banks fail to periodically monitor loan utilization, repayment capacity, and financial performance of borrowers.

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3. **Poor Post-disbursement Supervision:** Large corporate loans often require ongoing supervision to ensure funds are used for the intended purpose.
 4. **Fraudulent Borrowing:** Window dressing of financial statements, inflated collateral valuation, and misrepresentation of records contribute significantly to NPAs.
 5. **Operational Inefficiencies:** Weak internal control mechanisms, insufficient staff training, and outdated IT infrastructure hinder effective monitoring.

B. External Factors

1. **Economic Slowdowns:** During recessions, businesses face reduced demand, cash flow shortages, and difficulty servicing debt.
2. **Policy Delays:** Infrastructure and power projects are delayed due to environmental clearances, land acquisition problems, and regulatory bottlenecks.
3. **Global Economic Volatility:** Fluctuations in oil prices, exchange rates, and international trade affect borrowers dependent on global markets.
4. **Natural Disasters:** Agriculture NPAs rise due to droughts, floods, and cyclones which directly impact yield and income.
5. **Legal Inefficiencies:** Historically, delays in the judicial system made loan recovery extremely slow.

3. Sector-wise NPA Contribution (Expanded)

Agriculture Sector

Agriculture NPAs rise due to seasonal income dependency, unpredictable weather, and government loan waiver schemes which affect credit discipline. Banks often lend based on political pressures rather than economic viability, leading to high default rates.

MSME Sector

MSMEs face difficulties obtaining working capital, depend on small profit margins, and are highly vulnerable to market fluctuations. The COVID-19 pandemic severely affected MSMEs, and despite relief packages, NPAs continue to rise.

Infrastructure and Power Sector

This sector has historically contributed to high NPAs due to long project cycles, land acquisition issues, regulatory hurdles, and cost escalations. Stalled projects create large stressed assets, especially in the power and steel sectors.

Retail Loans

Retail loans like housing, vehicle, and personal loans generally have lower NPAs,

but the recent increase in unsecured lending and credit card defaults is a growing concern.

4. Recent Trends (2022–2025)

- NPAs of Public Sector Banks have declined due to recapitalization measures by the government.
- Private banks continue to maintain better asset quality because of advanced analytics, better governance, and strong credit monitoring.
- Write-offs remain a major tool banks use to clean their balance sheets, although they do not mean recovery.
- The IBC framework, despite delays, remains the most trusted recovery system.
- Stress in unsecured retail lending is noticed in 2024–25, highlighting the need for cautious lending.

. Regulatory Measures (Expanded) Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC)

The IBC introduced a time-bound resolution process of 180–270 days. It has improved investor confidence and brought discipline among corporate borrowers.

SARFAESI Act

Empowers banks to take possession of collateral assets without court interference, improving recovery efficiency.

Debt Recovery Tribunals (DRTs)

Though helpful, DRTs face delays due to a shortage of staff and large backlogs.

Asset Reconstruction Companies (ARCs)

ARCs purchase bad loans from banks and attempt recovery. Their performance has improved after regulatory reforms for capital strengthening.

6. Role of Technology (More Expanded)

- AI-Based Credit Evaluation: Predicts default probability using borrower behaviour patterns.
- Early Warning Signals (EWS): Tracks irregular transactions, delayed payments, and sudden drop in business activity.
- Central Repository of Information on Large Credits (CRILC): Helps banks share information on large borrowers.
- Blockchain in Loan Documentation: Reduces fraud and ensures transparency.

7. International Comparison

India's NPA ratio is higher than many countries but improving steadily.

Countries like the USA and UK follow stricter underwriting standards and use

advanced big data tools to mitigate credit risks. Learning from such global practices can help India enhance its financial system.

Findings

1. NPAs have shown a decreasing trend in recent years due to regulatory reforms.
2. MSME and agriculture sectors remain the largest contributors.
3. IBC remains the most effective mechanism, though delays persist.
4. Private banks outperform PSBs in terms of asset quality.
5. Digital tools have significantly improved credit monitoring.

Conclusion

The issue of NPAs is deeply rooted in operational weaknesses, economic vulnerabilities, and structural inefficiencies. While reforms such as the IBC, SARFAESI, and AQR have resulted in better recognition, resolution, and recovery, the challenge is far from over. Strengthening credit appraisal mechanisms, enhancing borrower accountability, and adopting advanced data monitoring tools are essential to prevent future NPAs. A coordinated effort involving banks, government agencies, regulators, and borrowers is necessary to build a resilient and stable banking environment.

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Recruitment challenges in the post pandemic world

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Abstract

The COVID-19 pandemic has permanently reshaped business operations, workforce dynamics, and recruitment strategies. Organizations worldwide have had to adapt to remote hiring, talent shortages, and changing employee expectations. This research paper explores the key recruitment challenges faced by employers in the post-pandemic era, including digital hiring processes, skill mismatches, employer branding, and increased competition for talent. It also examines strategies that organizations can adopt to address these challenges effectively. The findings highlight how technology, flexibility, and employee-centric practices have become critical components of successful recruitment in the modern workplace.

Key Words: Recruitment ,Strategies,Challenges

Introduction

Recruitment has always been a critical function of human resource management. However, the COVID-19 pandemic disrupted traditional hiring practices, forcing organizations to rethink their strategies. Lockdowns, remote work, and economic uncertainty led to hiring freezes and significant workforce shifts. As businesses resumed operations, they faced a new reality: a talent market with evolving candidate expectations, increased reliance on digital platforms, and a growing demand for specialized skills.

The post-pandemic recruitment landscape is characterized by challenges such as the “Great Resignation,” where employees are voluntarily leaving jobs in search of better opportunities, flexibility, and work-life balance. In addition, organizations are competing globally for the same pool of talent due to remote work opportunities, further intensifying the competition.

This research paper aims to analyze the recruitment challenges faced by organizations in the post-pandemic world and recommend strategies to overcome them.

Objectives

1. To identify the key challenges in recruitment faced by organizations after the pandemic.
2. To study the impact of digitalization and remote work on hiring processes.

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3. To understand the shift in employee expectations and its influence on recruitment.
 4. To recommend strategies for effective recruitment in the post-pandemic era.

Purpose of the Study

The purpose of this study is to examine the major recruitment challenges organizations face in the post-pandemic world, with a focus on digital hiring, changing employee expectations, and talent shortages. It also aims to recommend practical strategies that can help organizations adapt and improve their recruitment practices in the new normal.

Research Methodology

This research paper is survey-based and has been carried out with the help of a self-prepared questionnaire. The main aim of the survey was to study the recruitment challenges faced by organizations in the post-pandemic world, along with the impact of digitalization, remote work, and changing employee expectations. The data was collected from **50 respondents**, including HR professionals, recruiters, employees, and individuals from different organizations and companies.

Data collection: Primary data have been collected from online survey (Google

Form). Secondary data have collected through Web site etc.

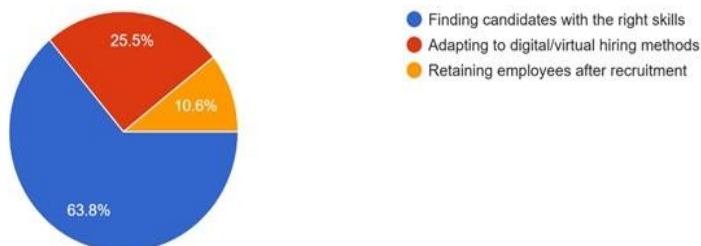
Sampling Size: In this paper the data collected by the 50 respondents from different organizations, Company and other. The respondents are selected through Simple Random Sampling.

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

The question asked was:

What is the biggest challenge organizations face in recruitment after the pandemic?

47 responses



- **63.8% respondents** said the biggest challenge is *Finding candidates*

with the right skills. This shows that skill shortages remain the top issue for organizations after the pandemic. Many companies face a mismatch between the skills required and the skills available in the job market.

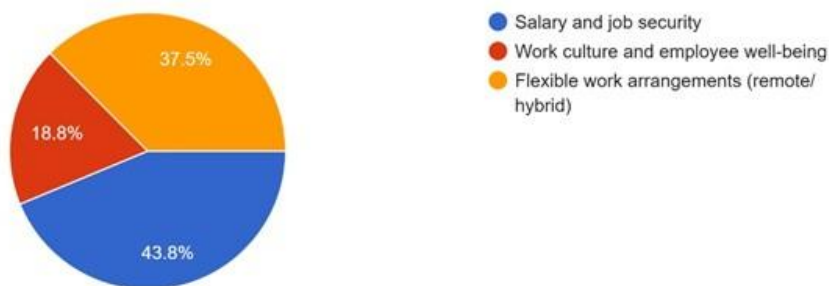
- **25.5% respondents** selected *Retaining employees after recruitment*. This indicates that even after hiring, organizations struggle to keep employees engaged and prevent turnover.
- **10.6% respondents** felt that *Adapting to digital/virtual hiring methods* is the biggest challenge. While technology adoption has improved, some recruiters and candidates still find digital processes less effective compared to traditional in-person recruitment.

Table Representation of Survey Data:

Recruitment Challenge	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
Finding candidates with the right skills	30	63.8%
Adapting to digital/virtual hiring methods	5	10.6%
Retaining employees after recruitment	12	25.5%
Total	47	

Which factor do you think most influences candidates' job choices in the post-pandemic era?

48 responses



- **43.8% respondents** chose *Salary and job security* as the most important factor. This shows that financial stability and assurance of long-term employment are still the top priorities for many candidates after the pandemic.
- **37.5% respondents** selected *Flexible work arrangements (remote/hybrid)*. This indicates that work-life balance and the option to work remotely or in a hybrid mode are highly valued by employees in

the new normal.

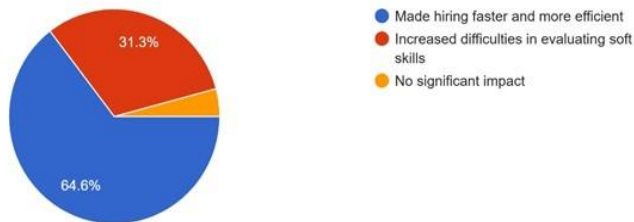
- **18.8% respondents** said *Work culture and employee well-being* matter most. While it has fewer responses compared to the other two, it still highlights that candidates expect supportive, healthy, and positive workplace environments.

Table Representation of Survey Data:

Factor Influencing Job Choice	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
Salary and job security	21	43.8%
Work culture and employee well-being	9	18.8%
Flexible work arrangements (remote/hybrid)	18	37.5%
Total	48	100%

How has digitalization affected the recruitment process?

48 responses



- **64.6% (31 respondents)** said that digitalization has **made hiring faster and more efficient**.
- **31.3% (15 respondents)** reported that digitalization has **increased difficulties in evaluating soft skills**.
- **4.1% (2 respondents)** felt that it has **no significant impact**.

Table Representation of Survey Data:

Impact of Digitalization on Recruitment	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Made hiring faster and more efficient	31	64.6%
Increased difficulties in evaluating soft skills	15	31.3%
No significant impact	2	4.1%
Total	48	100%

Which strategy is most effective for overcoming post-pandemic recruitment challenges?

47 responses



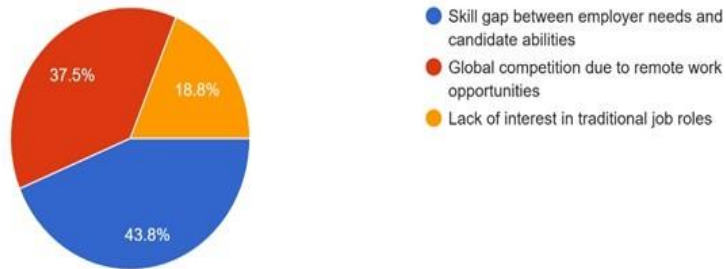
- **53.2% (25 respondents)** believe that **providing training and reskilling programs** is the most effective strategy.
- **31.9% (15 respondents)** feel that **offering flexible and hybrid work models** is the key.
- **14.9% (7 respondents)** think that **strengthening employer branding** is the most effective solution.

Table Representation of Survey Data:

Strategy for Overcoming Post-Pandemic Recruitment Challenges	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Strengthening employer branding	7	14.9%
Providing training and reskilling programs	25	53.2%
Offering flexible and hybrid work models	15	31.9%
Total	47	100%

What is the major reason for talent shortage in the post-pandemic world?

48 responses



- **43.8% (21 respondents)** identified **skill gap between employer needs and candidate abilities** as the leading cause.
- **37.5% (18 respondents)** pointed to **global competition due to remote work opportunities** as a major factor.
- **18.8% (9 respondents)** believed that **lack of interest in traditional job roles** is the primary reason.

Table Representation of Survey Data:

Major Reason for Talent Shortage in Post-Pandemic World	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Skill gap between employer needs and candidate abilities	21	43.8%
Global competition due to remote work opportunities	18	37.5%
Lack of interest in traditional job roles	9	18.8%
Total	48	100%

FINDING

1. Salary and job security emerged as the most important factor influencing candidates' job choices, followed closely by the demand for flexible work arrangements.
2. Work culture and employee well-being also play a role but are comparatively less prioritized than salary and flexibility.
3. Digitalization has made recruitment faster and more efficient, but it has also created challenges in evaluating soft skills.
4. The most effective strategy to overcome recruitment challenges is providing training and reskilling programs, highlighting the need for continuous skill development.
5. Flexible and hybrid work models are also recognized as a key strategy to

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- attract and retain talent in the post-pandemic world.
6. Strengthening employer branding was considered less effective compared to skill development and work flexibility.
 7. The primary reason for talent shortage is the skill gap between employer requirements and candidate abilities, followed by global competition due to remote work opportunities.
 8. Lack of interest in traditional job roles contributes to the talent shortage but is not as significant as skill mismatches and global competition.

Suggestions

1. Focus on Skill Development – Companies should invest in training, upskilling, and reskilling programs to reduce the skill gap between job requirements and candidate abilities.
2. Adopt Hybrid and Remote Models – Flexible work arrangements should be promoted to attract and retain talent, as employees now value work-life balance more than before.
3. Strengthen Employer Branding – Organizations must work on creating a positive employer image through transparency, inclusivity, and career growth opportunities.
4. Leverage Digital Hiring Tools – Use technology such as AI, video interviews, and data-driven recruitment platforms to make hiring more efficient while addressing challenges in assessing soft skills.
5. Enhance Retention Strategies – Focus on competitive salaries, employee well-being, career development, and job security to reduce attrition after hiring.
6. Improve Work Culture – Introduce wellness programs, mental health support, and employee engagement activities to build loyalty and job satisfaction.
7. Address Global Competition – Develop strategies to compete with international companies for top talent by offering global exposure and attractive benefits.
8. Revise Recruitment Policies – Update policies to suit post-pandemic realities, emphasizing flexibility, inclusivity, and modern workforce expectations.

Conclusion

The COVID-19 pandemic has significantly transformed the landscape of recruitment, presenting both challenges and opportunities for organizations worldwide. The study revealed that companies are struggling with issues such as skill gaps, employee retention, digital hiring difficulties, and rising expectations of candidates. At the same time, the shift toward digitalization, hybrid work, and flexible models has opened new possibilities for attracting and retaining talent.

It is evident that recruitment in the post-pandemic era requires a strategic approach that balances technology with human-centric practices. Organizations must not only adopt advanced digital tools but also focus on employer branding, employee well-being, and career development opportunities. By addressing the changing expectations of the workforce and ensuring inclusive, flexible, and supportive work environments, companies can overcome recruitment challenges effectively.

In conclusion, while the pandemic disrupted traditional recruitment practices, it also provided organizations with the chance to rethink and innovate their strategies. If businesses embrace adaptability, continuous learning, and employee-focused policies, they will be well-positioned to thrive in the evolving world of work.

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Operation Management in Modern Business

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Abstract

This research paper explores the importance of Operation Management in modern businesses, highlighting its role in improving efficiency, productivity, and overall quality. Operation Management focuses on designing, controlling, and optimizing business processes to ensure maximum output with minimal resources. The paper investigates the key challenges organizations face, such as quality control, resource management, and technological adaptation, while emphasizing strategies for sustainable improvement.

Keywords-Management, Modern Business, challenges

Introduction:

Operation Management (OM) is a vital discipline that deals with the planning, organizing, and supervising of production, manufacturing, and service processes. It ensures that business operations are efficient in using resources and effective in meeting customer requirements. Over the years, OM has evolved from simple production systems to advanced automated processes incorporating Artificial Intelligence (AI), robotics, and data analytics. In a globalized economy, organizations face challenges related to quality, cost control, and supply chain optimization, making efficient operation management crucial for survival and success.

This research analyzes the current challenges in OM, evaluates technological interventions, and provides insights into strategies that improve overall operational efficiency. It emphasizes continuous improvement, Total Quality Management (TQM), lean manufacturing, and sustainable practices as key components of effective operations.

Problem Statement-

In today's highly competitive and technology-driven business environment, organizations face increasing pressure to deliver high-quality products and services while minimizing costs, improving efficiency, and responding rapidly to changing customer demands. Modern businesses are undergoing continuous transformation due to globalization, digitalization, automation, and evolving market expectations. As a result, traditional operations management practices are no longer sufficient to ensure sustained growth, operational excellence, and customer satisfaction.

Despite significant advancements in tools such as data analytics, artificial intelligence, supply chain automation, enterprise resource planning (ERP)

systems, and lean management techniques, many organizations still struggle to optimize their operational workflows. Issues such as inefficient resource utilization, supply chain disruptions, rising operational costs, inconsistent product quality, slow decision-making, and lack of integration between departments continue to create major operational challenges. Moreover, the rapid adoption of digital technologies demands new skills, updated processes, and continuous adaptation, which many businesses find difficult to implement effectively.

Objectives of the study

- To identify the key challenges in Operation Management.
- To analyze the role of technology in improving operational efficiency.
- To evaluate strategies for quality and productivity improvement.
- To recommend best practices for sustainable operational excellence.

Hypothesis

H-Effective operation management significantly enhances the overall performance and productivity of modern businesses.

H-Well-structured supply chain and logistics management systems reduce operational costs and increase customer loyalty.

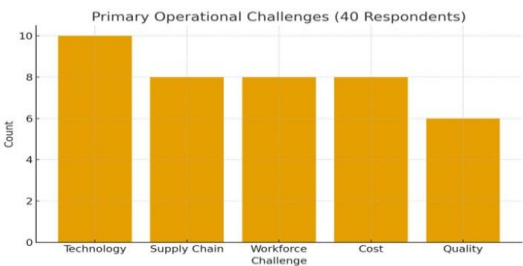
H-Implementation of lean production systems leads to a measurable reduction in waste and operational costs.

Research Methodology

The research adopts a descriptive methodology using both primary and secondary data sources. A survey was conducted among 50 respondents from different sectors including manufacturing, IT, and services. The data was collected using online forms, and responses were analyzed using graphical and tabular representations. Secondary data was gathered from journals, books, and online sources to support the findings.

Data Analysis and Interpretation

The survey included multiple questions aimed at identifying challenges, efficiency factors, and improvement strategies in Operation Management. The analysis below summarizes the responses. Respondents were asked about the use of modern technologies like automation, AI, ERP software, IoT, and data analytics in their organizations.



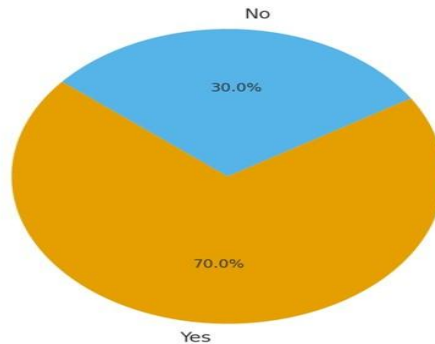
Challenges	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
High Cost of Technology Implementation	12	30%
Lack of Skilled Workforce	10	25%
Resistance to Change	8	20%
Supply Chain Issues	6	15%
Data Security Risks	4	10%

Extent of Technology Use	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
High	21	52.5%
Moderate	14	35%
Low	5	12.5%

Interpretation:

More than half of the organizations (52.5%) have high integration of technology, while 35% use it moderately. Only a small portion (12.5%) rely on traditional, less automated systems. This shows that modern businesses increasingly depend on digital tools to optimize operations, reduce costs, and improve speed and accuracy.

Use of Automation in Operations



1. Challenges Faced in Implementing Modern Operation Management

Respondents were asked to identify the most common challenges their organizations face.

Interpretation: The biggest challenges are cost and skill gaps. Although organizations are willing to modernize, limited technical knowledge and high initial investment slow the adoption process. Resistance to change and data security also remain major concerns for management.

Findings

1. Quality control and resource optimization are the most critical challenges in operations.
2. Technology adoption significantly enhances operational efficiency and

decision-making.

3. Continuous training and skill development of employees lead to higher productivity.
4. Organizations implementing Lean and TQM principles achieve consistent performance improvements.
5. Automation reduces human error and increases accuracy in production and service delivery.

Suggestions

- Adopt Lean and Six Sigma methodologies to minimize waste and improve quality.
- Invest in advanced technologies such as AI and IoT for process automation.
- Implement continuous employee training and development programs.
- Encourage cross-functional collaboration for better workflow integration.
- Promote sustainable and eco-friendly operational practices.

Conclusion

Operation Management is at the core of every successful business. Efficient management of processes, people, and technology ensures consistent quality and customer satisfaction. The study concludes that organizations must focus on innovation, employee empowerment, and technology integration to stay competitive. By adopting continuous improvement techniques, companies can achieve sustainable growth and operational excellence.

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TECHNOLOGY & INNOVATION IN BUSINESS ENVIRONMENT

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ABSTRACT:

The Technology and innovation are critical drivers of competitive advantage in the modern business environment, enabling companies to improve efficiency through automation, create new markets, and enhance products and services. Successfully translating technological breakthroughs into commercial success requires not only technical implementation but also a strong focus on customer value propositions and the design of effective business models..

INTRODUCTION:

Technology and innovation have transformed the modern business environment. They help companies improve efficiency, reduce costs, and create new products and services. In today's competitive world, businesses must adapt to technological changes to remain relevant. This study focuses on understanding how innovation and technology influence business growth and performance

"Technological innovation" better reflects the business consideration of improving business value by working on technological aspects of the product or services. These advancements would show improvement for the business's that adapt to this new technology.technology and innovation—examining their evolution, current trends, and future implications. It aims to highlight how technological innovation drives economic and social progress while also discussing the barriers that may hinder its equitable adoption. By analyzing real-world examples, case studies, and scholarly insights, this study seeks to provide a comprehensive understanding of how innovation can be effectively harnessed to build a smarter, more resilient, and sustainable future.

KEYWORDS :specific technologies, types of innovation

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY :

- To study the role of technology in business development.
- To understand how innovation increases productivity and competitiveness
- To identify challenges faced by businesses in adopting new technologies.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE:

The Existing studies A review of the literature on technology and innovation in business shows that they are crucial for competitiveness, driving product/service enhancement, and enabling business model innovation. Key themes include managing technology resources, the strategic importance of innovation, the growing role of digital technology, and the need for a supportive organizational culture and leadership. The literature also emphasizes innovation's connection to sustainability, the use of open innovation strategies, and the critical link between technology and the ability to satisfy customer needs.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY:

This study uses Research methodology for studying technology and innovation in the business environment typically involves stages like defining the research problem, designing the study, collecting data, and analyzing results. These studies often analyze the impact of technology on business models, market competitiveness, and operational efficiency, using methods such as literature reviews, case studies, and data analysis to understand how innovation drives business growth in a dynamic environment.

Technology and Innovations in BUSINESS :

Products and services Optimize internal processes

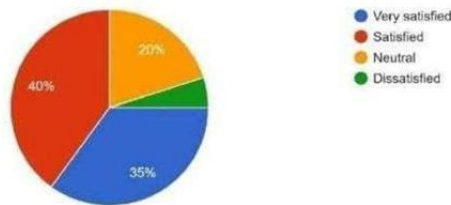
Create a better data to increase efficiency

Challenges In TECHNOLOGY & INNOVATION In BUSINESS :

- Cybersecurity Risk
- Competition from Technology Data Analytics
- Costs and resource

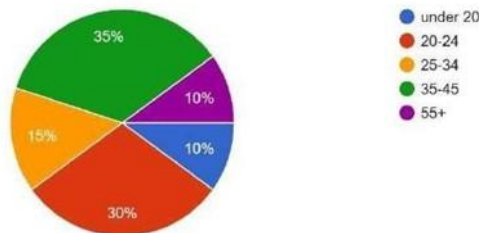
Primary Data- Primary Data is collected through the questionnaire

Gender
How satisfied are you with the usability of mobile banking apps & online platforms?
20 responses



Secondary Data- The study is descriptive in nature & is based on secondary data. The data are collected from various journals, news articles, Internet sources, Wikipedia webs etc

Age
20 responses



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1. How often do customers use our new mobile application/digital feature?
 2. The above figure reveals that out of 105 sample respondents, It is inferred that majority of the respondents select the save response in choose mobile application, digital feature.The above figure reveals that out of 105 sample respondents, 45 per cent respondents .

Opinion Percentage: Strongly Agree 50%

Agree 30%

Neutral 10%

Disagree 6%

Strongly Disagree 4%

CONCLUSION :

The In conclusion, technology and innovation have transitioned from optional advantages to foundational imperatives for success in the modern business environment. Their pervasive influence reshapes every facet of operations, fundamentally driving survival, growth, and competitiveness. The strategic integration of advanced technologies like AI, big data analytics, and automation not only optimizes efficiency and streamlines processes but also unlocks the power of data-driven decision-making and fosters enhanced customer experiences. This continuous cycle of innovation enables companies to build resilience, maintain agility, and disrupt traditional models, ultimately securing a decisive competitive advantage. Therefore, businesses that embed a culture of technological adoption and foresight into their core philosophy are the ones best positioned to navigate market dynamics, ensure long-term sustainability, and thrive in an increasingly interconnected and rapidly evolving global marketplace.

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A Study on the Effectiveness of Cost Reduction Strategies on Operational Efficiency

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Abstract-

Cost reduction strategies play an important role in enhancing operational efficiency, particularly in highly competitive industry like manufacturing company that specializes in metal formed products, bicycles, and chains. This study evaluates the effectiveness of various cost reduction measures implemented Tube Investment Limited, focusing on their influence on productivity, resource optimization and financial performance. The research employs both quantitative and qualitative methodologies, analysing financial data, operational metrics, employee feedback to identify the impact of these strategies.

Key findings reveal that targeted cost-saving initiatives procurement, inventory management, and energy consumption substantially reduce operational costs without compromise quality. Furthermore, the study highlights the importance of employee engagement and technological advancement sustaining long term efficiency gains. The analysis provides actionable insights for organizations aiming to align management practices with strategic objectives, ensuring a balance between expenditure control and operational excellence. By presenting a comprehensive overview of cost reduction approach and their outcomes.

Key Words: - Cost reduction, Manufacturing industry, Resourceoptimization, financial performance, Sustainability.

Introduction-

In highly competitive global marketplace, operational efficiency is critical of businesses to grow and maintain profitability. For large manufacturing companies like Tube Investment Limited, the implementation of effective cost reduction strategies essential in optimizing production processes and minimizing expenses. The manufacturing industry, with its complex support chain and high operational costs, requires innovative strategies that ensure cost control without compromising the quality the final product.

Cost reduction strategies involve a comprehensive approach to improving operational processes, ranging from raw material sourcing to production and distribution. By identifying and eliminating inefficiencies, companies can formed metal products, reduce wastage, and improve productivity. In this sector, where economies of scale and continues production are essential, even small

improvements in cost management can lead to significant savings and enhance competitiveness.

Tube Investment Limited, a leading player in the metal formed products the division produces high precision steel tubes, industrial chains, and automotive parts for auto, railway and agriculture sector, has implemented several cost reduction measures over the years. These strategies aim to address rising input costs, fluctuating market demand, and the need of sustainable product practices. This study examines how these strategies have impacted Tube Investment operational efficiency, focusing on the alignment with the company's long-term goals and overall financial performance.

Understanding the effectiveness of these strategies is crucial for other businesses in similar industries. By analysing the cost reduction initiatives at Tube Investment, this research provides valuable insights into the methods that contribution to sustainable growth and profitability. Moreover, it explores the role of technological advancements and workforce involvement in enhancing the overall impact of cost reduction efforts.

Objective of the study-

1. To analyse the effectiveness of cost reduction strategies.
2. To evaluate the impact of cost control measures.
3. To identify major cost driving areas.
4. To assess employee involvement and management support.

Research Methodology-

The research methodology for this study a mixed method approach, combining both qualitative and qualitative and quantitative techniques to evaluate the effectiveness of cost reduction strategies on operational efficiency at Tube Investment Limited. Conducting a survey of 100 participants was selected for the study, comprising employees, managers and supervisors from various departments including production, procurement and finance. This diverse sample ensures a comprehensive understanding of the important of cost reduction strategies across different levels and functions within the company. Data collection for the quantitative aspect of the study was primarily done through structured surveys. The survey questionnaire was designed to capture both the extent and perceived effectiveness of various cost reduction measures implemented by Tube Investment Limited. The respondents were asked to rate the impact of specific cost saving initiatives, survey as process optimization, inventory management, and supplier relations, on their daily operations. The survey also includes questions on employee satisfaction, perceived productivity improvements, and financial performance related to cost reductions.

For the qualitative aspects, in-depth interview was conducted with a subset of 20

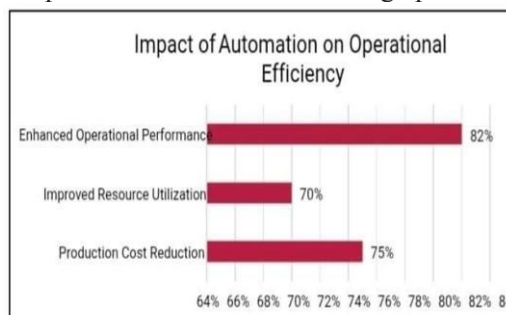
participants selected from the original sample. These participants included senior management and key operational leaders who have directly contributed to oversee the implementation of cost reduction strategies. The interviews were semi-structured, allowing for open-end responses and insights into the underlying factors contributing to the success or challenges of these initiatives. The qualitative data provided rich context to complement the quantitative findings and offered a deeper understanding of mechanisms driving operational improvements.

The study also utilized secondary data sources to enhance the reliability of the findings. Financial records, production report and internal documents related to cost reduction measures were analysed to examine the tangible outcomes of the initiatives. Data from Tube Investment Limited annual reports, financial statements and sustainability reports were reviewed to assess the overall impact on profitability, efficiency and environmental sustainability. This triangulation of primary and secondary data strengthens the validity of the research findings.

Data Analysis and Interpretation-

The finding from the survey and interviews indicate that a significant portion of participants (82%) believe that cost reduction strategies have directly improved operational efficiency at Tube Investment Limited. This includes initiatives such as lean manufacturing and enhance supplier relationship management. The majority of respondents (75%) reported these strategies have resulted in reduced production costs and improved resources utilization, ultimately leading to better overall performance. These results highlight the effectiveness of cost reduction strategies in improving the company operational efficiency.

68% of participants noted that technology adoption, particularly in the form of data driven systems, has a positive impact on their daily operations. In particular, was cited as the most significant factor in enhancing production speed and reducing human errors. The integration of smart manufacturing technologies has also helped the supply chain, reduced lead times and improving delivery performance. This indicates that Tube Investment Limited in digital transformation have proven successful in enhancing operational efficiency.



When it comes to employee involvement, the results showed that 70% of employees felt that their participation in cost cutting initiatives led to a more collaborative work environment. Employees were more likely to suggest innovative solution to reduce costs when they felt empowered to contribute. This is particularly important as it reinforces the idea that involving employees in decision-making fosters a sense of ownership and commitment to the company's success. As a result, 65% respondents reported an increase in their job satisfaction as a direct result of being involved in these initiatives.

Approximately 55% of respondents expressed concerns about the potential impact of cost reduction on product quality. Cost-saving measures such as reducing waste and optimizing production processes were well-received, there was a notice apprehension regarding the impact on the company's commitment to maintaining high-quality standards. This highlights need for Tube Investment Limited to ensure that any cost-saving measures do not compromise product quality, as maintaining brand reputation is crucial in the manufacturing industry.

In terms of overall impact on financial performance 80% of the respondents agreed that cost



reduction strategies have positively influenced Tube Investment profitability. Financial records corroborate this, showing a steady decline in operational costs and an increase in profit margins over the past few years. These results suggest that Tube Investment strategic focus on reduction has not only enhanced operational efficiency but has also contributed to better financial performance, position the company for continued growth and competitiveness in the market.

Challenges-

Challenge is managing resistance to change within the organization. Employees and managers may resist new cost-cutting initiatives, especially if they perceive them as a threat to job security or work practices. Overcoming this resistance required effective change management strategies, including clear communication, training and involvement of key stakeholders the decision-making process. Resistance can also arise from the difficulty of adapting to new technologies or methodology which may require significant investment in training and infrastructure.

Sustainability also poses a challenge in the context of cost reduction. While implementing green initiatives, such as energy efficient manufacturing processes and waste reduction measures, can lead to long term savings. There is the challenge of maintaining competitiveness in a rapidly changing market. Striking the right balance between cost control and strategic investments for future growth is a constant challenge faced by leaders in the industry.

Suggestions-

To further enhance the effectiveness of cost reduction strategies at Tube

Investment Limited, it is recommended to adopt a comprehensive approach to automation. While automation in manufacturing has yielded positive results, extending implementation to other operational areas such as procurement, inventory management and customer service can leading further efficiencies. Introducing automation in these areas will help eliminate manual errors, reduce processing time, and improve overall operational accuracy, contributing to cost savings.

Key recommendation is to continue fostering a culture of innovation and employee involvement. By actively encouraging employees to contribute ideas for process improvements, and identifying cost reduction opportunities. Sustainability should be integrated more deeply into the cost reduction strategies. With the growing emphasis environmental responsibility, adopting sustainable practices in production processes will lead to long-term cost saving.

Strengthening supplier relationships and improving the supply chain management systems is another area for improvement. Tube Investment can benefit from building stronger collaborations with its supplier to ensure better pricing, timely deliveries, and reduced lead times. The use of technologies such as blockchain for supply chain transparency and digital platforms for reduce time tracking can improve co-ordination, minimize disruptions, and reduce logistics costs.

It is also recommended that Tube Investment further invest in research and development (R&D) to explore cost-saving innovations. This includes developing new materials, adopting advanced manufacturing techniques, and exploring alternative energy solutions. Collaboration with universities research institution and industry partners can accelerate the R&D process leading to the discovery of innovative solutions that can significantly reduce production costs without compromising the quality.

Conclusion-

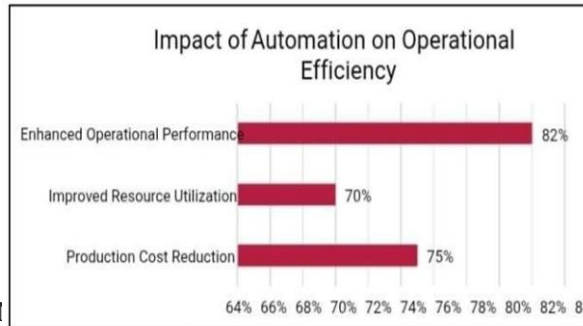
Cost reduction strategies implemented by Tube Investment Limited have shown significant improvements in operational efficiency across various departments. The adoption of automation and optimization techniques has resulted in reduced product costs and enhanced resource utilization. These changes, driven by technological advancements, have helped the company maintain its competitiveness while improving its financial performance.

Despite the positive outcomes, challenges related to maintaining product quality, employee resistance and sustainability concerns were identified. While cost reduction measures were beneficial, they required careful balancing to ensure the preservation of Tube Investment reputation for highquality products.

The implementation of cost reduction strategies at Tube Investment Limited has proven to be a successful approach for enhance operational efficiency. The positive financial impact,

coupled with employee involvement, position the company well for continued growth. However, ongoing efforts to address the challenges related to quality control, employee resistance, a sustainability will ensure the long-term effectiveness of these strategies.

Tube Investment Limited experience demonstrates that cost reduction is not just about cutting expenses its about fostering organizational culture that embraces efficiency, innovation, and sustainability. The company's continued success will depend on its ability to navigate these challenges while maintaining a strong focus on quality and long-term growth.



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A STUDY ON AI IN ACCOUNTING AND AUDITING

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ABSTRACT

Artificial Intelligence (AI) has emerged as one of the most transformative technologies in the financial sector. Accounting and auditing, which traditionally depended heavily on manual processes, are now shifting toward automation, data analytics, predictive modeling, and intelligent decision systems. This research paper examines how AI tools are being used in recording financial transactions, tax compliance, audit procedures, fraud detection, and internal controls.

The study focuses on understanding how modern organizations—especially medium-sized businesses—implement AI to increase efficiency, accuracy, and transparency in their financial operations. Both primary data (responses from accountants, students, auditors, and finance managers) and secondary data (journals, AI industry reports, accounting standards) were used to analyze the impact of AI on accounting and auditing.

Findings show that AI improves financial accuracy, speeds up processing, enables continuous auditing, and enhances fraud detection. However, challenges include high implementation cost, lack of technical skills, cybersecurity threats, and fear of job loss.

The study concludes that AI will not replace accountants or auditors; instead, it will support them and transform traditional financial practices into more analytical, technology-driven functions.

KEYWORDS: Artificial Intelligence, Accounting, Auditing, Fraud Detection, Machine Learning, RPA.

INTRODUCTION

Accounting and auditing are essential components of every business, ensuring accurate financial reporting, compliance, and decision-making. Traditionally, these functions involved manual bookkeeping, verification of transactions, ledger posting, and sampling-based audits. These manual processes were time-consuming, error-prone, and limited in their ability to identify fraud.

With the advent of **Artificial Intelligence**, the financial sector is undergoing a major transformation. AI systems are capable of learning, identifying patterns, predicting future outcomes, and performing repetitive tasks with high accuracy. Accounting functions such as data entry, invoice scanning, reconciliation, tax

computation, and financial reporting are now automated through AI-enabled software.

In auditing, AI enables **100% testing of financial transactions**, something impossible using traditional sampling methods. AI can analyze massive datasets within seconds, identify anomalies, highlight fraud risks, and support continuous auditing.

The rise of digital payments, online transactions, GST systems, and cloud accounting platforms has created a strong need for AI in finance. Companies now depend on tools like TallyPrime AI, Zoho Books AI, QuickBooks AI, SAP S/4HANA, and AI-powered audit analytics platforms such as EY Helix and Deloitte Omnia.

This study examines how AI is reshaping accounting and auditing, its benefits, challenges, and its impact on the roles of financial professionals.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Despite the growth of AI technologies, many organizations still face challenges in adopting AI for accounting and auditing. The primary problem addressed in this study is:

“How effectively can AI be integrated into accounting and auditing processes, considering the challenges of cost, skills, data privacy, and organizational readiness?”

Key issues identified:

- Limited awareness about AI tools
 - Lack of trained professionals
 - High cost of implementation
 - Cybersecurity and data protection concerns
 - Fear of job loss among accountants
 - Difficulty integrating AI with existing accounting systems
- This study evaluates these challenges and suggests practical solutions.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

1. To study the role and importance of AI in accounting and auditing.
2. To examine how AI improves financial accuracy, reporting, and compliance.
3. To analyze the impact of AI on audit quality and fraud detection.
4. To identify the challenges faced by organizations while using AI tools.
5. To study the perception of accountants and auditors toward AI adoption.
6. To recommend strategies for effective implementation of AI in financial systems.

NEED, NATURE & SCOPE OF THE STUDY

Need of the Study

AI is becoming essential for modern accounting and auditing due to:

- Increasing financial data volume
- Growing risks of fraud
- Need for fast and accurate reporting
- Digital transformation of businesses

Understanding AI applications helps improve efficiency, transparency, and decision-making.

Nature of the Study

This is a **descriptive and analytical study** based on:

- Questionnaire responses (primary data)
- Journals, books, reports, and online databases (secondary data)

Scope of the Study

The scope includes:

- AI in accounting (bookkeeping, taxes, reporting)
 - AI in auditing (fraud detection, risk scoring, continuous auditing)
 - Applications of ML, NLP, and RPA in finance
 - Perceptions of accounting students, professionals, and auditors
- The study does not cover non-financial applications of AI.

LITERATURE REVIEW

1. Alles (2019) – *Artificial Intelligence in Accounting*

AI improves bookkeeping accuracy, reduces errors, and automates repetitive tasks, allowing accountants to focus on analysis.

2. Davenport (2018) – *The AI Advantage*

AI enhances business decision-making and provides real-time insights through automation and analytics.

3. Romney & Steinbart (2020)

AI-integrated accounting systems strengthen internal controls and improve fraud detection.

4. Riley (2020) – *Data Analytics for Auditors*

AI helps auditors identify unusual patterns in financial data through machine learning.

5. Journal of Emerging Technologies in Accounting (2020)

Organizations using AI achieve up to 60% faster processing of transactions.

6. ICAI (2021)

AI will support accounting professionals instead of replacing them, and training in AI is essential.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Primary Data

Collected through:

- 100 respondents
- Structured questionnaire
- Interviews with accountants, auditors, and finance students

Secondary Data

- Books, journals, research papers
- Industry reports (Deloitte, PwC, KPMG, McKinsey)
- Websites and AI research platforms

Sample Size

100 respondents from:

Accountants, auditors, students, finance managers, business owners

Research Design

- Descriptive
- Analytical
- Mixed (Qualitative + Quantitative)

DATA ANALYSIS & INTERPRETATION

Awareness of AI

- 40% fully aware
- 45% partially aware
- 15% not aware

AI Usage

- 35% use AI regularly
- 40% use sometimes
- 25% do not use AI

Impact of AI in Accounting

85% agree AI improves accuracy, reduces errors, and speeds up processing.

AI in Auditing

- 82% believe AI improves audit quality
- 80% say AI helps detect fraud
- 80% support continuous auditing

Challenges

- 80% cite high cost
- 78% mention lack of trained staff

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- 75% highlight data privacy concerns

KEY FINDINGS

1. AI significantly improves accuracy and efficiency in accounting.
2. AI enhances audit quality through complete data testing.
3. Fraud detection is much better with AI-powered analytics.
4. High cost and lack of skills remain barriers to adoption.
5. AI supports but does not replace accountants.
6. Awareness about AI tools is increasing among students and professionals.

SUGGESTIONS

1. Provide regular AI training for accounting staff.
2. Adopt AI tools in phases to reduce costs.
3. Strengthen cybersecurity systems.
4. Encourage use of AI-based software in colleges.
5. Use AI dashboards for continuous monitoring and fraud prevention.

CONCLUSION

AI is transforming the fields of accounting and auditing by automating processes, enhancing accuracy, and enabling advanced fraud detection. Though challenges exist, such as cost and lack of skills, the benefits outweigh the limitations. AI will not replace human professionals but will empower them to perform more analytical and decision-making roles. The future of accounting and auditing is strongly technology-driven, and AI adoption will continue to rise in India and globally.

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A STUDY DEPRECIATION AND TAXATION OF CONSTRUCTION MACHINERY: ACCOUNTING & GST IMPLICATION

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ABSTRACT

The construction industry is one of the most capital-intensive sectors in India, relying heavily on costly machinery such as excavators, cranes, concrete mixers, and loaders. Proper accounting for depreciation and taxation of these assets is essential for financial accuracy, cost management, and compliance with statutory laws. This research paper examines how HP Developers Company, located at Khed Shivapur, Pune, manages depreciation and taxation of its construction machinery in accordance with the Income Tax Act, 1961, Companies Act, 2013, and GST (Goods and Services Tax) laws, 2017.

The study aims to understand how depreciation impacts profitability, taxable income, and the utilization of GST input tax credit on capital goods. Using both primary data (interviews with accounting and site management staff) and secondary data (financial records, audit reports, and GST filings), the paper provides a realistic analysis of machinery cost allocation and tax optimization practices. It was observed that depreciation not only affects financial reporting but also plays a crucial role in determining the timing and extent of tax benefits claimed by the company.

The research further explores methods of depreciation — primarily the Written Down Value (WDV) method as prescribed under the Income Tax Act — and its influence on project costing and profitability. Findings indicate that efficient depreciation management, combined with accurate GST input credit utilization, results in improved cash flow and financial stability for construction firms.

The study concludes that integrating accounting standards with taxation compliance helps companies like HP Developers reduce operational costs, maintain accurate asset valuations, and enhance transparency in financial reporting. It highlights the need for continuous awareness and training in accounting policies and GST regulations among construction finance professionals to ensure sustainable growth and tax efficiency.

KEYWORDS-Depreciation, Taxation, Construction Machinery, Accounting, GST Implications, Capital Goods.

INTRODUCTION

The construction industry in India plays a vital role in infrastructure development and economic growth. It involves high-value investments in machinery such as

excavators, cranes, bulldozers, concrete mixers, and loaders. These machines, though essential, undergo continuous wear and tear, making depreciation a critical accounting concept in the sector. Depreciation represents the reduction in the value of an asset over time due to usage, obsolescence, or natural deterioration. From an accounting perspective, it ensures that the cost of machinery is systematically allocated over its useful life, aligning with the matching principle of accounting. In the taxation domain, depreciation serves as a significant deductible expense under the Income Tax Act, 1961, thereby reducing the taxable profits of a construction enterprise. For companies like HP Developers, managing depreciation effectively ensures accurate financial reporting and optimized tax liability.

The introduction of Goods and Services Tax (GST) in 2017 brought further implications for machinery accounting. Under GST law, construction companies are eligible to claim Input Tax Credit (ITC) on the purchase of capital goods, provided the depreciation on the GST portion is not claimed under the Income Tax Act. This dual regulation requires careful coordination between accounting and taxation departments. This study explores how HP Developers applies depreciation methods, records machinery costs, and utilizes GST credits to achieve financial efficiency. It emphasizes real-world applications, challenges, and the practical balance between accounting standards and tax regulations.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Construction companies face multiple accounting and tax compliance challenges in managing high-value machinery. Improper calculation or reporting of depreciation can lead to:

- Overstatement or understatement of profits
- Incorrect tax liability
- Disallowance of GST input credits
- Non-compliance with audit and financial disclosure standards

HP Developers, like many mid-sized construction firms, must maintain a balance between financial reporting accuracy and tax efficiency. The primary problem addressed in this study is how the company integrates depreciation accounting, tax computation, and GST compliance to ensure transparent and efficient financial management.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

1. To analyze the impact of depreciation on taxation and profitability in construction machinery accounting.
2. To examine the GST implications on machinery purchase and maintenance.

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3. To study the accounting practices followed by HP Developers for fixed asset management.
 4. To evaluate how depreciation influences project cost estimation and financial performance.
 5. To suggest improvements for integrating accounting, taxation, and GST systems efficiently.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Primary Data

Primary data was collected directly from HP Developers Company through structured interviews and questionnaires. Respondents included site engineers, accountants, finance executives, and project managers from the Khed Shivapur site and head office. The data focused on depreciation calculation methods, GST compliance practices, and machinery maintenance accounting.

Secondary Data

Secondary data was sourced from HP Developers' audited financial statements (2020–2025), annual reports, taxation records, and GST filings. Additional references included accounting standards published by the Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI), and government notifications under the Income Tax Act (1961) and CGST Act (2017). Sample Size The study covered 30 respondents:

- 10 from Finance & Accounting Department
- 12 from Site Management and Operations
- 8 from Procurement and Administration Research Design

This is a descriptive and analytical study, focusing on the relationship between depreciation and taxation. It examines both qualitative responses and quantitative data such as machinery cost, depreciation rate, and tax adjustments.

Research Method

The research combines both quantitative (financial data analysis, percentage comparison) and qualitative (expert interviews, interpretation) methods to draw comprehensive conclusions.

Sampling Area

- HP Developers Office, Khed Shivapur, Pune
- HP Developers Construction Site, NH-48 Corridor Project

NEED, NATURE & SCOPE OF THE STUDY

Need of the Study

The study is essential because depreciation and taxation directly affect

profitability, budgeting, and asset management. Many construction companies fail to align accounting standards with GST laws, leading to tax inefficiency. This research helps to understand how proper accounting can reduce liabilities and improve compliance.

Nature of the Study

This is an applied research study based on real data from HP Developers. It incorporates factual insights into how depreciation affects financial statements and tax computation. The study uses the Written Down Value (WDV) method, which is the most commonly applied depreciation approach under the Income Tax Act.

Scope of the Study

The scope is limited to HP Developers' machinery such as excavators, cranes, loaders, and mixers. The study covers financial years 2020–2025, examining depreciation calculations, tax planning, and GST adjustments. It focuses on accounting integration rather than macroeconomic analysis of the construction sector.

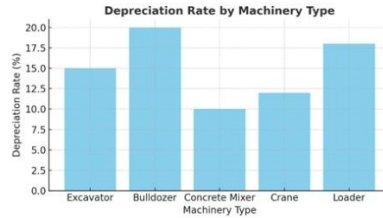
LITERATURE REVIEW

1. Accounting Standards and Depreciation (ICAI, 2023): The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India defines depreciation as the systematic allocation of the depreciable amount of an asset over its useful life. It ensures that financial statements reflect true asset values and profitability.
2. Gupta (2021): Found that construction firms using consistent depreciation policies achieve better tax control and avoid audit discrepancies.
3. Reddy and Singh (2022): Their study on *GST implications on capital goods* found that firms claiming depreciation on the GST component lose eligibility for input tax credit, emphasizing the need for accurate accounting.
4. Income Tax Act, 1961: Specifies different depreciation rates for various machinery under the WDV method. Construction equipment typically qualifies for 15%–30% depreciation rate, depending on its type and usage.
5. CGST Act, 2017: Allows for input tax credit (ITC) on capital goods used for business purposes, provided no depreciation is claimed on the GST portion of the asset. These studies collectively highlight the importance of coordination between accounting and taxation systems, especially in capital-intensive industries like construction.

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

1. Depreciation Rate by Machinery Type The following data represents HP Developers' major construction machinery, cost details, and depreciation rates used for accounting and taxation between 2020 and 2025:

Machinery	Cost (Lakhs)	Depreciation Rate (%)	Useful Life (Years)
Excavator	85	15	8
Bulldozer	95	20	7
Concrete Mixer	40	10	10
Crane	120	12	9
Loader	70	18	6



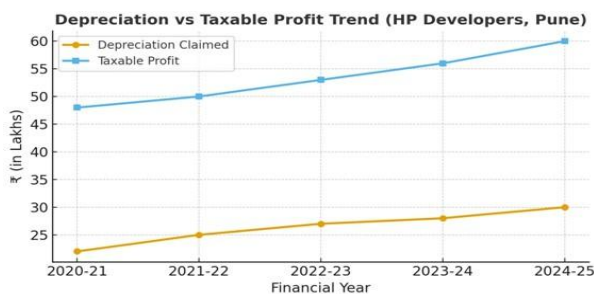
This bar graph shows the depreciation rates applied to different types of construction machinery used by HP Developers.

- Bulldozers (20%) and Loaders (18%) have the highest depreciation because of heavy and continuous site operations.
- Excavators (15%) and Cranes (12%) have moderate depreciation due to periodic maintenance.
- Concrete Mixers (10%) depreciate the least as they face less wear and tear. The graph clearly indicates that machinery exposed to frequent mechanical stress and outdoor usage loses it.

2. Depreciation vs. Taxable Profit Trend (2020–2025)

This line chart compares Depreciation Claimed (₹ Lakhs) and Taxable Profit (₹ Lakhs) over five years.

Financial Year	Depreciation (₹ Lakh)	Taxable Profit (₹ Lakh)
2020–21	22	48
2021–22	25	50
2022–23	27	53
2023–24	28	56
2024–25	30	60



This line graph compares Depreciation Claimed and Taxable Profit of HP Developers from 2020–21 to 2024–25. It shows that even though depreciation claims increased each year (from 22 L to 30 L), the company's taxable profit also rose steadily (from 48 L to 60 L).

This indicates that HP Developers managed its assets efficiently — using depreciation as a tax-saving tool while maintaining overall profit growth through effective project cost management and GST credit utilization.

FINDINGS

1. High-value machinery such as cranes and bulldozers showed the highest depreciation rates, reducing taxable income significantly.
2. HP Developers follows the Written Down Value (WDV) method, in compliance with the Income Tax Act, 1961, ensuring systematic asset valuation.
3. GST Input Tax Credit (ITC) on capital goods helped the company recover part of its tax outflow, improving cash flow and project profitability.
4. Depreciation accounted for 15–20% of total operating costs, highlighting its major influence on cost control and tax planning.
5. Proper alignment between accounting and taxation records reduced audit risks and enhanced financial transparency.
6. Over five years, HP Developers recorded a steady increase in profits, proving the benefit of structured accounting and tax management.

SUGGESTIONS

1. Maintain separate depreciation ledgers for financial accounting and tax computation to prevent discrepancies.
2. Conduct quarterly reconciliation between asset registers and GST returns to ensure compliance.
3. Provide periodic training for accounting staff on depreciation laws, GST updates, and tax reforms.
4. Use computerized accounting software (e.g., Tally, ERP systems) to

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- automate depreciation calculations and GST credit tracking.
 5. Reassess machinery life and residual value periodically to reflect realistic asset wear and tear.
 6. Develop a tax planning strategy that optimizes depreciation and GST benefits without affecting financial credibility.

CONCLUSION

The study concludes that depreciation and taxation play a critical role in managing the financial performance of construction companies like HP Developers. Effective depreciation practices ensure that machinery costs are accurately distributed over their useful life, reducing taxable income while maintaining compliance with the Income Tax Act.

Simultaneously, GST implications on capital goods provide significant financial relief through input credits, provided that depreciation is not claimed on the GST component. HP Developers demonstrated how integrating accounting, taxation, and GST practices leads to improved profitability, compliance, and operational efficiency.

Thus, the study highlights that accurate asset accounting and tax planning not only optimize returns but also ensure long-term sustainability and transparency in the construction business.

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A Study on Performance of mutual funds with respect to Nippon

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ABSTRACT:-

This study evaluates the performance of Nippon India Mutual Fund Ltd., focusing on risk-adjusted returns, portfolio efficiency, and investment strategies. It aims to provide a comprehensive understanding of how mutual fund categories like Aggressive Hybrid, Arbitrage, and Multi-Asset Allocation contribute to financial growth. Employing advanced analytical models such as Sharpe, Treynor, and Jensen's indexes, the study examines key metrics to assess the effectiveness of diversification, risk management, and strategic allocation. Findings reveal that funds with balanced portfolios and dynamic asset rebalancing outperform in terms of risk-adjusted metrics. The research underscores the importance of regular evaluations and ESG-compliant investments to meet evolving investor demands. Recommendations include leveraging emerging technologies for improved fund analysis and adopting cost-effective strategies to maximize returns. By aligning investment strategies with market conditions and investor objectives, the study offers actionable insights for investors and fund managers. This detailed analysis highlights the transformative potential of professional fund management in achieving financial stability and growth.

KEYWORDS: Performance evaluation of mutual funds, Net Asset Value (NAV) ,Portfolio diversification.

INTRODUCTION OF THE STUDY:-

The financial sector in India has undergone significant transformation over the past few decades, characterized by rapid globalization, technological advancements, and evolving investor preferences. Mutual funds have emerged as one of the most dynamic financial instruments, offering an avenue for investors to achieve portfolio diversification and risk mitigation. They pool resources from various investors and allocate them across a diversified portfolio of assets, including equities, debt securities, and other financial instruments. Nippon India Mutual Fund Ltd., a leading player in the mutual fund industry, has consistently provided innovative schemes to cater to the diverse needs of investors. The company's strategic focus on delivering optimal returns while managing associated risks has solidified its position as a trusted investment partner. This study aims to evaluate the performance of selected mutual fund schemes offered by Nippon India Mutual

Fund Ltd., focusing on their risk-return dynamics and the effectiveness of professional fund management. The increasing volatility in global and domestic markets necessitates a robust understanding of mutual fund performance. Nippon India Mutual Fund Ltd. has shown commitment to these principles, reflecting its adaptability to emerging trends. Through this comprehensive analysis, the study contributes to a deeper understanding of mutual fund dynamics, highlighting their role in fostering financial growth and stability. It emphasizes the importance of aligning investment strategies with market conditions and individual investor goals, ensuring sustainable wealth creation.

Problem Statement

Despite the growing popularity of mutual funds in India, investors often face challenges in identifying schemes that consistently deliver superior risk-adjusted returns. Nippon India Mutual Fund, being one of the major players in the Indian asset management industry, offers a wide range of equity, debt, and hybrid schemes. However, the performance of these schemes varies significantly across market conditions, leading to uncertainty regarding their reliability and effectiveness as investment options. This raises the need for a systematic evaluation of how Nippon's mutual funds perform relative to their benchmarks and industry standards.

The core problem lies in determining whether Nippon's mutual fund schemes deliver competitive, stable, and risk-adjusted performance over time. There is limited consolidated research that compares the fund performance using key metrics such as NAV trends, Sharpe ratio, Treynor ratio, Jensen's alpha, beta, and overall portfolio behavior. Without such analysis, investors lack clear insights into the efficiency of fund management and the ability of Nippon schemes to generate returns that justify their associated risks.

Therefore, this study aims to address the gap by critically analyzing the performance, consistency, and risk characteristics of Nippon mutual funds, enabling investors and policymakers to make informed decisions based on empirical evaluation rather than assumptions or fragmented information.

OBJECTIVES:-

1. To select the certain mutual funds schemes from Nippon India mutual fund ltd based on performance.
2. To analyse the risk and return of selected schemes from Nippon India mutual fund ltd.
3. To compare the schemes and select the best schemes.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE:-

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- Nisha Chalshi. A & Vidya. R (2022). This study aims to find the blue-chip schemes, which are essentially equities funds, are recognized to be the best mutual fund schemes and the safest to invest in since they regularly yield high profits over an extended period of time and have a risk return. The study is descriptive in nature, and the data source is secondary data that was gathered over a five-year period from the sample of the top five blue chip funds in India. The Jensen's ratio, Treynor's, and Sharpe's ratio statistical tool used in this study. The study shows that positive returns will result from positive market performance and vice versa.
 - Krishna Prasanna Vaitla (2022). This study focused on small caps mutual funds, of which eight were taken into consideration for the analysis since they are sector-specific funds that cater to investors who are more interested in returns during their peak earning phase. The eight were compared in this way and divided into two groups: one was entirely pre- pandemic, and the other was via pandemic circumstances. The findings demonstrated that there is relatively little risk associated with pandemics, which is encouraging since it suggests that investors are envisioning long-term investment plans on small-cap mutual funds
 - Siddhi Shah (2022). The purpose of this research is to help mutual fund investors choose better funds as investment outlets by identifying the risk and returns associated with equity funds and comparing them to peers' results. to assess the growth of the mutual fund sector in India as well as the performance of the chosen Equity/Growth schemes offered by SBI Mutual Fund. To rank and assess mutual funds, they use the Treynor, Sharpe, and Jensen ratio. According to the study, speculating with mutual funds is secure. Using mutual funds is sometimes the only way for investors to invest in a portfolio that is intellectually varied.
 - Chaitra K S (2022). Understanding the mutual fund market is the goal of this study. researching the small cap mutual fund industry's performance rating. to understand some specific small cap mutual fund products' risk and return. To evaluate the plans that yield the highest return during the duration of the study. should be aware of the relationship between risk and return on the plan.

Research Methodology

1. Research Design

This study adopts a descriptive and analytical research design. The descriptive component focuses on understanding the structure, types, and general characteristics of Nippon India Mutual Fund schemes. The analytical component evaluates the performance of selected mutual funds using quantitative financial metrics to derive meaningful insights.

2. Data Collection

- **Type of Data:** The study relies primarily on secondary data.
- **Sources:** Data will be collected from reputable financial sources such as AMFI reports, NSE/BSE databases, Nippon India Mutual Fund's official publications, Moneycontrol, Value Research, and annual fund fact-sheets.

- **Data Period:** The performance of selected funds will be analyzed for a period of 3 to 5 years (or a period chosen based on availability and relevance).

Schemes Selected: A representative sample of Nippon's equity, debt, and hybrid mutual fund schemes will be chosen to analyze both risk and return behavior.

3. Tools and Techniques for Analysis

To evaluate the performance of Nippon mutual funds, the following financial tools and statistical techniques will be employed:

- **Net Asset Value (NAV) Analysis:** Measures the historical performance trend of each scheme.
- **Risk-Return Analysis:**
- **Sharpe Ratio:** Evaluates excess return per unit of total risk.
- **Treynor Ratio:** Measures return generated per unit of systematic risk.
- **Jensen's Alpha:** Determines whether the fund outperforms its expected return.
- **Beta & Standard Deviation:** Assess the volatility and market risk of the fund.
- **Benchmark Comparison:** Each scheme's performance will be compared against its respective market benchmark index.
- **Portfolio Analysis:** Examines asset allocation, sector exposure, and fund diversification.
- **Statistical Techniques:** Mean, variance, correlation, and regression (if required) to explore relationships between fund returns and market fluctuations.

4. Sampling Technique

A purposive sampling method will be used to select mutual fund schemes that have stable historical data, represent different categories, and exhibit significant investor interest.

5. Data Analysis Procedure

1. Collect NAV data and historical returns for each selected Nippon fund.
2. Compute risk and performance ratios using financial formulas.
3. Compare fund performance with benchmarks and category averages.
4. Interpret results to understand consistency, volatility, and manager efficiency.
5. Draw conclusions on whether Nippon funds deliver competitive risk-adjusted returns.

Limitations of the Study

The analysis depends wholly on the availability and accuracy of secondary data.

- Market fluctuations, economic events, or fund manager decisions during the study period may influence performance outcomes.
- Only selected schemes are analyzed, which may not fully represent all Nippon

S.NO	KEY FEATURES	NIPPON INDIA MUTUAL FUNDS LTD
1	STANDARD DEVIATION	2.16
2	BETA	0.56
3	SHARPE RATIO	0.65
4	JENSEN'S ALPHA	1.10
5	TREYNOR'S RATIO	0.02

funds.

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION:-

AGGRESSIVE HYBRID FUND

(in percentage)

Source: Secondary data

RISK ANALYSIS FOR AGGRESSIVE HYBRID FUND

S.NO	KEY FEATURES	NIPPON INDIA MUTUAL FUNDS LTD
1	STANDARD DEVIATION	10.78
2	BETA	1.11
3	SHARPE RATIO	0.89
4	JENSEN'S ALPHA	3.30
5	TREYNOR'S RATIO	0.09

INTERPRETATION:

The Aggressive Hybrid Fund demonstrates a high Standard Deviation of 10.78 and a Beta of 1.11, indicating significant market risk and volatility. However, the fund delivers a favorable risk-adjusted return, as reflected by the Sharpe Ratio of 0.89.

The Jensen's Alpha of 3.30 highlights the strong performance of the fund manager in generating returns above the expected benchmark. Additionally, the Treynor's Ratio of 0.09 suggests a moderate return per unit of systematic risk, showcasing the fund's ability to balance risk and reward effectively.

TABLE 2. RISK ANALYSIS FOR CONSERVATIVE HYBRID FUND

Source: Secondary data

CHART 2. RISK ANALYSIS FOR CONSERVATIVE HYBRID FUND

INTERPRETATION:

The Conservative Hybrid Fund is characterized by a low Standard Deviation of 2.16 and a Beta of 0.56, indicating reduced volatility and lower sensitivity to market fluctuations. The Sharpe Ratio of 0.65 and Jensen's Alpha of 1.10 reflect moderate risk-adjusted returns and reasonable fund performance. However, the Treynor's Ratio of 0.02 suggests minimal returns per unit of systematic risk, aligning with the fund's low-risk profile.

FINDINGS

Aggressive funds often allocate a higher proportion to high-growth sectors like technology, finance, and infrastructure.

Conservative funds prefer stable sectors like FMCG, utilities, and healthcare.

Aggressive funds show strong positive correlation with market upswings, amplifying gains during bull markets.

Conservative funds are resilient during market downturns, preserving capital better in bearish phases.

Funds with lower expense ratios tend to deliver better net returns over the long term, especially in conservative categories.

High-expense aggressive funds require exceptional performance to offset management costs.

Multi-asset allocation funds benefit from blending equities, debt, and other assets, reducing overall portfolio risk.

CONCLUSION:-

The study underscores the critical role of tailored investment strategies in optimizing portfolio performance while effectively managing associated risks. Investors need to align their portfolios with specific financial goals and risk tolerances to achieve long-term success. By leveraging advanced analytical models like Sharpe, Treynor, and Jensen's indexes, the assessment of risk-adjusted returns becomes more precise, enabling better decisionmaking. Diversification remains a cornerstone of sound portfolio management, as it mitigates risks associated with overexposure to any single asset class or sector. Dynamic portfolio rebalancing further enhances performance by adjusting allocations in response to market conditions, ensuring that portfolios remain

aligned with the investor's objectives. Technological tools, such as machine learning and real-time analytics, provide valuable insights into market trends and potential risks, empowering investors to act proactively. Incorporating international securities and alternative assets adds an additional layer of diversification, reducing reliance on domestic markets and enhancing portfolio resilience. The findings of this study highlight that well-informed and adaptive strategies are indispensable for optimizing returns and managing risks in today's dynamic financial landscape.

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A STUDY ON IMPACT OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE ON EMPLOYMENT

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Abstract :-

Artificial Intelligence is a growing technology in current generation and it is impacts on employment. AI is taking over routine tasks in manufacturing, retailing, customer service, threatening job losses, etc. This technology transforming employment, displacement of traditional job roles and creating new roles whichever's are AI skills role jobs. It is changing employment and workforce dynamics worldwide. AI also opens new fields like data science, cybersecurity, AI ethics or requiring new skills and requiring advanced workforce training & development etc. This paper investigates the impact of AI on job market, it discusses how AI can both create new job opportunities and potentially displace traditional roles across various industries. This paper examines the AI adoption's socioeconomic effects on income inequality, employment polarization and work-life balance.

Keywords: - Artificial Intelligence, Growing Technology, Impact on Employment, Demand.

Introduction :-

Now a days, AI has become a part of our everyday lives. AI is one of the growing technology. The goal of AI is to create machines that can think like humans and also perform tasks with the capabilities of human minds. AI can enables machines to think, learn and adapt like a human being. AI is a transformative field of technology that focuses on creating systems that typically require human intelligence, learning such things, etc.

AI is changing the job market, creating new type of jobs while automating routine tasks. While some industries may experience significant job displacement. AI growth affects the job market. AI technology helps to improve work progress but this technology displace the traditional job roles. AI helps the economy grow and doesn't leave people behind. This research aims to provide insights into navigating the challenges and opportunities presented by AI in the employment, workforce and society.

Artificial Intelligence is taking a lot of jobs and the impact of the same is pretty visible all over the globe. Now, Noble Laureate Geoffrey Hinton also known as the Godfather of Artificial Intelligence (AI), has suggested that the development in Artificial Intelligence will leave millions of people jobless in the future and only Elon Musk will get richer in the meantime. The 360 degree transformation of the

industry is not something new, as we have seen a lot of companies adopting AI and laying off a plethora of people, including IBM, TCS, Google, and Amazon, etc.

Problem Statement of the Study :-

1. Understanding the impact of widespread AI adoption on the labor market.
2. Anticipating future demand for new skills in an AI-driven economy.
3. Analyzing the role of education and training in preparing the workforce for AI changes.
4. The rapid growth of AI causes job displacement.
5. The development in Artificial Intelligence will leave millions of people jobless in the future

Objectives of the Study :-

1. To Understand the Concept of AI
2. To Find Out Risks and Challenges for Employment
3. To Understand the AI Transforming Employment

Hypothesis of the Study :-

H1 :- Artificial Intelligence can make robotics think, learn or solve problems like humans by using data and to perform tasks more efficiently and accurately than humans alone.

H2 :- The job market is uncertain and people don't have the specific skills employers are looking for it becomes much harder and more stressful for them to find and maintain employment.

Purpose of the Study :-

The purpose of this study is to examine how AI impacts on employment, job market, workforce and identifying challenges for AI new job roles.

Review of Literature :-

1. **Mrs. Vinaya Keskar, Mrs. Shital Kare, Mrs. Vinita Kadlag & Ms. Manisha Bharambe (July 2025) :-** Found the textbook AI FOR EVERYONE-I published by NIRALI PRAKASHAN , it is relevant to all AI impacts, benefits, challenges, risks, how to use , how its works, Applications of Artificial Intelligence, AI in Healthcare, Finance, Transportation, Customer service and Chatbots, Education, Impact of AI on Employment and the workforce, etc.
2. **<https://myexceed.com/how-ai-is-changing-the-job-market/> (6th July 2025) :-**In 2025 how AI is reshaping the job market, Threats, opportunities and some points like New Job roles, Growing Demand for

human skills, Hybrid Human is known as AI Collaboration, etc.

3. <https://myexeed.com/ai-in-the-workplace/> (13th Sep 2024) :-
AI transforming employment in the workplace, Evolution of AI in workplace,
Creation of New Job opportunities through AI, Job Displacement and transition,
etc.

Research Methodology :-

- **PRIMARY DATA**

Primary data was collected through questionnaire survey method. Primary data was collected by interacting with various people in Pune City. A Google form was used to create an online survey specifically for this study. A structured self-developed research questions has been created to collect data. Online methods were used to get the data. It was administered to about 33 respondents. The questionnaire was sent using social media platforms to gather primary data. It consists of 15 questions that were designed to find out what various people were thinking about Artificial Intelligence (AI).

- **SECONDARY DATA**

Secondary Data refers to information already published. Secondary data comes from various sources like published academic books, reference books, websites, articles via internet, etc. The key advantage of secondary data is that, it is already available, time saving and resources, but it requires careful evaluation to ensure relevance and accuracy.

Sampling Size :- For this research project I have taken 33 responses.

Sampling Area :- Katraj

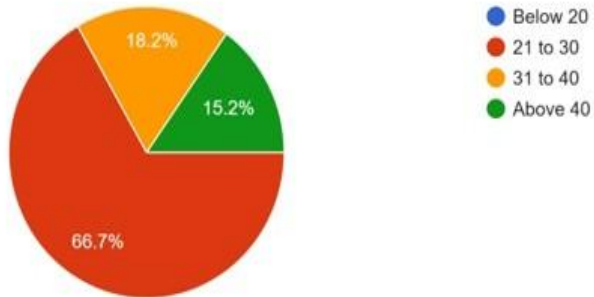
Sampling Period :- I have done this research paper in 1 month.

Data Analysis & Interpretation : Source :- Primary Data

Type :- Survey by Using Google Form

1. What is your Age ?

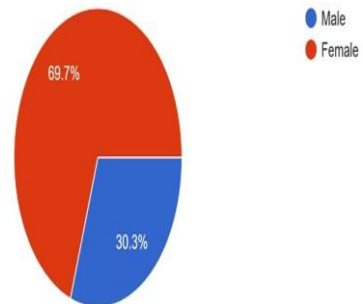
33 responses



Age group	Responses	Percentage
Below 20	0	0%
21 to 30	22	66.7%
31 to 40	6	18.2%
Above 40	5	15.2%
Total	33	100%
Gender	Responses	Percentage
Male	10	30.3%
Female	23	69.7%
Total	33	100%

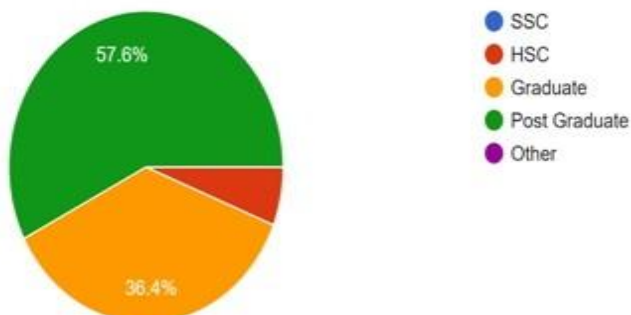
2. What is your Gender ?

33 responses



3. What is your Education ?

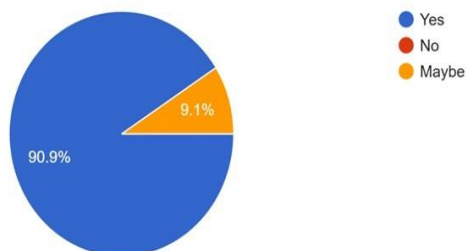
33 responses



Education	Responses	Percentage
SSC	0	0%
HSC	2	6%
Graduate	12	36.4%
Post Graduate	19	57.6%
Other	0	0%
Total	33	100%
Opinion	Responses	Percentage
Yes	30	90.9%
No	0	0%
Maybe	3	9.1%
Total	33	100%
Opinion	Responses	Percentage
Very Familiar	4	12.1%
Familiar	10	30.3%
Somewhat Familiar	10	30.3%
Not Familiar	9	27.3%
Total	33	100%

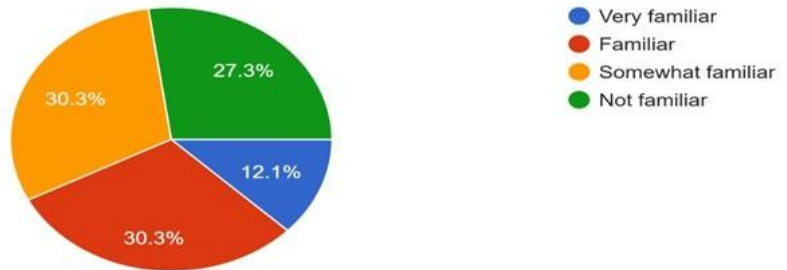
4. Have you heard about AI ?

33 responses



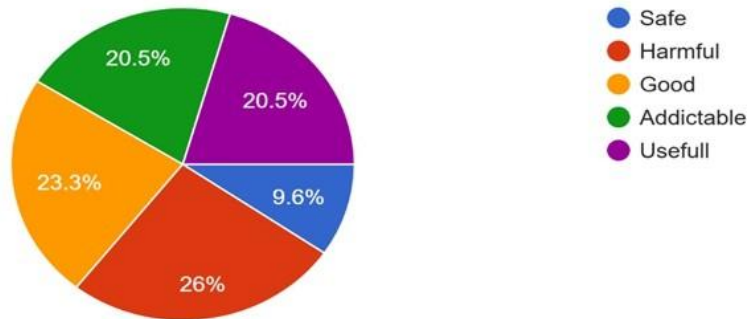
5. How familiar are you with artificial intelligence (AI)?

33 responses



6. What is your opinion about AI?

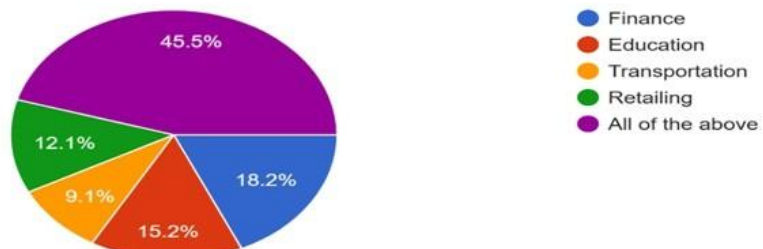
33 responses



Opinion	Responses	Percentage
Safe	3	9.6%
Harmful	10	26%
Good	8	23.3%
Addictable	6	20.5%
Useful	6	20.5%
Total	33	100%

7. Which industries do you think will be most affected by AI?

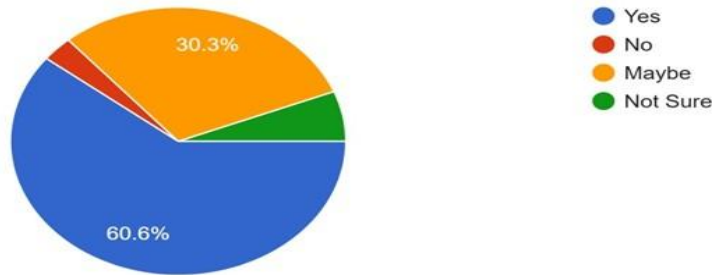
33 responses



Industries	Responses	Percentage
Finance	6	18.2
Education	5	15.2%
Transportation	3	9.1%
Retailing	4	12.1%
All of the above	15	45.5%
Total	33	100%

8. AI impacts on Job market or employment trends ?

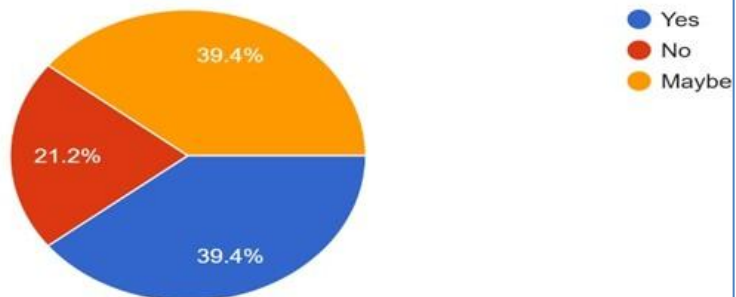
33 responses



Opinion	Responses	Percentage
Yes	20	60.6%
No	1	2.9%
Maybe	10	30.3%
Not Sure	2	6.2%
Total	33	100%

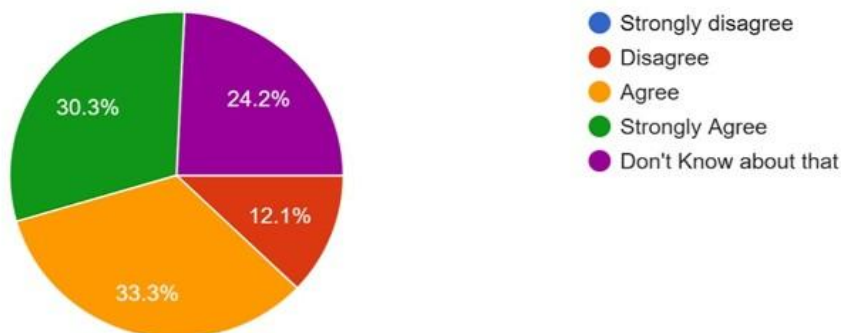
9. Do you believe on AI ?

33 responses



10. Do you agree that the unemployment rate is increasing after AI came ?

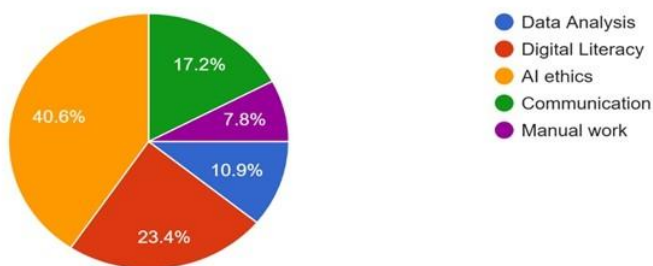
33 responses



Opinion	Responses	Percentage
Yes	13	39.4%
No	7	21.2%
Maybe	13	39.4%
Total	33	100%

11. What new skills do you think will be most essential for employees in an AI-integrated workplace?

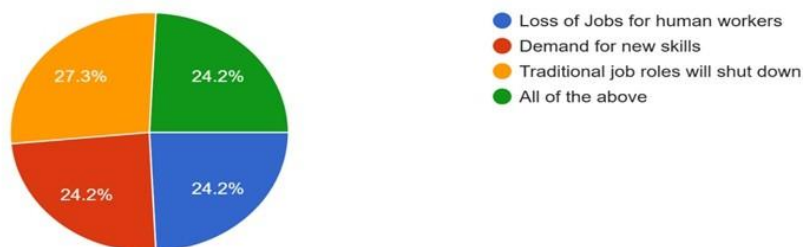
33 responses



Opinion	Responses	Percentage
Strongly Disagree	0	0%
Disagree	4	12.1%
Agree	11	33.3%
Strongly Agree	10	30.3%
Don't Know about that	8	24.2%
Total	33	100%

12. What is the biggest concern regarding AI's impact on the future employment ?

33 responses

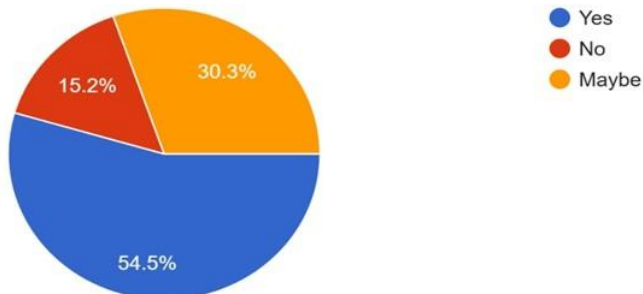


Skills	Responses	Percentage
Data Analysis	3	10.9%
Digital Literacy	8	23.4%
AI ethics	14	40.6%
Communication	6	17.2%
Manual Work	2	7.8%
Total	33	100%

Concern	Responses	Percentage
Loss of jobs for human workers	8	24.2%
Demand for new skills	8	24.2%
Traditional job roles will shut down	9	27.3%
All of the above	8	24.2%
Total	33	100%

13. Do you feel adequately prepared to work alongside AI tools in your current role ?

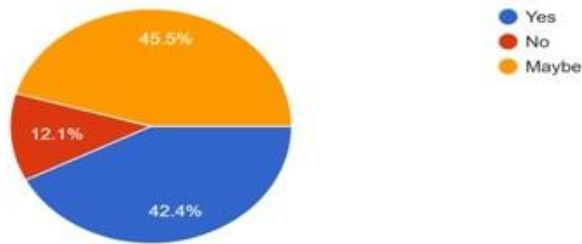
33 responses



Opinion	Responses	Percentage
Yes	18	54.5%
No	5	15.2%
Maybe	10	30.3%
Total	33	100%

14. Do you anticipate that the introduction of AI will lead to a reduction in workforce salaries ?

33 responses



Opinion	Responses	Percentage
Yes	14	42.4%
No	5	15.2%
Maybe	10	30.3%
Don't Know	4	12.1%
Total	33	100%

Findings of the Study :-

- Artificial Intelligence (AI) is studying how human brain thinks, learn, decides, works, etc.
- The development of Artificial Intelligence will help to growth of country but it will impact on job displacement.
- The development in Artificial Intelligence will leave millions of people jobless in the future.
- Artificial Intelligence (AI) is already taking a lot of jobs and the impact of the same is pretty visible all over the globe.
- Artificial Intelligence (AI) rapid growth may harmful for employment.

Suggestions :-

- Stay proactive about updating and acquiring new skills that are in demand in the Artificial Intelligence driven economy.
- Seek out training opportunities, online courses, certifications to develop expertise in areas such as data analysis, programming and Artificial Intelligence ethics.
- Make sure that Artificial Intelligence systems are transparent, fair and accountable to build trust with employees, customers and stakeholders.
- Instead of seeing Artificial Technology as a threat, work with it and find ways to use its potential to increase productivity and efficiency in the workplace.
- Invest time to gain more knowledge about new skills.

Conclusion :-

Artificial Intelligence possesses the capacity to revolutionize all types of organizations. It impacts various sectors like manufacturing, retailing, labor work etc. The impact of AI on employment is a complex & multifaceted issue that requires careful consideration of various factors. AI technologies continue to evolve and become more integrated into business operations. However, this does not necessarily translate to widespread unemployment.

References-

Mrs. Vinaya Keskar, Mrs. Shital Kare, Mrs. Vinita Kadlag & Ms. Manisha Bharambe (July 2025) :- Found the textbook AI FOR EVERYONE-I published by NIRALI PRAKASHAN ,
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<https://myexceed.com/ai-in-the-workplace/>

COST MANAGEMENT PRACTICES IN MANUFACTURING INDUSTRIES

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ABSTRACT

In Current scenario business environment has undergone several changes viz technological changes, strong competition from global and domestic markets and other factors made companies to focus on cost management which is the core component driving the business firms towards profit maximization objective. Cost management practices certainly influence the financial performance of any company. The objectives of the present study are to understand the importance of cost management in reducing and controlling costs of manufacturing industries, to look over the cost control techniques which help the companies to maximize profitability and reduce costs, to understand the major benefits of cost management. Besides these authors of research article have made a humble attempt to review existing empirical literature pertaining to cost management. In order to structure the article data has been collected from secondary sources through published articles in national and international journal of repute, online sources, EBSCOhost is used to collect research papers published in cost management domain. Present study is purely conceptual, descriptive and exploratory in nature and content analysis technique is used and the findings of the study revealed that budgetary control, standard costing, and quality control are major cost control techniques. There are limited empirical evidences related to cost management practices in manufacturing industries with reference to Indian context.

Keywords: Cost Management, Cost Control, Profitability, Budgetary Control, Standard Costings

INTRODUCTION

The main objective of any business entity is to maximize their profits management of every firm is more concerned towards profitability it is important to understand that manufacturing industries need to increase their sales volume this may facilitates business entity to increase production capacity which in turn results in higher production costs. For every business unit it is important to earn desirable profits, hence cost management practices are highly important since business units are more cost centric and profit oriented it is necessary to have a cost structure which facilitates the firms to reach the target performance. Global and domestic firms are competing with each other and high competition between industries have made companies to concentrate on cost structure and controlling

techniques it has become success mantra for modern industries.

Every firm has to concentrate on operational issues connected to cost, quality and survival in heighten business competition on the other hand, customer's expect high quality products at affordable price. Besides this Shareholders of any firm expect reasonable returns on their investments. The generation of earnings highly depends on efficient cost management practices adopted by the firms and the survival of any business highly depends on its business strategy and cost practices. The major problem faced by manufacturing industries is increased input costs if these issues are not address on right time, it may adversely affect the profitability of business units.

When the firm aims to maximize their earnings obviously it has to reduce operational and input costs keeping in view of customers the responsibility of the entity is to produce the superior quality products at affordable cost if the companies may fail to maintain cost structure. Firm has to strike off the balance between customer expectations and cost control. If a company fails to meet the expectations of customers they may switch to other competitor products this adversely affect the earnings of every company so it very important for every business unit to have a cost structure and minimize the cost.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

1. To examine the cost management practices and impact on firm performance through extensive review of literature in cost management domain.
2. To develop a conceptual frame work for cost control and cost management practices to manufacturing industries.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

The present section of research article is devoted to literature review related to cost management practices in manufacturing industries and also to establish the base for understanding cost reducing and cost controlling techniques used across global manufacturing industries. The literature survey helps the others to formulate objectives and identify the research gap exist in this domain besides this author have covered theoretical, empirical studies carried out across the globe were considered.

Cost management practices are associated with cost data which help the managers to make decisions and also helps to control and reduce the costs shank and Govindrajan (1989) cost strategies helps the companies to achieve their long term objectives companies aims to survive in business from its competitors (Ghanashyam and Radhe 2016) with the passage of time certain theories have emerged related to costing viz, traditional cost theory, differential cost theory

and value-engineering theory. Traditional cost theory distinguishes short term costs from long term costs. Short term costs are related with fixed determinants capital equipment is identified as fixed determinant in short run cost other factors are observed as variable factors in long run. Traditional theory of cost split total cost components in fixed and variable costs. Traditional cost theory facilitates the firm to determine level of outputs with optimum production with lower costs, (Koutosoyiannis, 1988). Contextual theory of costs incurred in production activities are represented as expense in income statement during period benefit cost of operations (Garrison, Noreen and seal, 2003). Value engineering theory aims to present organized financial information and facilitates evaluation of improving performance by reducing production costs.

Cost Management and Cost Control

Management of cost practices adopted by the industries has significant influence on organizational performance. Many production activities involved in production process add up costs and it is very significant check the costs because in order to establish standards. This may facilitate to trace out the difference between actual and standard costs of production. There is a need to control the costs to make sure that efficient utilization of resources to attain long term objective of the company. Syverson (2011) argues cost can be minimized by profit maximization he opines management of company should employ methodologies and techniques to control cost rather than cost reduction. Costs and expenses may affect revenue. The summary of cost may assist the firms to make pricing decisions. Cost control technique determines activities undertaken by business; firms should adopt cost control techniques to minimize cost. There are many inputs cost associated with production activity which may increase production costs in such cases there is a need to compare the standard with actual costs, the variance can be identified and controlled through cost control techniques. It is crucial to understand the cost control in manufacturing industries because to efficiently use the resources and also control techniques may help to align with management plans. It is very essential in manufacturing sector to determine the costs with budgeted also facilitates financial misappropriations. Horngren et.al (2012) opines budget is important for managers and employees to understand the objectives of entity and to confirm with standards of production activities, the budget act as controlling technique to realize the target of production and cost reduction. Siyanlola and Raji (2013) stressed that budget serve as important tool ensure cost control, facilitates comparison between actual and projected examines the major deviations and helps to analyse the reasons for such deviation and help to take appropriate decisions. Bedilu (2015) opines budgeting act as control mechanism in manufacturing industries and significantly influence financial performance of company. The advantage of budgeting is

communicating the targets which also involve managers and employees in the budgeting process also they become more conscious towards organization goals. In manufacturing industries, the tasks are iterative in nature hence standard costing is appropriate technique to control the cost in manufacturing units. Sikka (2003) opines standard costing facilitates comparison with actual and standards it is useful in monitoring financial performance that identify variations between projected and actual helps to analyse more effectively. Larry and Christopher (2009) standard costing serve as tool to determine standards compared with actual performance to measure the variance and facilitates fixation of responsibility to the executives. A report can be presented in front of management to make decisions associated with production and operational costs. Jalaee (2012) in their research work, cost control facilitates to become price leader it doesn't concentrate on product re-design it aims at examining the cost elements pertaining to all stages in product development process. These element cost comprises of operational, purchase price, supplies, repairs and maintenance costs. Target costing emphasizes on reducing cost of operations during all the stage product life cycle. Value analysis serves as an important tool for management which focus on saving costs through value analysis helps to examine and methods of production activities and recommends for improvements (Horgreen et.al.2012). Akeem (2017) it is an approach to assess systematically the value chain components with an objective to minimize cost and achieving quality that meet requirements of customers the technique is popularly known as value engineering and focus is with reference to product value.

Empirical Review

Akeem (2017) in their research work author has made an attempt to examine the impact of cost control and cost reduction techniques on organization performance. The data has collected through questionnaire and used regression analysis as tool to test hypothesis using SPSS software. Results of the study revealed that positive impact on organization performance was observed. Furthermore, author suggests the company to set realistic standards to achieve the goals. Siyanbola and Raji (2013) had examined cost control impact on manufacturing industries profitability of west African Portland cement company the author has used primary sources viz, questionnaire, observation and personal interview methods to collect data 74 respondents from all departments of company have chosen. Pearson correlation analysis is used to examine the relationship the outcomes revealed that cost control has positive effect on company profitability The findings of the study revealed that cost control significantly impacts organization performance, good cost system is also concerned with employee behaviour because they are instrumental in achieving organization goals. Olalekani and Tajudeen (2015) examined the cost control influence on Survival of Nigerian

bottle companies. Researcher had employed both primary and secondary data in his work, t-test is used to examine the hypothetical statements. Author has observed that direct costs, labour, material and manufacturing costs have positively significant with profitability of company. The authors of the article recommend to use value analysis, just in time techniques to meet production capacity and they opine good budgeting procedure is key for cost reduction and control. Adebayo et.al, (2014) assessed the influence of budgetary control on cost control, profitability of manufacturing industries. They collected primary data from 190 respondents of Cadbury Nigeria ltd, Friesland food Nigeria and Nestle companies. The structured questionnaire is used to collect primary data from respondents and chi-square test is used to process the data with SPSS software, authors recommend the companies to use cost control techniques to minimize costs and improve quality required for customers. Azeez and Adelabu (2015) examined the association between cost management practices and profitability of select 5 companies. Primary data has been collected through structured questionnaire from 230 randomly selected employees related to all departments, the data has been analysed using descriptive statistics and non-parametric tests are used. Correlation analysis is employed and found positive association between cost management practices and profitability and it is highly correlated. Caroline (2014) made an attempt to understand the effect of cost management practices on financial performance of manufacturing units. A sample of six companies listed in Nairobi stock exchange was chosen authors have collected data from primary and secondary sources obtained from respondents and audited financial reports and causal research design developed multiple regression models. The outcomes of analysis have revealed a positive association between cost management practices and financial performance of companies listed in Nairobi stock exchange.

Research Gap

The authors of the article made an attempt to trace out the research gap pertaining to cost management practices and its impact on manufacturing industries. However, after doing extensive literature survey it was found that there is positive relationship exist between cost management practices and profitability of manufacturing industries, still this area remains debatable because business entities concentrate on cost control and reduction on the other hand manufacturing quality products for customers with least possible cost is major challenge. If the company not able to meet customer quality specifications customers may switch to competitor offerings which affect adversely on firm profitability. Besides, only few research works are carried out in India and globally few research works are available with respect to cost management. Hence, there is scope for research in this area.

Proposed Conceptual Frame Work

The above conceptual frame work is developed after conducting extensive literature survey on cost management practices adopted by manufacturing industries. The frame work may help to establish the relationship between variables to examine the impact of cost management practices on profitability.

1. Top Management support helps to establish standards, determine long term objectives, preparation of budgets, and assessment of performance at each level of production process.
2. Employee participation and involvement in production process, preparation of cost budgets, formulation of organization goals, training and motivating the employees through monetary and non-monetary benefits because human resources are idealistic in achieving organization goals and helps in minimizing costs.
3. Both traditional and modern techniques can be used to control the cost of operations.
4. Standardization of work procedures, preparation of standard cost management system enables to compare the differences between actual and standards, the performance can be measured through variance analysis and also facilitates decision making in reducing and cost control.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

The present study is purely conceptual, descriptive and exploratory in nature, the authors of the article collected necessary secondary data from research articles published in national and international journals, EBSCOhost database, online sources, articles with good citations are collected and content analysis approach is used to structure the research articles. Articles available in English language and published works from globally related to cost management were majorly concentrated.

Cost Management Practices In Manufacturing Industries

1. The production cost is the major indicator for financial performance of every organization it determines the efficiency of organization performance in terms of operations.
2. Cost control is associated with determination of difference between actual performance and standard performance of the organization. The identification of activities, monitoring and assessment of activities enables decision making process through corrective measures to eliminate deviations in production process.
3. Cost Control in organization is carried out through cost analysis which helps the firm to assess the opportunities to improve production viz, product development, design, pricing, profitability etc. the cost data is collected and monitored carefully

to measure the deviation between standard set by top management and actual performance achieved.

4. From the empirical literature survey, it was found that cost management practices significantly influence the financial performance of manufacturing industries.

5. It was observed that manufacturing industries have concentrated on tools and techniques such as Just in time, value engineering, standard costing, budgetary control, target costing to minimize and control costs thereby manufacturing industries achieve higher profits.

6. It was found that very limited works on cost management practices are available from Indian context globally few research works are carried out in this area.

7. Responsibility centres have to be established at each functional units in Manufacturing industry to evaluate the financial performance of company.

CONCLUSION

The present study aims to understand the cost management practices and its impact on profitability of manufacturing industries. The material costs, labour costs, manufacturing overhead costs are classified under manufacturing costs. Cost controlling and reduction can be done through elimination of wastes, utilization of materials, usage of labours and monitoring of costs at each functional unit of manufacturing industry. Reduction and cost control is possible through integration of entire top management support, employee participation and understanding objectives of company, establishment of responsibility centres for setting standards, to measure the performance. The ultimate objective of every firm is to enhance profitability that can be achieved through effective cost control and reduction striking the balance between cost reductions and offering quality production. Still this area remains open for conducting research in India very limited works are conducted but few works are carried out in global context. It is important to understand the impact of cost control on profitability of manufacturing companies. Hence, it is suggested to conduct more research works in this area.

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A STUDY DEPRECIATION AND TAXATION OF CONSTRUCTION MACHINERY: ACCOUNTING & GST IMPLICATION

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ABSTRACT

The construction industry is one of the most capital-intensive sectors in India, relying heavily on costly machinery such as excavators, cranes, concrete mixers, and loaders. Proper accounting for depreciation and taxation of these assets is essential for financial accuracy, cost management, and compliance with statutory laws. This research paper examines how Sathe Developers Company, located at Marunji, Pune, manages depreciation and taxation of its construction machinery in accordance with the Income Tax Act, 1961, Companies Act, 2013, and GST (Goods and Services Tax) laws, 2017.

The study aims to understand how depreciation impacts profitability, taxable income, and the utilization of GST input tax credit on capital goods. Using both primary data (interviews with accounting and site management staff) and secondary data (financial records, audit reports, and GST filings), the paper provides a realistic analysis of machinery cost allocation and tax optimization practices. It was observed that depreciation not only affects financial reporting but also plays a crucial role in determining the timing and extent of tax benefits claimed by the company.

The research further explores methods of depreciation — primarily the Written Down Value (WDV) method as prescribed under the Income Tax Act — and its influence on project costing and profitability. Findings indicate that efficient depreciation management, combined with accurate GST input credit utilization, results in improved cash flow and financial stability for construction

The study concludes that integrating accounting standards with taxation compliance helps companies like Sathe Developers reduce operational costs, maintain accurate asset valuations, and enhance transparency in financial reporting. It highlights the need for continuous awareness and training in accounting policies and GST regulations among construction finance professionals to ensure sustainable growth and tax efficiency.

KEYWORDS-Depreciation, Taxation, Construction Machinery, Accounting, GST Implications.

INTRODUCTION:

The construction industry in India plays a vital role in infrastructure development and economic growth. It involves high-value investments in machinery such as excavators, cranes, bulldozers, concrete mixers, and loaders. These machines, though essential, undergo continuous wear and tear, making depreciation a critical accounting concept in the sector.

Depreciation represents the reduction in the value of an asset over time due to usage, obsolescence, or natural deterioration. From an accounting perspective, it ensures that the cost of machinery is systematically allocated over its useful life, aligning with the matching principle of accounting.

In the taxation domain, depreciation serves as a significant deductible expense under the Income Tax Act, 1961, thereby reducing the taxable profits of a construction enterprise. For companies like HP Developers, managing depreciation effectively ensures accurate financial reporting and optimized tax liability.

The introduction of Goods and Services Tax (GST) in 2017 brought further implications for machinery accounting. Under GST law, construction companies are eligible to claim Input Tax Credit (ITC) on the purchase of capital goods, provided the depreciation on the GST portion is not claimed under the Income Tax Act. This dual regulation requires careful coordination between accounting and taxation departments.

This study explores how Sathe Developers applies depreciation methods, records machinery costs, and utilizes GST credits to achieve financial efficiency. It emphasizes real-world applications, challenges, and the practical balance between accounting standards and tax regulations.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Construction companies face multiple accounting and tax compliance challenges in managing high-value machinery. Improper calculation or reporting of depreciation can lead to:

- Overstatement or understatement of profits
- Incorrect tax liability

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- Disallowance of GST input credits
 - Non-compliance with audit and financial disclosure standards

Sathe Developers, like many mid-sized construction firms, must maintain a balance between financial reporting accuracy and tax efficiency. The primary problem addressed in this study is how the company integrates depreciation accounting, tax computation, and GST compliance to ensure transparent and efficient financial management.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

1. To analyze the impact of depreciation on taxation and profitability in construction machinery accounting.
2. To examine the GST implications on machinery purchase and maintenance.
3. To study the accounting practices followed by HP Developers for fixed asset management.
4. To evaluate how depreciation influences project cost estimation and financial performance.
5. To suggest improvements for integrating accounting, taxation, and GST systems efficiently.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Primary Data

Primary data was collected directly from HP Developers Company through structured interviews and questionnaires. Respondents included site engineers, accountants, finance executives, and project managers from the Marunji site and head office. The data focused on depreciation calculation methods, GST compliance practices, and machinery maintenance accounting.

Secondary Data

Secondary data was sourced from HP Developers' audited financial statements (2020–2025), annual reports, taxation records, and GST filings. Additional references included accounting standards published by the Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI), and government notifications under the Income Tax Act (1961) and CGST Act (2017).

Sample Size

The study covered 30 respondents:

- 10 from Finance & Accounting Department
- 12 from Site Management and Operations
- 8 from Procurement and Administration Research Design

This is a descriptive and analytical study, focusing on the relationship between depreciation and taxation. It examines both qualitative responses and quantitative data such as machinery cost, depreciation rate, and tax adjustments.

Research Method

The research combines both quantitative (financial data analysis, percentage comparison) and qualitative (expert interviews, interpretation) methods to draw comprehensive conclusions.

Sampling Area

Sathe Developers, Marunji, Pune

- Sathe Developers Construction Site, NH-48 Corridor Project

NEED, NATURE & SCOPE OF THE STUDY

Need of the Study

The study is essential because depreciation and taxation directly affect profitability, budgeting, and asset management. Many construction companies fail to align accounting standards with GST laws, leading to tax inefficiency. This research helps to understand how proper accounting can reduce liabilities and improve compliance.

Nature of the Study

This is an applied research study based on real data from HP Developers. It incorporates factual insights into how depreciation affects financial statements and tax computation. The study uses the Written Down Value (WDV) method, which is the most commonly applied depreciation approach under the Income Tax Act.

Scope of the Study:

The scope is limited to HP Developers' machinery such as excavators, cranes, loaders, and mixers. The study covers financial years 2020–2025, examining depreciation calculations, tax planning, and GST adjustments. It focuses on accounting integration rather than macroeconomic analysis

of the construction sector.

LITERATURE REVIEW

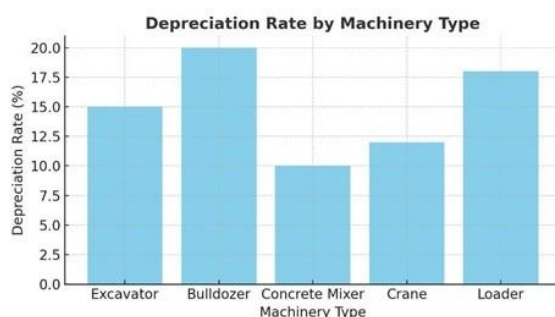
1. Accounting Standards and Depreciation (ICAI, 2023):
The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India defines depreciation as the systematic allocation of the depreciable amount of an asset over its useful life. It ensures that financial statements reflect true asset values and profitability.
2. Gupta (2021):
Found that construction firms using consistent depreciation policies achieve better tax control and avoid audit discrepancies.
3. Reddy and Singh (2022):
Their study on *GST implications on capital goods* found that firms claiming depreciation on the GST component lose eligibility for input tax credit, emphasizing the need for accurate accounting.
4. Income Tax Act, 1961:
Specifies different depreciation rates for various machinery under the WDV method. Construction equipment typically qualifies for 15%–30% depreciation rate, depending on its type and usage.
5. CGST Act, 2017:
Allows for input tax credit (ITC) on capital goods used for business purposes, provided no depreciation is claimed on the GST portion of the asset. These studies collectively highlight the importance of coordination between accounting and taxation systems, especially in capital-intensive industries like construction.

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

1. Depreciation Rate by Machinery Type

The following data represents Sathe Developers major construction machinery, cost details, and depreciation rates used for accounting and taxation between 2020 and 2025:

Machinery	Cost (Lakhs)	Depreciation Rate (%)	Useful Life (Years)
Excavator	85	15	8
Bulldozer	95	20	7
Concrete Mixer	40	10	10
Crane	120	12	9
Loader	70	18	6



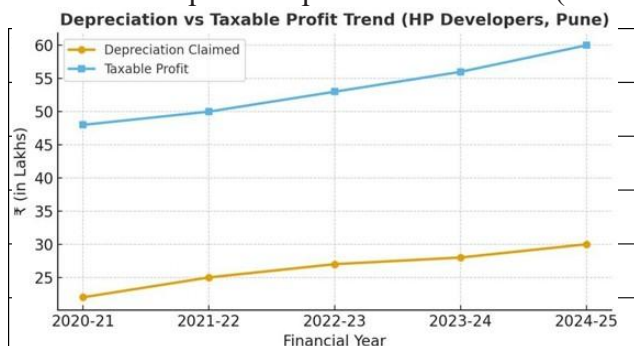
This bar graph shows the depreciation rates applied to different types of construction machinery used by HP Developers.

- Bulldozers (20%) and Loaders (18%) have the highest depreciation because of heavy and continuous site operations.
- Excavators (15%) and Cranes (12%) have moderate depreciation due to periodic maintenance.
- Concrete Mixers (10%) depreciate the least as they face less wear and tear.

The graph clearly indicates that machinery exposed to frequent mechanical stress and outdoor usage loses it.

1. Depreciation vs. Taxable Profit Trend (2020–2025)

This line chart compares Depreciation Claimed (Lakhs) and Taxable Profit (



Lakhs) over five years. This line graph compares Depreciation Claimed and Taxable Profit of Sathe Developers from 2020–21 to 2024–25.

It shows that even though depreciation claims increased each year (from 22 L to 30 L), the company's taxable profit also rose steadily (from 48 L to 60 L).

This indicates that HP Developers managed its assets efficiently — using depreciation as a tax-saving tool while maintaining overall profit growth through effective project cost management and GST credit utilization.

KEY FINDINGS

1. High-value machinery such as cranes and bulldozers showed the highest depreciation rates, reducing taxable income significantly.
2. HP Developers follows the Written Down Value (WDV) method, in compliance with the Income Tax Act, 1961, ensuring systematic asset valuation.
3. GST Input Tax Credit (ITC) on capital goods helped the company recover part of its tax outflow, improving cash flow and project profitability.
4. Depreciation accounted for 15–20% of total operating costs, highlighting its major influence on cost control and tax planning.
5. Proper alignment between accounting and taxation records reduced audit risks and enhanced financial transparency.
6. Over five years, HP Developers recorded a steady increase in profits, proving the benefit of structured accounting and tax management.

SUGGESTIONS

1. Maintain separate depreciation ledgers for financial accounting and tax computation to prevent discrepancies.
2. Conduct quarterly reconciliation between asset registers and GST returns to ensure compliance.
3. Provide periodic training for accounting staff on depreciation laws, GST updates, and tax reforms.
4. Use computerized accounting software (e.g., Tally, ERP systems) to automate depreciation calculations and GST credit tracking.
5. Reassess machinery life and residual value periodically to reflect realistic asset wear and tear.
6. Develop a tax planning strategy that optimizes depreciation and GST

benefits without affecting financial credibility.

CONCLUSION

The study concludes that depreciation and taxation play a critical role in managing the financial performance of construction companies like HP Developers. Effective depreciation practices ensure that machinery costs are accurately distributed over their useful life, reducing taxable income while maintaining compliance with the Income Tax Act.

Simultaneously, GST implications on capital goods provide significant financial relief through input credits, provided that depreciation is not claimed on the GST component. HP Developers demonstrated how integrating accounting, taxation, and GST practices leads to improved profitability, compliance, and operational efficiency. Thus, the study highlights that accurate asset accounting and tax planning not only optimize returns but also ensure long-term sustainability and transparency in the construction business.

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The Role of Forensic Accounting in Enhancing Auditor's Professional Skepticism and Fraud Detection Capability: An Empirical Study

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Abstract

Financial frauds have grown in complexity in recent decades, exposing the limitations of conventional audit approaches that were not designed to uncover deliberately concealed manipulations. This study investigates whether and how forensic accounting methods strengthen auditors' professional skepticism and improve their ability to detect fraud in Indian organisations. Primary data was collected using a structured questionnaire administered to **20 respondents** drawn from varied accounting and audit roles. The respondents included Chartered Accountants, internal auditors, accountants, finance managers, and postgraduate students specialising in advanced accounting and taxation. Results indicate that a substantial majority believe forensic accounting techniques raise auditors' questioning mindset (approximately **85%**) and that the use of forensic analytical tools boosts fraud detection accuracy (around **80%**). The research demonstrates a positive relationship between forensic exposure and improved audit judgment and suggests practical interventions — such as targeted training, incorporation of forensic modules in curricula, and mandated involvement of forensic procedures in risk-prone audits. The study argues that integrating forensic accounting within mainstream audit practice can significantly strengthen financial oversight and public trust in reporting.

Keywords: Forensic Accounting, Professional Skepticism, Fraud Detection, Auditing, Financial Crimes, Analytical Procedures.

1. Introduction

Over the last two decades, the mechanisms and scale of financial wrongdoing have transformed dramatically. The movement from straightforward embezzlement or misstatement toward elaborate schemes involving electronic records, fictitious transactions, and collusive networks means that traditional audit procedures — largely sample-based and compliance- oriented — are increasingly insufficient. Auditors are expected not only to verify figures but also to read underlying patterns that may signal

intentional concealment. In this context, forensic accounting has emerged as an interdisciplinary field that combines accounting knowledge with investigative techniques, statistical tools, and an understanding of legal processes to identify and substantiate fraud.

Professional skepticism is the mental attitude that enables auditors to remain alert to misstatements whether caused by error or fraud. Maintaining this skepticism is challenging in practice: practitioners face time pressures, familiarity with clients, and institutional constraints that can blunt critical judgement. High-profile corporate scandals worldwide — and several striking cases in India — have illustrated how reliance on routine audit approaches can allow major frauds to persist undetected. These events have prompted calls for auditors to adopt more investigative practices that test not only the accuracy of amounts but also the plausibility and intent behind transactions.

Financial statement manipulation often follows predictable mathematical patterns, and this has led researchers to explore statistical tools that support fraud detection. Among the most widely discussed tools is Benford's Law, a numerical rule frequently used in forensic analysis. As stated in foundational literature, “Benford's Law states that in many naturally occurring collections of numbers, the leading digit is likely to be small.” (Newcomb, 1881; Benford, 1938). This phenomenon, which holds across a wide range of datasets, provides auditors and forensic accountants with a scientific basis for detecting anomalies that indicate possible manipulation.

Given the rising complexity of fraud and the limitations of traditional audits, it becomes important to understand whether forensic accounting effectively strengthens auditors' skepticism and improves fraud detection. This research therefore examines the perception of auditors, accountants, forensic experts, and finance professionals regarding the integration of forensic techniques into audit engagements. By analyzing the responses of 20 professionals from the accounting and finance domain, this study provides empirical insight into how forensic accounting influences audit quality. The findings aim to contribute to academic research while offering practical implications for regulators, auditing firms, and accounting educators in India.

This empirical study examines the perception and practical experience of professionals in the Indian context to determine whether forensic accounting measurably strengthens auditors' skepticism and improves fraud detection. By combining primary responses with a review of relevant literature, the research aims to provide both theoretical and pragmatic insights that can inform training, regulation, and audit practice.

1. Objectives of the Study

This study has been framed to explore the relationship between forensic accounting practices and the effectiveness of auditing in detecting and deterring fraud. The objectives guide the research design and ensure the empirical work addresses both conceptual and practical dimensions of the topic.

Specific objectives:

1. To assess the extent to which forensic accounting techniques influence auditors' professional skepticism.
2. To evaluate whether the application of forensic tools enhances fraud detection effectiveness in audit engagements.
3. To examine practitioners' perceptions about the practical usefulness of forensic methods in everyday audit work.
4. To identify the major barriers (training, technology, organisational support) to adopting forensic accounting in routine audits.
5. To recommend practical measures for integrating forensic accounting into audit training and audit procedures to reduce audit risk.

2. Review of Literature

A concise review of prior research and authoritative sources establishes the theoretical and empirical backdrop for this study. The literature consistently suggests that forensic accounting adds investigative depth to auditing and can improve fraud detection, though challenges to implementation exist.

Golden, Skalak & Clayton (2006): Their foundational work frames forensic accounting as a discipline that blends accounting, auditing, and investigative methods. They emphasize that forensic accountants provide litigation support and trace evidence that conventional audits may not be equipped to collect. The authors document case examples where forensic procedures revealed intentional concealment and recommend that auditors incorporate investigative perspectives into their practice.

Crumbley, Heitger & Smith (2013): This text outlines forensic and investigative accounting techniques, stressing how systematic analytical procedures (e.g., ratio analysis, trend spotting, and document examination) enhance auditors' ability to identify anomalies. The authors argue that forensic tools support the exercise of professional skepticism by providing concrete, testable indicators of manipulation.

Owojori & Asaolu (2009): In the context of developing economies, Owojori and Asaolu discuss how forensic accounting can serve as a practical response to endemic fraud risks. They highlight institutional weaknesses and the necessity for auditors to be trained in investigative methods to counter complex fraud schemes shaped by local governance challenges.

Bhasin (2015): Focusing on Indian corporate frauds, Bhasin analyses high-profile cases and concludes that the absence of investigative emphasis within audits contributed to delayed detection. The study suggests that forensic techniques could have accelerated detection and facilitated regulatory action, and calls for more widespread forensic competence among practitioners. **Ramaswamy (2005):** Ramaswamy advocates for the formal integration of forensic accounting within auditing standards, arguing that proactive forensic procedures — applied selectively in high-risk audit areas — can significantly reduce audit failures. The author also discusses the ethical responsibilities of auditors to pursue evidence when red flags appear.

Collectively, the literature supports the proposition that forensic accounting strengthens audit outcomes, while also underscoring gaps in training, tools, and regulatory backing that hinder broad adoption. This study builds on those findings by providing fresh empirical evidence from Indian practitioners and students.

1. Research Methodology

This section explains how the study was designed and executed, the nature of data collected, and the analytical approach used to interpret findings.

The research uses an empirical, descriptive approach to capture both perceptions and self-reported practices among professionals. Given the aim to relate forensic exposure to skepticism and detection outcomes, primary data collection was prioritised, supplemented with secondary literature to contextualize findings.

1.1 Research Design

A descriptive-cum-exploratory design was adopted. The survey measures attitudes and experiences with forensic techniques and collects frequency data on tool usage and training. Descriptive statistics and simple inferential interpretation (correlation direction) are used to summaries relationships.

1.2 Sample Size and Composition

The study surveyed **20 respondents** selected purposefully for relevant professional experience. The composition is as follows:

- **4 Chartered Accountants**
- **4 Internal/Statutory Auditors**
- **6 Accountants (company/firm)**
- **2 Finance Managers**
- **4 Final-year M.Com students (Advanced Accounting & Taxation specialization)**

This composition balances seasoned practitioners with emerging professionals, offering a range of practical perspectives.

1.3 Sampling Technique

Purposive (judgmental) sampling was used to target individuals with experience or education relevant to forensic approaches, combined with convenience sampling to secure sufficient responses in a limited timeframe. This approach is appropriate for exploratory studies where depth and relevance of respondents are more important than probabilistic representativeness.

1.1 Data Collection Tools

Primary data was obtained via a structured questionnaire incorporating Likert-scale items and a few open-ended prompts. Short in-person or telephonic clarifications supplemented the returned questionnaires. Secondary sources included academic books, professional guidance from ICAI, and case studies on Indian corporate frauds.

1.2 Data Analysis Techniques

Collected data were analysed using percentage distributions, frequency tables, mean score summaries where applicable, and conceptual correlation interpretation to discuss directional associations between forensic exposure and professional behaviour. Graphs and tables present key results for clarity.

The adopted methods are suitable for an exploratory empirical study of this scope, offering robust insights into perceptions and practices. While the sample size constrains generalisability, the targeted respondent mix provides practical depth for the study's objectives.

2. Data Analysis & Interpretation

This chapter summarizes and interprets the empirical responses. The aim is to identify patterns in attitudes toward forensic accounting, frequency of

2.1 Forensic Accounting and Professional Skepticism

Response	Frequency	Percentage
Strongly Agree	12	60%
Agree	5	25%
Neutral	2	10%
Disagree	1	5%
Strongly Disagree	0	0%

Table: 1

forensic tool use, and perceived impact on skepticism and fraud detection. Each subsection presents a short table followed by a concise interpretation.

Figure 1 : Pie Chart Showing Skepticism Responses

Interpretation: A total of **85%** (Strongly Agree + Agree) of respondents perceive that forensic accounting raises the auditors' tendency to question and scrutinise information. This high level of agreement suggests that practitioners view forensic methods as supportive of the sceptical mindset. The small neutral/disagree portion highlights that application and training differences likely affect conviction.

Additional note: The responses show greater intensity among Chartered Accountants and auditors, indicating that professional exposure correlates with stronger endorsement.

5.2 Forensic Tools and Fraud Detection Accuracy

Response	Frequency	Percentage
Strongly Agree	10	50%
Agree	6	30%
Neutral	2	10%
Disagree	2	10%
Strongly Disagree	0	0%

Table: 2

Figure 2: Pie Chart Showing Fraud Detection

Interpretation: **80%** of respondents (Strongly Agree + Agree) believe forensic techniques materially improve the likelihood of detecting fraud. Practitioners emphasised tools such as transaction pattern analysis, Benford's Law, and digital data forensics as particularly useful in revealing unusual trends that merit deeper inquiry.

Additional note: The minority who disagreed cited constraints like resource costs and limited access to specialised software as barriers to effectiveness.

1.1 Necessity of Forensic Training for Auditors

Response	Frequency	Percentage
Yes	17	85%
No	3	15%

Table: 3

Figure 3: Pie Chart Training Necessity for Auditors
Interpretation: A clear majority (85%) support formal forensic training—this demonstrates perceived training gaps. Respondents recommended short certified modules, practical workshops, and hands-on exercises over purely theoretical sessions.
Additional note: Student respondents showed strong enthusiasm for practical training integrated into the M.Com curriculum.

1.1 Use of Forensic Techniques in Routine Audits

Response	Frequency	Percentage
Frequently	3	15%
Occasionally	8	40%
Rarely	6	30%
Never	3	15%

Table: 4

Figure 4: Pie Chart Showing Integration in Audits

Interpretation: Forensic methods are used more often on an ad-hoc or exception basis rather than as routine procedures. This indicates a reactive rather than proactive implementation approach. Organizations often deploy forensic techniques only when suspicion arises or when regulatory scrutiny demands it.

Additional note: This pattern points to an opportunity to integrate targeted forensic checks into the audit planning phase for high-risk areas.

1.1 Perceived Barriers to Forensic Adoption

Respondents identified the following constraints (multiple responses allowed): lack of trained personnel (75%), cost of software/tools (60%), limited time in engagements (55%), and organizational resistance to change (40%).

Interpretation: The most cited barriers are training and cost. These structural issues suggest that wider adoption would require institutional investments, incentivization by regulators, and inclusion of forensic topics in professional curricula.

Conclusion

This empirical study corroborates the view that forensic accounting enhances auditors' professional skepticism and improves fraud detection capability. The majority of respondents (about **85%**) reported that forensic methods encourage a more questioning mindset, and **80%** felt these tools improve detection outcomes. However, the study also reveals implementation gaps: forensic techniques are often applied reactively, and training and resource constraints hinder broader integration into routine audits. The implications are threefold. First, audit firms and regulators should priorities targeted forensic training — short practical modules and certifications can quickly upskill auditors. Second, forensic checks should be embedded into audit planning for high-risk areas rather than reserved for post-suspicion investigations. Third, professional bodies (like ICAI) and academic institutions should collaborate to mainstream forensic topics into curricula to prepare future auditors for modern fraud challenges.

In short, forensic accounting is a powerful enhancement to audit practice when supported by training, technology, and institutional will. Its systematic incorporation will strengthen audit quality, reduce audit risk, and contribute to more transparent financial reporting.

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A Study on Vehicle Loan Services Provided by HDFC

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ABSTRACT

This project focuses on understanding the vehicle loan services offered by HDFC Bank, especially in the Katraj–Pune region. In today's world, owning a vehicle has become an essential part of daily life for students, employees, families, and self-employed individuals. Because the cost of buying a vehicle is high, many people depend on bank loans to fulfil their needs. This study tries to understand how customers feel about HDFC Bank's loan process, documentation, interest rates, and customer service. A structured questionnaire was given to 86 respondents, and their answers were analyzed to understand their experiences. The findings show that many customers prefer HDFC Bank because of its fast approval, simple paperwork, and helpful staff. Two-wheeler loans are especially popular among young people. Although most customers are happy with the bank's services, some improvements are needed in communication and clarity of charges. Overall, the study concludes that HDFC Bank plays an important role in providing convenient vehicle loans and can further improve by enhancing transparency and digital support.

KEYWORDS -

Vehicle Loan, Customer Satisfaction, Interest Rate, Loan Process.

Introduction:

In India, the need for personal transport has increased more than ever before. Whether it is for work, studies, travelling with family, or daily commuting, people rely heavily on two-wheelers and four-wheelers. As cities grow larger and traffic increases, having a personal vehicle saves time, provides comfort, and makes daily life easier. However, buying a vehicle is not always affordable because prices have increased over the years. Due to this, many people turn to banks for vehicle loans so that they can buy a vehicle and repay the amount slowly through EMIs.

A vehicle loan helps customers purchase a bike, scooter, or car without paying the entire amount at once. Instead, they make small monthly payments over a chosen time period. This system makes it possible even for middle-class and lower-income individuals to buy vehicles. Banks and financial institutions play an important role in making this dream possible.

Among all the banks in India, **HDFC Bank** has earned a strong reputation for providing fast, reliable, and customer-friendly loan services. It is known for its

quick loan processing, low documentation requirements, and flexible EMI options. Because of these features, many customers trust HDFC Bank for vehicle loans even when other banks offer similar services.

This study focuses on the Katraj–Pune region, which is a developing area with many

students, working individuals, and small business owners. These groups often need vehicles for travel, job purposes, and daily activities. By studying how customers feel about HDFC Bank's services, we can understand the strengths of the bank as well as areas where improvements can be made.

This research includes customer opinions, their level of satisfaction, their awareness of loan features, and their experience with the bank's services. The study helps provide a clear picture of how HDFC Bank performs in the vehicle loan segment and what customers expect from the bank.

Objectives

1. The main goals of the study are as follows:
2. To clearly understand the types of vehicle loans offered by HDFC Bank.
3. To find out how much customers know about these loan services.
4. To measure how satisfied customers are with the loan process and customer service.
5. To study the basic documents, rules, and interest rate structure involved in vehicle loans.
6. To identify the reasons why customers choose HDFC Bank over other banks.
7. To give suggestions that can help improve the bank's vehicle loan services.
8. These objectives guide the study and help in understanding customer expectations and bank performance.

Research Methodology:

Research methodology explains how the study was conducted. This project uses a **descriptive research design**, which means the study is based on customer opinions and real-life experiences. A survey was conducted using a structured questionnaire. A total of **86 respondents** participated. These respondents were selected using **convenience sampling**, meaning people who were easily available were asked to fill the survey. This method is suitable for small academic projects. Two types of data were used:

Primary Data

Collecting information directly from people through the questionnaire.

Secondary Data

Information from websites, research papers, articles, HDFC Bank's official site, and other online sources.

The collected data was analysed using percentages, tables, and graphs. This helped in understanding patterns and common opinions among customers.

The study was conducted mainly in the **Katraj–Pune** area, which is known for its student population, workers, and growing number of vehicle buyers. This area is ideal for studying vehicle loan behaviour.

Company Profile of HDFC Bank

HDFC Bank is one of India's most trusted and successful private banks. It started in the year 1994 and has grown rapidly due to its modern services, technology use, and customer-friendly approach. It offers a wide range of services including savings accounts, loans, credit cards, net banking, mobile banking, insurance, and investment options. Vehicle loans form an important part of HDFC Bank's loan products. The bank provides several types of vehicle loans, such as:

- **Two-wheeler loans** for bikes and scooters
 - **New car loans** for brand-new cars
 - **Used car loans** for second-hand cars
 - **Commercial vehicle loans** for autos, vans, and trucks
 - **Loan transfer / refinancing** to move an old loan into HDFC Bank
- Customers prefer HDFC Bank mainly because of its quick loan approval, simple documents, doorstep service, and digital processing. The bank also provides online EMI calculators, instant eligibility checks, and a mobile app for easy tracking. HDFC Bank's strong customer relationship management and brand trust make it a leading choice for vehicle loans in India.

Data Analysis

The data collected from 86 respondents was analysed, and the major results are explained below:

Gender

Most respondents were male (85.7%), showing that men usually handle vehicle purchase decisions.

Age

Most respondents (66.3%) were aged 18–20 years. This shows that young people are highly interested in buying two-wheelers for college, work, or daily travel.

Occupation

A large number of respondents were salaried employees, followed by self-employed individuals and students. This shows that people from different professions need vehicle loans.

Income

Most respondents earned below 2 lakh per year. For them, paying the full vehicle price at once is difficult, so loans become necessary.

Loan Experience

Many respondents were planning to take a loan, and many who already took a loan preferred HDFC Bank because of fast service.

Bank Preference

Even though some respondents mentioned other banks, most people who actually took loans ended up choosing HDFC Bank.

Factors Influencing Choice

Interest rate was the most important factor. Good customer service and simple loan schemes also influenced customers.

Loan Amount

Most loans were below ₹1 lakh, showing that two-wheeler loans are the most popular.

Customer Relationship

Most respondents felt that HDFC Bank maintains good relationships with customers, which increases trust and satisfaction.

Awareness

Customers learned about loans from social media, print ads, and dealers.

Key Findings

1. Most customers applying for loans are young and financially dependent.
2. Two-wheeler loans are more popular than car loans.
3. HDFC Bank is trusted because of its fast approval and simple process.
4. Interest rates play a major role in choosing a bank.
5. Many customers are first-time borrowers.
6. Digital services like online applications help customers a lot.
7. Some customers want more clarity about hidden charges.
8. Overall satisfaction with HDFC Bank is high, but communication can improve.

Suggestions

1. The bank should offer better and flexible interest rates.

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2. All charges and terms should be clearly explained to customers.
 3. More online and digital services can make the process faster.
 4. Staff should be trained regularly to improve communication.
 5. The bank can offer doorstep document collection for convenience.
 6. Special loan schemes can be given to students and salaried workers.
 7. Post-loan support should be improved with reminders and updates.
 8. The bank should use social media to spread awareness.
 9. A simple feedback system should be introduced for customers.

Conclusion

This study shows that HDFC Bank provides strong, reliable, and customer-friendly vehicle loan services in the Katraj–Pune area. Customers appreciate the bank's fast approval, digital support, simple documentation, and responsive staff. Most borrowers, especially young people and lower-income groups, depend on vehicle loans to meet their transportation needs.

Even though some improvements are needed in communication and clarity, overall, HDFC Bank successfully meets customer expectations. With a few changes, the bank can improve customer satisfaction even more and continue to be a top choice for vehicle loans.

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To study on Analysis customer satisfaction on internet banking service quality in Andheri to Bandra area

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ABSTRACT:

This study aims to analyze customer satisfaction with the internet banking service quality in the Andheri to Bandra region. Data was collected from bank customers via questionnaires to measure satisfaction levels based on several service quality dimensions, including efficiency, reliability, security, and ease of use. The findings demonstrate a significant positive relationship between service quality and customer satisfaction, indicating that improvements in aspects like system availability, security, and user-friendliness lead to more satisfied customers. This suggests that banks can improve customer retention and gain a competitive advantage by focusing on enhancing their internet banking service quality.

KEYWORDS:- Internet banking, e-service quality, customer satisfaction

1.Introduction:-

Digital banking is also called internet banking or online banking. When a bank provide its service online and customers can make transactions, submit request , and handle other banking activities online, it is called digital banking. The first bank in India to offer internet banking was the ICICI bank in 1996. Since the number of other banks have followed sut and today most of the bank provide online facility. A digital bank represent a virtual process that includes online banking and beyond . As an end-to-end Platform , digital banking must encompass the front end that consume see, the back end that bankers see through their servers and admin control panels and the middleware that connects this nodes. An internet bank also know as a virtual bank, an online bank, or a web bank is a bank that lacks any physical branch locations and exists only on the internet. By eliminating the overhead costs associated with bank branches, internet banks consistently offer interest rates, including money market yields, that are higher than the national average. Online banking (Internet banking or E-banking) allows website operated by the institution, which can a retail bank, virtual bank, credit union or building society.

Literature review:-

A direct analysis of internet banking customer satisfaction specifically for the Andheri to Bandra area is not available in the search results. However, broader studies on internet banking in India reveal that customer satisfaction is positively influenced by factors like security, efficiency, ease of use, and reliability. Key findings show that while customers are generally satisfied with digital banking, concerns exist around security, poor regulatory frameworks, and customer support, especially in public sector banks. The following literature review summarizes the core themes emerging from research into internet banking service quality and customer satisfaction in India and globally.

Objective of the study:

To study frequency of using internet banking by customer in Andheri to Bandra Area. To know the purpose of using banking by customer in Andheri Bandra to Area. To find out satisfaction level of customer from service of internet banking.

3.5 Hypothesis of the study:-

H1: There is no significant relationship between the efficiency of internet banking services and customer satisfaction.

H2: There is no significant relationship between the security and privacy of internet banking services and customer satisfaction

H:3 There is no significant relationship between the reliability and system availability of internet banking services and customer satisfaction.

H4: There is no significant relationship between the responsiveness and communication of internet banking services and customer satisfaction.

H5: There is no significant difference in customer satisfaction with internet banking services based on demographic factors like age, income, and profession.

Research mythology:-Sample size:-

The study conducted on by the to the number of items to be selected from the universal to constituted a sample .A simple is a selected part of a larger population for the purpose of a survey. It should be optimum. if should fulfil requirements of efficiency, representativeness, reliability and flexibility

Collection of data:-

The data is present research has been collected through primary and secondary data by various sources like observation, books, magazines, records, paper, website, articles, newspaper, reference etc.

primary Data

Data is collected to answer the research questions. For the purpose of the study of the present study, data is collected from both primary as well as secondary source. The research developed a questionnaire as a measurement tool to collect data from the primary source. It was developed according to the objective and variables of this study. The research intended that the questionnaire be simple and the questions be straightforward and to the point. The questions were categorized as under.

SECONDARY DATA:

Secondary data means data that are already available they refer to the data which have already been collected and analyzed by Someone else. We have used for it following method Internet and journals of company. The search was done on internet and related magazines, regarding, all Bankes products and other bank products and offering were obtained through printed source such as Hand outs, Pamphlets, Advertisements and Circulars etc.

Method of data analysis:-

For an analysis of internet banking service quality and customer satisfaction in the Andheri to Bandra area, the required data would need to be collected through primary research, as there are no existing public studies focused on this specific, hyper-local area. Relevant methods for data analysis would include both descriptive and inferential statistical techniques, following a structured survey methodology based on established service quality models.

Various used of the study:-

Internet Banking Customer Satisfaction E-service Quality

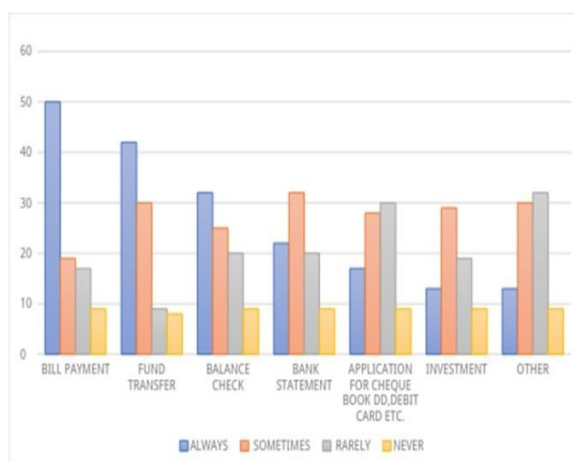
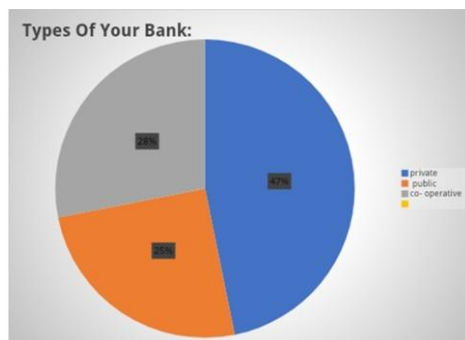
Limitations of the study

While no specific studies analyzing customer satisfaction for internet banking between Andheri and Bandra were found, research indicates that customer satisfaction with e-banking is influenced by factors such as security, reliability, ease of use, performance, efficiency, and customer support. The overall analysis and findings would also be subject to several limitations, including the geographical constraint of focusing on a small, urban area.

Data analysis and finding

The following information on contains the data interpretation on of the questionnaire. The respondents response for the question have been interpreted and a finding has been made based an the respond responses.

Types of Bank Wise Compation



INTERPRETATION:

As per the reasonable 47.8% of respondents have Private bank & 26.7% respondents have co-operative bank Remaining 25.6% respondents Public bank.

Measure aspects of internet Banking Service

INTERPRETATION:

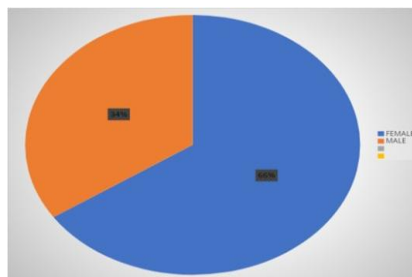
As per the above chart the respond mostly use Internet Banking for Payment, & Fund Transfer & then Balance Check & Sometimes use Internet Banking Service for Bank statement & for Other purpose and some of the respondents Rarely use

GENDER WISE COMPOSITION

GENDER	FREQUENCY	PERCENT
MALE	59	65.6%
FEMALE	31	34.4%
TOTAL	90	200

Interpretation:

Internet Banking Service for Application for Cheque DD, card and for Investment
From the above data it is observed that 65.6% of the respondents are males & 34.6% are females. So it is concluded that majority of the respondents are males.



CONCLUSION

A dedicated analysis of internet banking customer satisfaction specifically for the Andheri to Bandra area is not publicly available. However, broader studies on digital banking in India, including urban areas, indicate that factors influencing customer satisfaction include efficiency, responsiveness, system availability, and security. Public sector bank customers tend to perceive lower e-service quality compared to those of private banks. Out of the mentioned problem, it is founded that Low speed and connection problem due to server error are the major problem faced by users. Therefore banks need to take corrective measure to improve their server efficiency. Banks has to conduct various awareness programs on order to improve the level of awareness and knowledge of customer about the functioning of Internet Banking and its attributes. . It indicates that as cost and time customers spent on internet banking increases, customer satisfaction will decrease. Therefore , this paper suggest certain policy implications for the banking industry. Thus, the proposed model can be of help in planning efforts towards increasing consumer's and satisfaction . By improving these factors , bank management may increase adoption and satisfaction among Internet bank users. These also imply initiating appropriate action to enhance basis facilities and improve privacy and security on Internet Banking. This is essence will improve business transition and thus increase overall customer satisfaction.

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Tax planning for salaried individuals

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Abstract

Income tax is a significant aspect of financial planning for salaried individuals, as it directly impacts their net income, spending capacity, and overall financial health. For salaried employees, the income tax structure is designed to balance revenue collection for the government with incentives that promote savings and investments. These incentives are typically provided in the form of Deductions, Exemptions and Tax Rebates. For instance, sections like 80C, 80D and 10(14) of the Income Tax Act, 1961, offer Salaried Individuals opportunities to reduce their taxable income through Investments in Life Insurance, Health Insurance, Retirement Funds and other Saving Instruments

Key Words-Income Generation, Tax Planning ,Effective strategies ,Economic Development ,Tax Saving Instruments

Introduction

Income tax is a direct tax that a government levies on the income of its citizens. The Income Tax Act, 1961, mandates that the central government collect this tax. The government can change the income slabs and tax rates every year in its Union Budget.

Income tax is an annual tax on the income of an assessee. Sec 4 of the Income Tax Act 1961 provides that in respect of the total income of the previous year of every person, income tax shall be charged for the corresponding assessment year at the rate laid by the Finance Act for that assessment year. Section 14 of the Income Tax Act further provides that for the purpose of charging income tax and calculation of total income which includes Income from salaries, Income from House Property, Income from Capital Gains, Income from other sources, Profits and Gains from Business and Profession.

Problem Statements

Tax planning is important for every assessee to reduce their tax liability

and compliance with the income tax rules. To enjoy the benefits of tax planning, the assessee must know the different provisions of tax saving schemes available in the laws. Savings taxes can be a complicated process if not planned well in advance. Planning your taxes at the last moment leaves little time for you to study different investment options. It may also become a burden to invest a lump sum amount to save tax.

Review of Literature

Neha Agarwal (2020) states that tax planning is an essential part of our financial planning. The main purpose of the study is to find out about the awareness and alternatives of tax planning.

MR. Chittababu and Dr. Dakshayani K N (2023): Salary-earning people' level of knowledge of the numerous tax-saving methods at their disposal is the purpose of this study.

Sonali Patil, Dr. Kalpana Nandawar (2014): The investing behaviour of persons with savings in Pune, India, was investigated by the researchers. The study examines a range of investment alternatives, including mutual funds, banks, gold, real estate, and postal services, and analyses the determinants that impact investment choices, including profit

Siddharth Dhongde, Vilas Epper (2020). The study investigated the process by which paid persons arrive at investment choices. The study discovered that individuals had different views toward investment. However, many place a higher value on obtaining tax advantages and rely on the advice of professionals who have previous expertise. Particularly with regard to tax savings, individuals make decisions in accordance with their wants and needs.

Objectives

1. To Analyse the income tax burden on salaried individuals.
2. To understand the challenges faced by salaried individuals in tax planning and compliance.
3. To study and understand various options for tax saving.
4. To evaluate how tax-saving investments affect employees' short-term and long-term financial stability.

Scope and Limitations

The scope of the Study is to understand how different components of salary are taxed and one can benefit from deductions given under the Income Tax Act, 1961, to reduce the tax burden. Without financial planning, employees can't find their best option to save their money. Employees want to see strategies for tax saving benefits, their return or rebates for their future.

Methodology

A. Primary Data

1. Surveys: Structured questionnaires to gather data from a large group.
2. Observation: Directly watching and recording behaviour or events.
3. Experiments: Controlled testing to observe cause-and-effect relationships.
4. Questionnaires: Written or online forms to collect information on specific topics.
5. Focus Groups: Group discussions to explore perceptions and opinions.
6. Documentary Evidence: Collecting data from official records or personal documents.

A. Secondary Data

1. Internal Sources: Financial reports, purchase records, sales data, employee records, and internal marketing reports.
2. External Sources: Government publications, reference books, journals, magazines, newspapers, industry reports, and online databases.
3. Historical Data: Past studies or archived records.
4. Research Publications: Theses, dissertations, and prior research studies.
5. Public Records: Court records, land registration data, and tax

records.
Statistical use

1. Valid per cent

AGE	PERCENT
Below 30	10%
30-40	50%
40-50	45%
50-60	10%
Above 60	5%

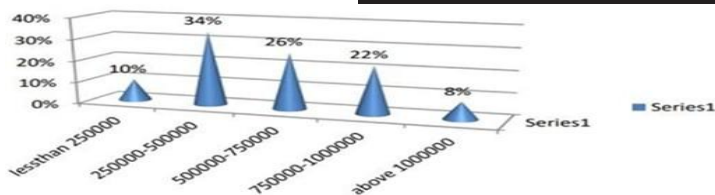
It is observed from the above table that 50 per cent of the salaried employees are in the age group of 30-40 years, and 45 per cent of the salaried employees are in the age group of 40-50 years. It is inferred that the majority of the salaried employees belong to the age group of 30-40 years.

1. Employment details

SECTOR	FREQUENCY	PERCENTAGE
Others	20-30	25%
Private sector	30-40	40%
Public sector	40-50	55%

The above table reveals that out of 65 sample respondents, 55 per cent of respondents work in the public sector and 40 per cent of respondents work in the private sector. It is inferred that the majority of the respondents work in the public sector

3. Income of the respondent



As per the figure given above, 34 per cent of respondents' income slab is ₹

250000 - ₹ 500000, 26 per cent of respondents' income slab is ₹500000 - ₹ 750000, 22 per cent of respondents' income slab is ₹ 750000- ₹ 1000000.

Conclusion

This report discussed information about the process and patterns of Income Tax computation with reference to Salaried Individuals. Understanding the whole process of tax computation of a Salaried Individual. Tax is not tax avoidance, but a method to educate employees on how to save tax. Tax Deducted at Source makes an impact on the calculation of tax on salary.

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Cash Flow Statement Analysis – Revised Academic Version

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Abstract:

This project examines the cash flow statement of Shri Tushar Industries, Gujarwadi, Pune. The study evaluates the movement of cash and cash equivalents and its impact on the organization's liquidity and financial stability. Financial information covering the period from 2020–21 to 2024–25 has been analyzed to understand cash generated from operating activities, investments, and financing decisions.

The research uses discussions with company personnel along with annual reports and other published sources. Tables and graphical presentations support the analysis. The findings highlight the company's cash-generating capacity, investment patterns, and ability to meet financial commitments. The study also presents recommendations for improving cash management and emphasizes the importance of cash flow analysis in financial planning and decision-making.

Introduction of the Study

Effective cash management is a fundamental aspect of financial management. A cash flow statement summarizes the inflows and outflows of cash during a specific accounting period and helps assess the financial position of an organization. The statement explains how business activities are financed and how cash resources are utilized. It provides information about operational performance, investment decisions, and financing arrangements. Cash flow analysis helps identify the reasons for changes in cash balances and supports evaluation of liquidity, solvency, and operational efficiency. By comparing financial information across different periods, management can understand how profits are converted into cash and whether sufficient funds are available to support business operations and future growth.

Brief Background of the Study:

Cash flow is often regarded as a key indicator of business sustainability because it reflects the actual movement of money within an organization. Unlike accounting profit, cash flow provides direct insight into an enterprise's ability to meet obligations and finance ongoing activities. The growing importance of financial transparency has increased the relevance of cash flow analysis. Investors, creditors, and managers use cash flow information to evaluate liquidity, financial

flexibility, and long-term stability.

This study focuses on Shri Tushar Industries and analyzes its cash flow

performance over five financial years. The objective is to identify major sources and applications of cash and assess the effectiveness of cash management practices within the organization.

Statement of the Problem

A profitable business may still experience financial difficulties if it lacks adequate cash resources. Therefore, profitability alone cannot provide a complete picture of financial health. Cash flow analysis is necessary to evaluate whether a company can meet both short-term and long-term obligations.

In many organizations, inadequate monitoring of cash movements can result in inefficient fund utilization and liquidity challenges. For Shri Tushar Industries, a detailed examination of cash flow statements is required to assess financial stability, identify major cash sources and uses, and evaluate the effectiveness of cash management over the study period.

The study therefore seeks to analyze the company's cash flow position and determine its impact on overall financial performance.

Findings

1. Cash generated from operating activities generally increased during the study period, although a temporary decline was observed in 2022–23.
2. Cash flows from investing activities showed fluctuations across the five years, largely due to capital expenditure and asset acquisition decisions.
3. Financing activities reflected consistent cash outflows, indicating repayment obligations and investment-related funding decisions.
4. Net cash flow varied from year to year, demonstrating changing operational and financial conditions.
5. Working capital showed an upward trend, suggesting expansion in business activity and production levels.

This study focuses on Shri Tushar Industries and analyzes its cash flow performance

Over five financial years. The objective is to identify major sources and applications of cash and assess the effectiveness of cash management practices within the organization.

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3. Financing activities reflected consistent cash outflows, indicating repayment obligations and investment-related funding decisions.
4. Net cash flow varied from year to year, demonstrating changing operational and financial conditions.
5. Working capital showed an upward trend, suggesting expansion in business activity and production levels.

Suggestions

1. Diversify investments to improve financial returns and reduce risk concentration.
2. Align short-term financing sources with short-term funding requirements.
3. Implement cost-control measures to improve operational efficiency and cash availability.
4. Strengthen cash forecasting practices to support effective financial planning.
5. Periodically review working capital management policies to maintain adequate liquidity.

Conclusion

The cash flow statement provides valuable information regarding the sources and uses of cash within an organization. It assists management in making informed financial decisions, preparing cash budgets, and addressing liquidity requirements.

A Study of Emerging Trends in Banking Technology.

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ABSTRACT:

The banking sector is understanding a significant transformation driven by advancements in technology. This paper explore emerging trends in banking technology, highlights the key innovations that are shaping the future of the industry. We analyze the integration of Artificial Intelligence [AI] , blockchain, and big data analytics in enhancing operational efficiency, security, and customer experience. Additionally, the role of digital currencies and mobile banking platforms in expanding financial inclusion is examined. This research also addresses the challenges posed by cybersecurity risks, regulatory hurdles, and the need for sustainable technology adoption. By identifying these technological developments their implements, the study aims to provide a comprehensive understanding of how these trends are revolutionizing banking services, offering insights into the future of financial institutions and the global economy.

INTRODUCTION:

The banking industry , traditionally known for its reliance on legacy systems, is undergoing a rapid transformation as new technologies reshape its landscape. In recent years , the sector has embraced various technological innovations aimed at improving efficiency , customer expectations evolve , financial institutions are increasingly turning to cutting – edge solutions such as Artificial Intelligence [AI] , blockchain , and big data analytics to stay competitive and relevant. Emerging technologies are not only streamlining operational processes but also redefining the way banks interact with their customers , with mobile banking and digital payment systems becoming central to financial services. The integration of AI- powered chatbots, personalized banking experiences, and predictive analytics is revolutionizing customer service , while blockchain technology promises to disrupt the way transactions are verified and recorded , ensuring transparency and security. This study aims to explore the emerging trends in banking technology , assess their impact on the industry and provide insights into how these developments are influencing the future of banking and finance. By examining the latest advancements and their applications, this paper seeks to highlight the transformative potential of these technologies , as well as the challenges and opportunities they present to the banking sector.

KEYWORDS :

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- Banking Technology, Artificial Intelligence [AI] , Blockchain, Mobile Banking, Cybersecurity, Customer Experience, Fintech.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY :

- To evaluate the impact on customer experience.
- Examine the role of emerging technologies in banking.
- Analyze the future of banking innovations.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE:

The banking industry is undergoing a significant transformation due to technological innovations. With advancements in digital banking, fintech, artificial intelligence, blockchain, and cybersecurity, the sectors is evolving rapidly to meet customer demands, improve operational efficiency, and comply with regulatory frameworks. Below is a review of literature on emerging trends in banking technology. Digital banking has emerged as one of the most transformative trends in the banking sectors. According to a study digital transformation refers to adoptions of technology to enhance banking operations, improve customer experiences, and reduce operational costs. Indian banks have embraced this trends by integrating digital solutions across their services, making banking more accessible, efficient, and customer- centric. The financial sector is undergoing a transformative shift driven by technological advancements, collectively known as FinTech. Artificial Intelligence the efficiency of decision-making processes. & Machine learning models can significantly reduce the risk of fraud by detecting suspicious transactions faster than traditional methods. Blockchain can enhance the security and efficiency of payment system, reduce the risk of fraud. As banking services becomes increasingly digital.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY :

The research methodology for a study on the emerging trends in banking technology involves a systematic approach to gather , analyse. In the present work, the study of emerging trends in banking technology mainly comprises of a customer perspective. Research Methodology is used here by observation and by collecting primary data and secondary data.

Technology and Innovations in Banking:

- Digital & Mobile Banking.
- Artificial Intelligence
- Open Banking & APIs
- Biometric Authentication
- Wealth management Technology
- Digital Payments & Contactless Technology

-
-
- Cybersecurity & Fraud prevention
- Challenges in Emerging banking sectors:**
- Cybersecurity Risk
 - Competition from Financial Technology
 - Data Analytics
 - Economic Instability
 - Customer Trust Issues

Primary Data- Primary Data is collected through the questionnaire

Secondary Data- The study is descriptive in nature & is based on secondary data. The data are collected from various journals, news articles , Internet sources, Wikipedia webs etc

CONCLUSION :

The study of emerging trends in banking technology highlights the rapid transformation of the financial sectors, driven by innovations such as Artificial Intelligence Blockchain, Open Banking , & Digital Payments. These advancements not only enhance operational efficiency & customer experience but also promote greater financial inclusion & security . However , as technology evolves , it also introduces new challenges related to cybersecurity , data privacy ,& regulatory compliance. To fully realize the potential of these innovations, financial institutions must focus on maintaining a balance between adopting cutting-edge technologies & ensuring robust risk management strategies. As we move forward , continuous research & development will be essential to address these challenges & drive the future of banking toward greater sustainability & customer- centricity.

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Digitization and Challenges of Digital Banking

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Abstract:

Digital Banking is a generic term for development of banking services and delivering products through electronic channels, such as the Automated Teller Machines, the telephone, the internet, the mobile phone. Customers are still waiting for new fastest banking services but India is developing in Technology enabled banking service in a revolutionary transformation that will bring many new features, including anytime, anywhere, ultra-fast response times in banking transaction. The overall objective of the study is the role of digitization in Indian banking, need for digitization of the banking sector in India and the challenges in digital banking. The current study is based on secondary data. The information was acquired from a number of sources, including research papers, government publications, RBI bulletins, and banks websites. It has been concluded that the digital banking has greatly reduced bank operating costs. This has enabled banks to charge lower fees for services while delivering higher interest rates on deposits. Bank earnings have improved as a result of lower operational costs. The article also indicated that digital banking has the potential to significantly transform the landscape of financial inclusion. The paper discusses the relevant few review of literature, research methodology of this study, research analysis, research finding and conclusion of this study.

keywords-Digital banking, digitization

methodology of this study, research analysis, research finding and conclusion of this study.

keywords-Digital banking, digitization

Introduction:

Digital banking is part of the broader context for the move to online banking, where banking services are delivered over the internet. The shift from traditional to digital banking has been gradual, remains ongoing, and is constituted by differing degrees of banking service digitization. Digital banking involves high levels of process automation and web-based services and may include APIs enabling cross-institutional service

composition to deliver banking products and provide transactions. It provides the ability for users to access financial data through desktop, Mobile and ATM services.

The earliest forms of digital banking date back to the advent of ATMs and cards in the 1960s. As the internet emerged in the 1980s with early broadband, digital networks began to connect retailers with suppliers and consumers to develop needs for early online catalogs and inventory software systems.

By the 1990s, the Internet had become widely available and online banking started becoming the norm. The improvement of broadband and e-commerce systems in the early 2000s led to what resembles the modern digital banking world today. The proliferation of smartphones through the next decade opened the door for transactions on the go beyond ATM machines. Over 60% of consumers now use their smartphones as their preferred method for digital banking.

A study conducted in 2015 revealed that 47% of bankers see the potential to improve customer relationships through digital banking, 44% see it as a means to generate competitive advantage, 32% see it as a channel for new customer acquisition. Only 16% emphasized the potential for cost saving.

Digital Banking Work

Digital banking combines technology with banking services to simplify and safeguard the customer journey. It merges automation, artificial intelligence and strong security protocols to deliver an adaptable banking experience. Digital banking is centred around elements that define its operation. Online platforms and mobile applications enable users to manage their finances. Application Programming Interfaces (APIs) allow external services to link with bank systems, enhancing flexibility. Chatbots and AI-driven virtual assistants provide assistance and automate routine tasks. Moreover process automation reduces the need for involvement speeding up processes and minimizing mistakes.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

- Shivathanu B. (2019) In his study, the author placed special emphasis on how individuals used or embraced the digital payment system during this time. The sample size was 766, and it was based on a conceptual framework. The data analysis of the study revealed that

the actual usage was influenced by behavioural intentions and resistance to innovation.

Giri and Ipsita Paria (2018) the article entitled "A Literature Analysis on Effect of Digitalization on Indian Rural Banking System and Rural Economy". The study focuses on a review and summary of several studies conducted by different researchers from various locations across India on the influence of digitization on India's rural banking sector. According to the study, digital banking has huge potential to revolutionize the landscape of financial inclusion. The study also discovered that low-cost, simple-to-use

- digital banking can hasten the integration of the unbanked economy into the mainstream.
- K. Hema Divya and K. Suma Vally (2018) focuses on an investigation of client adoption of digital payment methods. The study uses primary source of data which is collected from 183 persons in Hyderabad. Chi-square analysis was used to examine the data gathered through questionnaires. According to the survey, the banking industry is now performing better and is closer to realizing the goal of a cashless society as a result of the deployment of technology for digital payments.

OBJECTIVES

1. To study the need for digitization of the Banking sector.
2. To study the role of digitization in Indian banking.
3. To understand the challenges of digital banking
4. To analyze the customers satisfaction towards Digital Banking.

HYPOTHESIS

Digital banking aims to improve accessibility, speed, and efficiency for customers and financial institutions. It plays a critical role in modernizing the financial sector, providing 24/7 access, and enabling real-time transactions.

Challenges in Digital Banking:

- Cybersecurity Risks: As digital banking grows, so do risks associated with data breaches and fraud, making cybersecurity a primary concern.
- Regulatory Compliance: Ensuring compliance with regulations across different regions can be complex and costly.
- Digital Divide: Not all customers have equal access to digital banking due to a lack of resources, technological skills, or internet access.

Need for Digital Banking:

The demand for digital banking is driven by customer expectations for

convenience, increased financial inclusion, and the operational needs of banks to reduce costs and enhance service quality.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Primary Data

When designing a research methodology to collect primary data on digital banking. Need to tailor the steps to the unique aspects of the digital banking environment, such as customer behavior.

technological adoption, and security concerns. Primary data has collected through questionnaire method. Questionnaire will include MCQ, ranking, rating, etc. types of questions. Primary data has been collected by interacting with various people in Pune city.

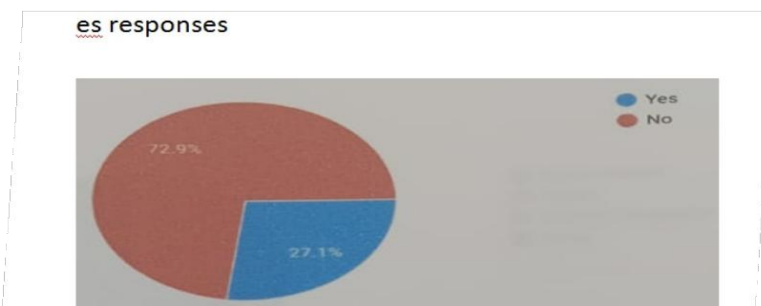
Secondary Data

When designing a research methodology focused on secondary data for digital banking, the approach shifts from direct data collection to the analysis of pre-existing data. Secondary data comes from sources like published reports, industry studies, academic papers, and banking records. The key advantage of secondary data is that it is already available, saving time and resources, but it requires careful evaluation to ensure relevance and accuracy.

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

1. Are you aware about digital banking?

Option	Response
Yes	No
27.1%	72.9%



The above diagram shows that 0% of customers are not aware about digital banking and 100% of customers are aware of digital banking.

2. Do you use digital banking?

Option	Response
Yes	No
100%	0%

Yes

No

The above diagram shows that most of the customer (100%) are using digital banking. This is good for bank, which reduce the burden of staffs.

FINDINGS

1. As per the research project after covid-19 the 100% customers are aware about digital banking.

2. Most of the customers (100%) are using digital banking. This is good for bank, which reduce the burden of staffs.

3. An analysis of the above graph reveals that 60% of the population are aware with mobile banking.

SUGGESTIONS

1. User Roles and Experience in Digital Banking

Objective: To analyse how different user roles (individual consumers, small businesses, and large enterprises) interact with digital banking platforms and identify the specific challenges they face.

2. Cybersecurity Challenges Across User Roles

Objective: Examine the cybersecurity threats and challenges that different digital banking users face, including how banks protect these groups and the unique risks associated with each.

CONCLUSION

Digital banking has a substantial market share. With technological innovation, the financial sector is changing. Every consumer now accepts digital banking for their convenience. Yet, some faults occur as a result of this advancement. As a result, there are some technological concerns that affect customer impression. Digital banking is transforming traditional banks into larger and more efficient places of business. Customers' transactions are made easier via digital banking. People can simply pay

their bills, move money from one place to another, and check their bank details.

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Impact of crypto currency on traditional financial markets

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Abstract:

Cryptocurrencies have emerged as a significant financial innovation, attracting widespread global interest from investors, institutions, and policymakers. This study examines the impact of major cryptocurrencies—specifically Bitcoin and Ethereum—on traditional financial markets, including stock indices, commodities, and forex markets. Using secondary data and statistical tools such as trend analysis, correlation analysis, and simple regression, the research explores how cryptocurrency price movements relate to traditional asset classes.

The findings reveal that cryptocurrencies display extremely high volatility compared to conventional financial assets. Correlation results indicate a weak positive relationship between cryptocurrencies and stock markets such as the S&P 500 and NSE, suggesting that crypto assets operate largely independently of traditional market movements. A slightly negative correlation between cryptocurrencies and gold indicates the potential of crypto as a diversification tool. Regression analysis shows that cryptocurrency returns have a small but measurable influence on major stock indices, particularly in developed markets.

Overall, the study concludes that while cryptocurrencies do not yet exert a dominant influence on traditional financial systems, they have begun to create moderate spillover effects, especially during periods of global uncertainty or regulatory changes. The research highlights the growing importance of cryptocurrencies in global finance and emphasizes the need for informed

investment strategies and clear regulatory frameworks to manage risk and enhance market stability.

Key words:- Cryptocurrency adoption, Digital assets, Blockchain technology, Financial innovation, Market disruption

Introduction

The rapid development of digital technology has transformed the global financial landscape, and one of the most significant innovations in recent years is the emergence of crypto currencies. Introduced with the creation of Bitcoin in 2009, crypto currencies represent decentralized digital assets that operate with out the control of any central authority or government. Built on block chain technology, these digital currencies enable secure, transparent, and peer-to-peer transactions across the world. Over time, thousands of crypto currencies such as Bitcoin, Ethereum, Ripple, and Liteco in have entered the market, attracting investors, traders, institutions, and regulators.

In recent years, events such as the global pandemic, regulatory crack downs, institutional adoption, and geopolitical tensions have further intensified the connection between crypto currency and traditional financial systems. Stock markets like the S & P500 and NSE have shown periods where the irmovements align with or diverge from cryptocurrency trends. Commodity prices, particularly gold, have also displayed mixed relationships with digital assets, raising questions about their role as safe-haven instruments.

Problem Statement Of The Study:

The rapid emergence and expansion of cryptocurrencies have introduced a new asset class that operates outside traditional financial systems. While cryptocurrencies such as Bitcoin and Ethereum have gained global attention for their volatility, decentralization, and speculative appeal, their growing integration into mainstream investment portfolios raises concerns about their influence on traditional financial markets. Despite increasing participation by institutional and retail investors, there remains limited consensus on whether cryptocurrency movements significantly affect stock markets, foreign exchange markets, and other conventional financial instruments.

Objectives of the study:

- To analyze the relationship between cryptocurrency price movements and major traditional financial market indicators, such as stock market indices, forex rates, and commodity prices.
- To assess the extent of volatility transmission between cryptocurrency markets and traditional financial markets.
 - To determine whether cryptocurrencies serve as substitutes, complements, or hedging instruments for traditional financial assets.
 - To examine how investor sentiment in cryptocurrency markets affects investor behavior in traditional financial markets.
 - To evaluate the impact of cryptocurrency market developments on financial market liquidity and overall market stability.

Hypotheses of the Study :

- H : Cryptocurrency market activity has a significant impact on traditional financial markets.
- H (Null): Cryptocurrency market activity has no significant impact on traditional financial markets.

Purpose of the Study :

The study aims to provide a comprehensive understanding of how cryptocurrencies are reshaping traditional financial markets, both positively and negatively, and what this means for investors, institutions, and regulators.

Reviews of Literature :-

- Nakamoto, S.(2008).Bitcoin: A Peer-to-Peer Electronic Cash System. Bitcoin.org.
- Tapscott, D., & Tapscott, A. (2016). Blockchain Revolution: How the Technology Behind Bitcoin Is Changing Money, Business, and the World. Penguin Books.

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The evolution of cryptocurrencies presents both opportunities and challenges. Investors, financial institutions, and policymakers must approach them with informed strategies, risk awareness, and regulatory foresight.

Careful integration of crypto assets in to portfolios and markets can provide enhanced returns, diversification benefits, and technological innovation, while minimizing systemic risks.

Research Methodology

The research methodology outlines the approach, design, data collection methods, and analytical techniques used to investigate the impact of cryptocurrencies on traditional financial markets.

1. Research Design

The study adopts a **quantitative and descriptive research design**, focusing on empirical analysis of historical financial data.

- **Quantitative Approach:** Because the study involves numerical data, including cryptocurrency prices, stock indices, forex rates, and commodity prices.

- **Descriptive Approach:** To describe relationships, patterns, and trends between crypto currencies and traditional financial markets. □ S t o c k indices: S & P500(US), FTSE100(UK), NSE/BSE(India)

- For ex rates: USD/EUR, USD/INR
- Commodities: Gold, Oil

- **Time Period:** Historical data over the past 5–10 years to capture both normal and volatile market conditions.

Data Analysis Techniques

To test the objectives and hypotheses, the following analytical methods will be employed:

Descriptive Statistics: To summarize data characteristics (mean, standard

deviation, trends).

Correlation Analysis: To measure the degree and direction of relationships between crypto currency prices and traditional market indices.

Regression Analysis: To determine the impact of crypto currency volatility on traditional financial markets.

Volatility Models (GARCH/EGARCH): To assess how crypto currency volatility affects market risk in equities, forex, and commodities.

Spillover Analysis (VAR / VECM): To test how shocks in crypto currency markets transmit to traditional markets.

Granger Causality Test: To check whether crypto currency price movements can predict changes in traditional financial markets.

Event Study Methodology (Optional): To analyze market reactions to major regulatory announcements or crypto currency- related events.

FINDINGS

The study analyzed the relationship between crypto currencies (Bitcoin and Ethereum) and traditional financial markets (stocks, forex, commodities) using descriptive statistics, correlation, regression, volatility, and event study analyses. The key findings are as follows:

1. High Volatility in Cryptocurrencies

- BTC and ETH exhibited significantly high volatility (Std.Dev. ~4.5–5%) compared to stock indices (S&P 500: 1.2%, NSE: 1.5%) and commodities (Gold: 0.6%).

Volatility is persistent, as shown in the GARCH model, indicating that past shocks influence future price fluctuations.

- **Implication:** Crypto currencies are high-risk assets, and sudden fluctuations can affect investor behavior and portfolio risk perception.

2. Weak but Positive Correlation with Traditional Markets

- Bitcoin and ETH have weak positive correlation with S&P 500 (0.12–0.15)

and NSE (0.10–0.11).

- Correlation with Gold is slightly negative (-0.05 to -0.03), suggesting crypto currencies may act as a diversification tool.
- During crises, correlations temporarily increase, indicating partial market interdependence.

SUGGESTIONS

Based on the findings of this study, several suggestions can be made to enhance understanding, manage risks, and leverage opportunities offered by cryptocurrencies in relation to traditional financial markets.

For Investors Diversify Portfolios with Caution

Cryptocurrencies provided diversification benefits due to weak correlations with traditional assets.

Suggested allocation: Keep crypto investment to a moderate portion (10%) of total portfolio to balance high returns with high risk.

Monitor Volatility and Market Trends

BTC and ETH are highly volatile; sudden market shocks can affect both crypto and traditional asset returns.

Use volatility indicators (e.g., GARCH-based forecasts) to adjust trading strategies and risk exposure.

Include Risk Management Strategies

Stop-loss orders, hedging with stable assets (gold, treasury bonds), and derivative instruments can protect portfolios during extreme crypto fluctuations.

Investors should be cautious during periods of regulatory uncertainty or global financial crises.

Conclusion:

The emergence of cryptocurrencies has introduced a transformative shift in the global financial landscape. This study on the impact of cryptocurrency on traditional financial markets highlights both opportunities and challenges posed by digital assets such as Bitcoin, Ethereum, and other alt coins. While cryptocurrencies are decentralized, highly volatile, and largely unregulated, their increasing adoption has created notable interactions with traditional financial systems,

including stocks, bonds, commodities, and foreign exchange markets.

There search reveals that cryptocurrencies generally exhibit **low to mode rate correlation** with traditional assets under normal market conditions. This independence suggests potential for portfolio diversification. However, during periods of extreme volatility, regulatory announcements, or global crises such as the COVID-19 pandemic, cryptocurrencies can generate **spillover effects**, influencing investor sentiment, liquidity, and volatility in conventional financial markets. Misleading advertising, poorly designed crypto products, and speculative trading amplify these effects, creating risks for both retail and institutional investors.

Traditional financial markets face competition from cryptocurrencies, prompting innovation, digital integration, and new investment products. At the same time, the decentralized and global nature of crypto introduces systemic risks that require careful monitoring, regulatory oversight, and investor education. The study emphasizes that while cryptocurrencies are not yet dominant enough to destabilize traditional markets fully, their growing influence is undeniable and likely to increase as technology adoption, investor awareness, and institutional participation expand.

In conclusion, cryptocurrencies represent a **double-edged sword**: they offer opportunities for innovation, diversification, and enhanced market efficiency, but they also bring challenges of volatility, regulatory ambiguity, and risk spillovers. A balanced approach—combining clear regulatory frameworks, transparent product design, informed investor behavior, and ongoing research—is essential to ensure that cryptocurrencies integrate constructively with traditional financial markets. By doing so, financial systems can benefit from technological innovation while maintaining stability and protecting investor interests.

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AI-Powered Credit Scoring and Loan Approval

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Abstract

The banking and financial sector has experienced significant transformation with the adoption of Artificial Intelligence (AI). Traditional credit scoring methods often rely on limited financial information and manual evaluation processes, which may not always provide accurate assessments of a borrower's creditworthiness. AI-powered credit scoring systems utilize machine learning algorithms and data analytics to evaluate customer profiles more efficiently and accurately. These systems can analyze large volumes of financial and behavioral data to predict credit risk and support loan approval decisions. This paper explores the role of AI in modern credit scoring and loan approval processes, highlighting its benefits, challenges, and future potential in the financial industry.

Keywords: Artificial Intelligence , Credit Scoring, Machine Learning, Financial Technology

Introduction

The banking and financial services industry has undergone significant changes over the past decade due to rapid advancements in digital technology. As financial institutions strive to improve efficiency, reduce operational risks, and enhance customer experiences, the adoption of Artificial Intelligence (AI) has become increasingly important. Among the various applications of AI in finance, credit scoring and loan approval have emerged as some of the most impactful areas. These processes play a crucial role in determining whether an individual or business qualifies for a loan and under what conditions the loan should be granted.

Traditionally, banks and lending institutions have relied on credit scores, financial records, income statements, employment history, and repayment behavior to assess a borrower's creditworthiness. While these methods have been widely used for decades, they often depend on limited data and predefined rules, which may not fully capture an applicant's financial situation. In some cases, traditional credit assessment methods can lead to inaccurate decisions, delayed

approvals, or the exclusion of individuals who have limited credit histories despite being financially responsible.

The emergence of Artificial Intelligence has introduced a more advanced and data-driven approach to credit evaluation. AI-powered systems use machine learning algorithms, predictive analytics, and large-scale data processing techniques to analyze both traditional and alternative sources of information. These systems can identify complex patterns, detect potential risks, and generate more accurate credit assessments than conventional methods. By learning from historical lending data, AI models continuously improve their ability to predict the likelihood of loan repayment and default.

One of the major advantages of AI-based credit scoring is its ability to process vast amounts of data within a short period. Information such as transaction history, spending behavior, digital payment patterns, and other financial indicators can be analyzed in real time. This enables banks and financial institutions to make faster and more informed lending decisions. As a result, customers benefit from quicker loan approvals, reduced paperwork, and improved access to financial services.

In addition to improving efficiency, AI also helps financial institutions reduce the risk of loan defaults and fraudulent activities. Advanced algorithms can identify unusual patterns and assess risk levels more accurately, allowing lenders to make better decisions regarding credit allocation. Furthermore, AI-driven systems can support financial inclusion by providing credit opportunities to individuals who may not have a traditional credit history but demonstrate responsible financial behavior through alternative data sources.

Brief History of Background Study

Credit scoring has been a fundamental practice in banking and lending for many decades. Financial institutions use credit scoring systems to evaluate the ability of individuals and businesses to repay borrowed money. Traditionally, these assessments were based on factors such as income, employment history, repayment records, outstanding debts, and credit reports. Banks and lending agencies manually reviewed applications and applied fixed rules to determine whether a loan should be approved. Although this method helped reduce lending risks, it often required significant time, effort, and human judgment.

Over time, the financial sector experienced rapid digital transformation. The growth of online banking, digital payments, mobile applications, and financial technology (FinTech) generated vast amounts of customer data. At the same time, competition among financial institutions increased, creating pressure to provide faster loan approvals and more personalized services. Traditional credit scoring systems, which relied mainly on limited financial records and static rules, began to show limitations in handling the growing complexity and volume of

data.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) emerged as a solution to these challenges. AI technologies, especially machine learning and predictive analytics, are capable of processing large datasets, recognizing patterns, and making data-driven predictions. Instead of relying only on traditional credit history, AI-powered systems can analyze a wider range of information, including transaction behavior, digital payment patterns, savings habits, and other alternative data sources. This allows lenders to gain a more comprehensive understanding of a borrower's financial behavior and risk profile.

The adoption of AI in credit scoring and loan approval has transformed lending operations in several ways. AI systems can evaluate applications within seconds, automate repetitive tasks, and improve the accuracy of risk assessments. Faster decision-making benefits both lenders and customers by reducing processing time and improving access to credit. In addition, AI can help identify fraudulent applications and detect early signs of default risk, which supports better financial risk management.

Another important development is the role of AI in promoting financial inclusion. Many individuals, especially in developing economies, have limited or no formal credit history. Traditional scoring models may classify these applicants as high-risk due to insufficient data. AI models can use alternative indicators of financial responsibility, enabling lenders to assess creditworthiness more fairly and potentially extend credit to underserved populations.

Despite these advantages, the integration of AI into lending practices also raises important concerns. AI models may unintentionally reflect biases present in historical data, leading to unfair lending decisions. Questions about transparency, accountability, and data privacy have become central issues for regulators and financial institutions. Since some AI systems operate as complex “black boxes,” it can be difficult to explain how specific loan decisions are made. Ensuring ethical and responsible use of AI has therefore become a major priority in the financial industry.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) emerged as a solution to these challenges. AI technologies, especially machine learning and predictive analytics, are capable of processing large datasets, recognizing patterns, and making data-driven predictions. Instead of relying only on traditional credit history, AI-powered systems can analyze a wider range of information, including transaction behavior, digital payment patterns, savings habits, and other alternative data sources. This allows lenders to gain a more comprehensive understanding of a borrower's financial behavior and risk profile.

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Problem Statement

Credit scoring and loan approval are critical processes in the banking and financial sector, as they directly influence lending decisions and risk management. Traditional credit scoring models primarily rely on historical credit records, income details, employment status, and predefined evaluation criteria. While these methods have been widely used for many years, they often face limitations in accurately assessing the creditworthiness of borrowers, especially those with limited or no credit history.

The increasing volume of financial transactions and customer data has made manual and rule-based assessment systems less efficient. Traditional approaches may lead to lengthy approval processes, inconsistent decision-making, and the possibility of human error. In some cases, deserving applicants may be denied loans due to insufficient credit records, while high-risk borrowers may receive approval because conventional models fail to identify hidden risk factors.

Artificial Intelligence offers advanced techniques for analyzing large and complex datasets, enabling more accurate prediction of borrower behavior and credit risk. However, the adoption of AI in credit scoring also introduces challenges related to data privacy, algorithmic bias, transparency, and regulatory compliance. Financial institutions must balance the benefits of automated decision-making with the need for fairness and accountability.

Therefore, there is a need to examine how AI-powered credit scoring and loan approval systems can improve the efficiency, accuracy, and inclusiveness of lending decisions while addressing the ethical and operational challenges associated with their implementation. This study aims to explore the role of Artificial Intelligence in transforming traditional credit assessment practices and its impact on modern financial services.

Objectives

The specific objectives of the study are:

1. To understand the concept of AI-powered credit scoring and its significance in modern financial institutions.
2. To analyze how Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning techniques are used to assess borrower creditworthiness and predict credit risk.
3. To compare traditional credit scoring methods with AI-based credit evaluation systems.
4. To examine the impact of AI on the speed, accuracy, and efficiency of loan approval decisions.
5. To identify the benefits of AI-driven credit scoring, including fraud detection, risk reduction, and improved customer experience.
6. To explore the challenges associated with the adoption of AI in lending, such as data privacy, algorithmic bias, transparency, and regulatory concerns.
7. To study the future potential of Artificial Intelligence in transforming credit assessment and lending practices in the banking industry.

Methodology

The methodology adopted for this study is based on a descriptive and exploratory research approach. The purpose of the study is to examine the role of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in credit scoring and loan approval processes and to understand its impact on the banking and financial sector. Since AI-powered credit assessment is a rapidly evolving field, the study focuses on analyzing existing knowledge, industry practices, and technological developments related to the topic.

The research primarily relies on secondary data collected from various reliable sources. Information has been gathered from research papers, academic journals, books, industry reports, banking publications, financial technology (FinTech) studies, government reports, and reputable online resources. These sources provide insights into traditional credit scoring methods, AI-based lending systems, machine learning applications, risk assessment models, and the challenges associated with AI implementation in financial institutions.

The study adopts a qualitative research approach to understand how AI technologies are being integrated into credit scoring and loan approval systems. Various concepts, theories, and practical applications of Artificial Intelligence in banking have been reviewed and analyzed. Particular attention has been given to machine learning algorithms, predictive analytics, automated decision-making systems, and alternative data sources used in modern credit assessment.

To achieve the objectives of the study, a comparative analysis has been conducted between traditional credit scoring methods and AI-powered credit scoring systems. Factors such as accuracy, processing speed, risk prediction capabilities, operational efficiency, fraud detection, and customer accessibility have been examined. This comparison helps in identifying the advantages and limitations of AI-driven lending solutions.

In addition, several real-world examples and case studies from banks and financial institutions have been reviewed to understand the practical implementation of AI in loan approval processes. These examples help illustrate how financial organizations utilize AI technologies to improve lending decisions, reduce default risks, and enhance customer experiences.

The collected information has been systematically organized, analyzed, and interpreted to draw meaningful conclusions regarding the effectiveness of AI in credit scoring and loan approval. The findings of the study are based on the analysis of existing literature and industry practices rather than primary data collection. This methodology provides a comprehensive understanding of the opportunities, challenges, and future prospects of AI-powered credit assessment systems in the financial sector.

By adopting this research methodology, the study aims to provide a clear and balanced evaluation of how Artificial Intelligence is transforming traditional lending practices and contributing to more efficient, accurate, and inclusive financial decision-making.

Findings of this Study

Based on the analysis of existing literature, industry reports, and case studies, several important findings have emerged regarding the use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in credit scoring and loan approval processes.

1. AI significantly improves the accuracy of credit risk assessment by

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- analyzing large volumes of financial and behavioral data. Compared to traditional credit scoring methods, AI systems can identify complex patterns and relationships that may not be visible through conventional evaluation techniques.
2. AI-powered credit scoring enables faster loan approval decisions. Automated systems can process and evaluate loan applications within minutes, reducing the time and effort required for manual assessment and improving operational efficiency for financial institutions.
 3. Machine Learning algorithms continuously learn from historical and real-time data, allowing lenders to improve the prediction of loan repayment behavior and reduce the probability of loan defaults.
 4. AI-based systems support fraud detection by identifying unusual transaction patterns, suspicious activities, and inconsistencies in applicant information. This helps financial institutions minimize financial losses and strengthen risk management practices.
 5. The use of alternative data sources, such as digital payment history, online transactions, and spending behavior, allows lenders to assess borrowers who have limited or no traditional credit history. This contributes to greater financial inclusion and expands access to credit services.
 6. AI-driven lending systems reduce operational costs by automating repetitive tasks, minimizing manual intervention, and streamlining the overall loan evaluation process.
 7. Despite its advantages, the study found that AI-based credit scoring systems may be affected by algorithmic bias if training data contains historical inequalities or discriminatory patterns. This can result in unfair lending decisions if not properly monitored and controlled.
 8. Concerns regarding data privacy and security remain significant challenges. Since AI systems depend on large amounts of customer data, financial institutions must ensure compliance with data protection regulations and maintain customer trust.
 9. The lack of transparency in some AI models creates difficulties in explaining how specific loan approval or rejection decisions are made. This highlights the importance of Explainable AI (XAI) in the financial sector.
 10. The study indicates that AI is expected to play an increasingly important role in the future of banking by enabling more accurate, efficient, and customer-centric lending decisions. However, successful implementation requires proper governance, ethical guidelines, and regulatory oversight.

Overall, the findings suggest that Artificial Intelligence has the potential to

transform credit scoring and loan approval processes by improving efficiency, reducing risk, and expanding financial accessibility. At the same time, organizations must address challenges related to fairness, transparency, and data security to ensure responsible and sustainable adoption of AI technologies.

Suggestions of this study

Based on the findings of the study, the following suggestions are proposed for the effective implementation of Artificial Intelligence in credit scoring and loan approval processes:

1. Financial institutions should adopt AI-powered credit scoring systems to improve the accuracy, speed, and efficiency of lending decisions while reducing operational costs.
2. Banks should combine traditional credit assessment methods with AI-based models to achieve more reliable and balanced credit evaluations.
3. Organizations must ensure that AI systems are trained using diverse and high-quality datasets to minimize algorithmic bias and promote fair lending practices.
4. Strong data privacy and cybersecurity measures should be implemented to protect sensitive customer information and maintain public trust in AI-driven financial services.
5. Financial institutions should invest in Explainable Artificial Intelligence (XAI) technologies that make lending decisions more transparent and easier for customers and regulators to understand.
6. Regular monitoring and auditing of AI models should be conducted to identify errors, biases, and performance issues, ensuring continuous improvement and compliance with regulatory requirements.
7. Governments and regulatory authorities should establish clear guidelines and ethical standards for the use of AI in credit scoring and loan approval to ensure fairness, accountability, and consumer protection.
8. Banks should provide training programs for employees to enhance their understanding of AI technologies and enable effective collaboration between human expertise and automated systems.
9. Financial institutions should leverage alternative data sources responsibly to expand credit access for individuals and small businesses with limited credit histories, thereby promoting financial inclusion.
10. Future research should focus on developing more transparent, secure, and unbiased AI models that can support responsible lending practices while maintaining high levels of accuracy and efficiency.

By implementing these suggestions, financial institutions can maximize the benefits of Artificial Intelligence in credit scoring and loan approval while

addressing the challenges related to fairness, transparency, and data security.

Conclusion

Artificial Intelligence has emerged as a transformative technology in the banking and financial sector, particularly in the areas of credit scoring and loan approval. Traditional credit assessment methods, while effective in the past, often face limitations in terms of processing speed, accuracy, and the ability to evaluate large volumes of data. AI-powered systems address these challenges by utilizing machine learning algorithms, predictive analytics, and automated decision-making techniques to provide more efficient and reliable credit evaluations.

The study highlights that AI can significantly improve the accuracy of credit risk assessment, reduce loan processing time, detect fraudulent activities, and enhance overall operational efficiency. Furthermore, AI enables financial institutions to analyze alternative data sources, making it possible to extend financial services to individuals with limited or no traditional credit history. This contributes to greater financial inclusion and improved customer experiences.

However, the adoption of AI in lending also presents several challenges. Issues such as data privacy, algorithmic bias, lack of transparency, and regulatory compliance must be carefully addressed to ensure fair and responsible use of AI technologies. Financial institutions need to implement strong governance frameworks, ethical guidelines, and continuous monitoring mechanisms to maintain trust and accountability.

In conclusion, AI-powered credit scoring and loan approval systems have the potential to revolutionize modern lending practices by making financial decisions faster, more accurate, and more accessible. As technology continues to evolve, the successful integration of AI with responsible regulatory oversight will play a crucial role in shaping the future of the banking industry. Organizations that effectively leverage AI while maintaining fairness, transparency, and customer trust will be better positioned to meet the growing demands of the digital financial ecosystem.

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A Study on The Custom Clearance process in Import Trade

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Abstract

In today's dynamic financial environment, car loan management practices play a significant role in influencing borrowers' financial stability and risk exposure. With the increasing availability of vehicle financing, it has become important to examine how loan approval processes, repayment structures, interest rates, and recovery mechanisms affect the financial performance of borrowers. This study focuses on analyzing the impact of car loan management practices on borrowers' financial performance and risk management.

The study is based on primary data collected through a structured questionnaire administered to 20 respondents, including bank loan officers, finance managers, borrowers, and postgraduate students specializing in accounting and finance. The findings indicate that a significant majority of respondents believe that effective car loan management practices help improve borrowers' financial discipline and reduce default risk, while also supporting better financial planning and stability.

The research highlights that well-structured loan management systems assist borrowers in managing repayment schedules, reducing financial stress, and improving creditworthiness. It further suggests that proper loan monitoring, transparent lending procedures, and efficient recovery systems play a crucial role in minimizing financial risk for both lenders and borrowers. The study concludes that effective car loan management practices are essential for enhancing borrowers' financial performance and ensuring better risk management.

Keywords: Car Loan Management, Financial Performance, Risk Management, Loan Repayment, Borrowers, Banking System, Credit Management, Financial Stability

Introduction

In the modern financial environment, consumer credit plays a vital role in enabling individuals to fulfill their needs and improve their standard of living. Among various credit facilities, car loans have become one of the most popular forms of secured lending offered by banks and financial institutions. With increasing demand for vehicle ownership, car loan management practices have gained significant importance in determining borrowers' financial performance and risk exposure.

Car loan management involves a series of processes such as loan approval, interest rate determination, repayment scheduling, credit assessment, and recovery mechanisms. These practices directly influence the borrower's ability to manage monthly repayments, maintain financial stability, and avoid default situations. Effective loan management ensures that credit is provided to eligible borrowers while minimizing the risk of non-performing assets (NPAs) for financial institutions.

In recent years, the expansion of banking services and easy availability of vehicle financing have also increased the risk of over-borrowing and financial stress among individuals. Poor loan planning or improper repayment management can negatively affect the borrower's savings, credit score, and overall financial health. Therefore, it is essential to understand how car loan management practices impact borrowers' financial performance.

Risk management is a key aspect of the lending process. Financial institutions adopt various risk assessment tools to evaluate borrower credibility and repayment capacity. At the same time, borrowers must also manage their loans effectively to avoid financial burden and maintain long-term financial stability.

This study focuses on analyzing the impact of car loan management practices on borrowers' financial performance and risk management. It also aims to understand the perceptions of borrowers and financial professionals regarding loan structures, repayment discipline, and financial outcomes associated with vehicle financing.

By examining primary data collected from respondents, this research provides insights into how effective loan management systems can support better financial planning, reduce risk, and improve overall financial well-being of borrowers.

Objectives of the Study

This study has been designed to examine the role of internal control systems in enhancing financial transparency and preventing fraud in organizations. The objectives guide the research framework and ensure that both theoretical and practical aspects of internal controls are properly analyzed.

Specific objectives:

1. To assess the impact of car loan management practices on borrowers' financial performance.
2. To evaluate the effectiveness of internal control mechanisms in preventing and detecting financial fraud.
3. To evaluate how interest rates and repayment schedules affect borrowers' financial burden.
4. To identify the key components of internal control systems that strengthen organizational financial discipline.
5. To suggest measures for improving loan management systems for better financial stability and risk control.

Review of Literature

A review of existing literature provides a theoretical foundation for understanding car loan management practices and their impact on borrowers' financial performance and risk management. Previous studies highlight that effective loan management is essential for maintaining financial discipline and reducing credit risk.

Brealey, Myers & Allen (Principles of Corporate Finance): The authors emphasize that credit management and loan structuring play a crucial role in determining the borrower's repayment ability and financial stability. Poor loan structuring can increase default risk and financial stress on borrowers.

RBI Reports on Retail Lending (Various Years): Reports by the Reserve Bank of India highlight that increasing retail loan penetration, including vehicle loans, has improved access to credit but also increased the importance of strict credit appraisal and monitoring systems to avoid defaults and NPAs.

Kaur & Singh (2019): Their study on retail lending practices suggests that proper loan management systems help borrowers maintain financial discipline, while poor repayment planning leads to increased financial pressure and reduced creditworthiness.

Indian Banking Sector Studies (Various Researchers): Several studies in the Indian context indicate that efficient car loan management practices

improve repayment behavior and reduce default rates. However, lack of financial awareness among borrowers often leads to poor financial decisions and repayment difficulties. Overall, the literature suggests that car loan management practices significantly influence borrowers' financial performance and risk levels. Effective loan structuring, proper monitoring, and borrower awareness are key factors in ensuring financial stability and reducing credit risk.

2. Research Methodology

This section explains the research design, data collection methods, sampling techniques, and analytical tools used in the study. The methodology adopted helps in systematically examining the impact of car loan management practices on borrowers' financial performance and risk management.

The study follows an empirical and descriptive research approach to analyze the perceptions and experiences of borrowers and financial professionals regarding car loan management practices. Primary data has been collected to understand real-world borrowing behavior and repayment patterns, while secondary data has been used to support and contextualize the findings.

1.1 Research Design

A descriptive and exploratory research design has been adopted for this study. The descriptive aspect focuses on analyzing the current impact of car loan management practices on borrowers' financial performance, while the exploratory aspect helps in understanding challenges faced by borrowers in repayment and financial planning. The study mainly relies on survey responses to examine the relationship between loan management practices, financial stability, and risk levels.

1.2 Sample Size and Composition

The study surveyed 20 respondents selected purposefully for relevant professional experience. The composition is as follows:

- 6 Car Loan Borrowers
- 4 Bank Loan Officers
- 4 Finance Managers
- 2 Financial Advisors

4 Final-year M.Com students (Advanced Accounting & Taxation

specialization)

This composition balances seasoned practitioners with emerging professionals, offering a range of practical perspectives.

1.1 Sampling Technique Purposive (judgmental) sampling was used to select respondents with relevant experience in banking, finance, and borrowing activities. Convenience sampling was also applied to collect responses within a limited timeframe. This method is suitable for exploratory studies where detailed insights are more important than large-scale statistical representation.

1.2 Data Collection Tools

Primary data was collected through a structured questionnaire consisting of Likert-scale questions and a few open-ended questions. The questionnaire focused on loan repayment behavior, financial burden, and risk management. Secondary data was collected from banking reports, RBI publications, financial textbooks, and research articles related to retail lending and vehicle financing

1.2 Data Analysis Techniques

This chapter presents the analysis and interpretation of the empirical data collected from respondents. The main objective is to identify patterns in borrowing behavior, loan repayment practices, and financial management of borrowers, and to understand the impact of car loan management practices on financial performance and risk management.

Data Analysis & Interpretation

This chapter presents the analysis and interpretation of the empirical data collected from respondents. The main objective is to identify patterns in awareness, effectiveness, and implementation of internal control systems, and to understand their contribution toward financial transparency and fraud prevention in organizations.

1.1 Car Loan Management and Financial Performance of Borrowers

Response	Frequency	Percentage
Strongly Agree	12	60%
Agree	5	25%
Neutral	2	10%
Disagree	1	5%
Strongly Disagree	0	0%

Table: 1

Figure 1 : Pie Chart Showing Skepticism Responses

Interpretation: A total of **85% (Strongly Agree + Agree)** of respondents believe

Response	Frequency	Percentage
Yes	17	85%
No	3	15%

Table: 3

that effective car loan management practices positively influence borrowers' financial performance. This indicates that proper loan planning, structured repayment schedules, and manageable interest rates help borrowers maintain financial stability. The small percentage of neutral and disagree responses suggests that some borrowers may face challenges due to income constraints or poor financial planning.

Additional note: Respondents with financial knowledge, such as finance managers and bank professionals, showed stronger agreement, indicating that awareness and financial literacy play an important role in managing loans effectively.

1.1 Car Loan Management Practices and Risk Management

Response	Frequency	Percentage
Strongly Agree	10	50%
Agree	6	30%
Neutral	2	10%
Disagree	2	10%
Strongly Disagree	0	0%

Table: 2

Figure 2: Car loan V/S Risk management

Interpretation: A majority of **80% (Strongly Agree + Agree)** respondents believe that effective car loan management practices help in better risk management. This suggests that proper loan evaluation, repayment tracking, and financial discipline reduce the chances of default and financial stress. However, 10% disagreement indicates that some borrowers still face difficulties in managing financial risk due to factors such as high interest rates or unstable income.

Additional note: The minority who disagreed cited constraints like resource costs and limited access to specialised software as barriers to effectiveness.

1.1 Necessity of Proper Loan Management Awareness for Borrowers

Figure 3: Pie Chart Showing Awareness Necessity for Borrowers

Interpretation: A clear majority of respondents (85%) believe that proper awareness and understanding of car loan management practices are essential for

borrowers. This indicates that lack of financial knowledge can lead to poor repayment decisions, increased financial burden, and higher risk of default. The results highlight the importance of educating borrowers about loan terms, interest rates, and repayment planning.

Additional note: Student respondents and borrowers showed strong interest in financial literacy programs and practical guidance on loan management. This suggests that integrating financial education into academic curricula and awareness programs can significantly improve borrowers' financial performance and risk management.

1.2 Use of Car Loan Management Practices by Borrowers

Response	Frequency	Percentage
Frequently	3	15%
Occasionally	8	40%
Rarely	6	30%
Never	3	15%

Table: 4

Figure 4: Pie Chart Showing Use of Loan Management Practices

Interpretation: Forensic methods are used more often on an ad-hoc or exception basis rather than as routine procedures. This indicates a reactive rather than proactive implementation

approach. Organizations often deploy forensic techniques only when suspicion arises or when

regulatory scrutiny demands it.

Additional note: This pattern points to an opportunity to integrate targeted forensic checks into the audit planning phase for high-risk areas.

5.2 Perceived Barriers to Forensic Adoption

- Lack of financial awareness – **75%**
- High interest rates – **60%**
- Irregular income or financial instability – **55%**
- Complex loan procedures – **40%**

Interpretation: The most significant barrier identified is lack of financial awareness among borrowers, followed by high interest rates and unstable income.

These factors increase the financial burden and risk of default. The findings suggest that improving financial literacy, simplifying loan procedures, and offering flexible repayment options can enhance loan management

Conclusion:

This empirical study supports the view that effective car loan management practices play a significant role in improving borrowers' financial performance and managing financial risk. The majority of respondents (around 85%) indicated that proper loan management—such as planned repayment schedules and awareness of loan terms—helps maintain financial stability. Additionally, about 80% of respondents agreed that structured loan management practices reduce the risk of default and financial stress.

However, the study also highlights certain challenges. Many borrowers follow loan management practices only occasionally, indicating a reactive rather than proactive approach to financial planning. Furthermore, key barriers such as lack of financial awareness, high interest rates, and income instability limit the effective management of car loans.

The implications of the study are threefold. First, financial institutions should focus on improving borrower awareness through financial literacy programs and clear communication of loan terms. Second, flexible repayment options and better loan structuring should be introduced to reduce financial burden on borrowers. Third, academic institutions and professional bodies should include practical financial management education in their curriculum to prepare individuals for responsible borrowing.

In conclusion, effective car loan management practices are essential for enhancing borrowers' financial discipline, reducing financial risk, and ensuring long-term financial stability. With proper awareness, planning, and institutional support, borrowers can significantly improve their financial performance while minimizing the risks associated with loan obligations.

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Impact of Digital Platform on Customer

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Abstract: -

People's lives and society have changed significantly as a result of the digital economy. Numerous studies have examined the influence of digital platforms on development, but none have compiled the body of knowledge regarding the effects of digital platforms on consumers. We categorised previous research into three primary areas in this analysis and examined the ways in which digital platforms and technology support economic growth. To obtain a comprehensive perspective, we considered papers from the surrounding area that used survey research methods. For upcoming studies, this assisted us in comprehending how digital platforms affect consumers.

Objective: -

1. To comprehend how digital platforms affect consumer experiences and expectations, and the business ramifications
2. To understand how consumers' interactions with enterprises are altered by digital platforms.
3. Must understand the role those digital platforms play in establishing and preserving relationships with customers.
4. To understand how digital platforms strike a compromise between the requirement to preserve client privacy and the necessity for customer data.

Introduction: -

Digital platforms have completely changed how consumers communicate with companies, obtain services, and decide what to buy. Convenience, more options, and financial savings are provided by these platforms, which include social networking, smartphone applications, and e-commerce websites. Personalized experiences and smooth transactions are advantageous to customers. But there are issues, including a lack of face-to-face engagement, false information, and privacy threats. Users can make the most of these platforms in a number of ways, such as through digital banking, social media interaction, and online purchasing. Digital platforms offer a variety of functions, influencing contemporary consumer behavior from communication and education to buying and leisure. For proper use, it is necessary to comprehend both their benefits and risks.

This paper talks about how digital platforms, like Uber, Facebook, Instagram,

Twitter, Amazon, Meesho, Phone Pay, and Airbnb, are changing the economy and society. These platforms have become an important part of our daily lives, helping people find jobs, connect with others, and buy and sell products more easily.

Review of literature: -

1. The June 2016 publication of “**A Review Paper on E-Commerce,**” written by Shahid Amin Bhat, Keshav Kansana, and J.M. Khan, examines how electronic commerce has changed conventional business methods. The literature review examines e-commerce's evolution, highlighting the shift from traditional business models to digital platforms. It discusses factors influencing e-commerce growth, such as internet penetration, technological advancements, and changing consumer behaviors.
2. Xiaolan Fu, Ernest Avenyo, and Hang Yin's paper “**Digital platforms and development: a survey of the literature**” was released in 2021. Digital platforms improve inclusivity, create jobs, and add value to economies, but issues with regulation and job quality need more research. It categorizes existing research into three primary themes: value creation, job creation, and inclusion.
3. “**An Introduction to Online Platforms and their Role in the Digital Transformation**” was authored by Jeremy K. West of the Organisation for Economic Co-Operation and Development (OECD), Directorate for Science, Technology and Innovation. It was posted on SSRN on December 20, 2023. Jeremy K. West examines how online platforms influence daily activities and the broader digital economy. It includes detailed profiles of twelve leading platform companies, analysing their operations, economic characteristics, and factors contributing to their financial success

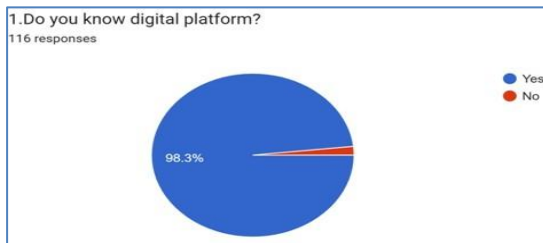
Limitations:

1. Data Privacy Issues: A lot of clients might not be completely aware of how their data is handled, which could cause bias in their answers.
2. Survey Response Bias: Respondents may give answers that are more socially acceptable than what they really think.
3. Rapid Technological Changes: Because digital platforms are always changing, research becomes dated very quickly.
4. Limited Sample Representation: Generalisability may be impacted by surveys that do not include all client demographics.
5. Regulatory Differences: Because many nations have different digital rules, it might be challenging to do a worldwide analysis.

Methodology: -

The survey methodology is an excellent means to evaluate the influence of digital platforms on customer data. It entails using online structured surveys to get information from a specific group of respondents. This approach aids in comprehending consumer attitudes, actions, and worries about personalization, data protection, and digital platform trust.

A Google form with a well-structured questionnaire is used to collect the data, utilizing the survey approach. For the purpose of gathering data, several websites and digital resources are also consulted.



based on 116 responses, Figure 1 shows that a significant majority, 92.3%, answered “Yes,” while only 7.7% answered “No,”.

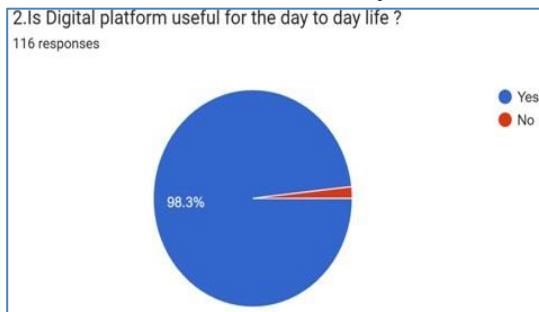
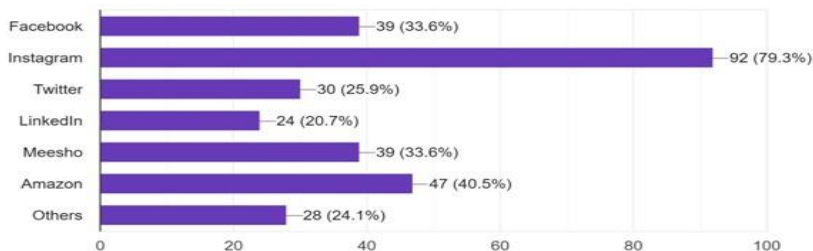


Figure 2 indicate that 98.3% of respondents believe that digital platforms are useful for day-to-day life. Only 1.7% of respondents indicated that they do not find digital

3. Which online social media platforms do you use?

116 responses

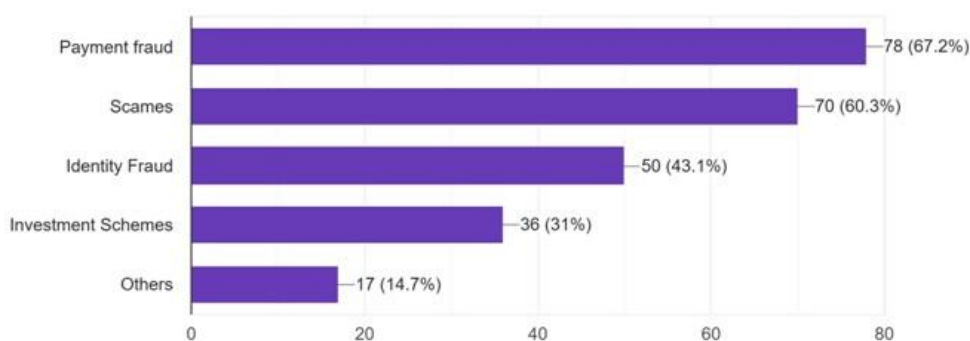


platforms useful. In Figure 3, it is stated that the online social media platforms used by 116 respondents are:- **Instagram:-92 (79.3%), Amazon:-47 (40.5%), Facebook:-39 (33.6%), Meesho:-39 (33.6%), Twitter:-30 (25.9%), Others:-28 (24.1%),**

LinkedIn:-24 (20.7%)

4. What types of frauds are possible on digital platform?

116 responses



6. Are digital platforms useful for the different industries?

116 responses

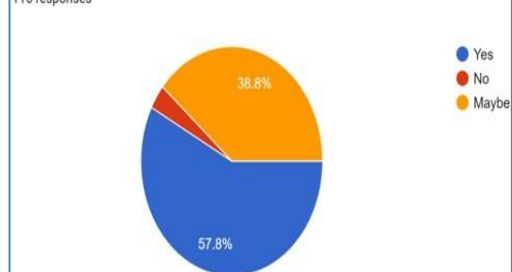


Figure 4 indicates possible fraud on digital platforms:

Payment fraud is the most prevalent, affecting 78 respondents (67.2%).

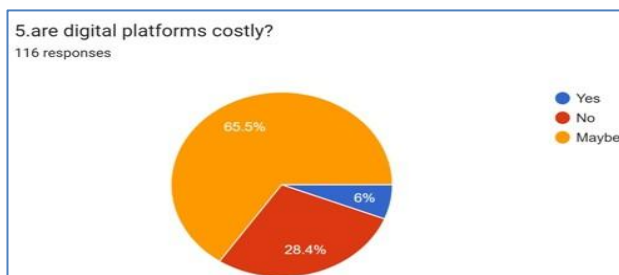
Scams are also significant, impacting 70 respondents (60.3%).

Identity fraud: affects 50 respondents (43.1%).

Investment schemes have impacted 36 respondents (31%).

Other: types of fraud account for 17 respondents (14.7%).

It is important to exercise caution and be aware of these potential risks while using digital platforms.



In Figure 5 shows that:-

65.5%: of respondents believe digital platforms are costly. 28.4% of respondents do not believe digital platforms are costly. 6% of respondents are unsure if digital platforms are costly.

This data suggests that a majority of respondents perceive digital platforms as expensive, while a notable percentage disagrees. A small fraction remains undecided.

Figure 6 reflects that, according to a survey of 116 responses, the usefulness of digital platforms across different industries is perceived as follows:

Yes:-57.8%, Maybe:-38.8%, No:-3.4%

This indicates that a majority of respondents believe digital platforms are useful for various industries, with a significant portion remaining uncertain. Only a small percentage find them not useful.

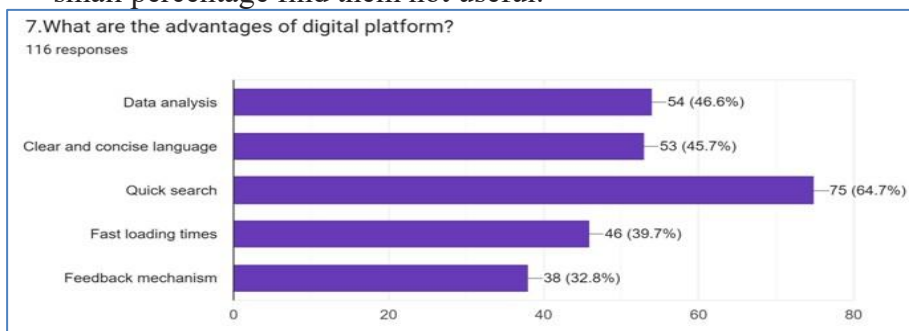
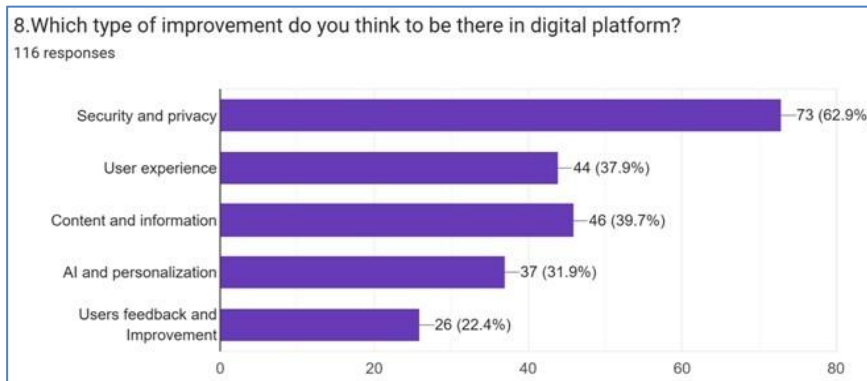


Figure 7 indicates that Digital platforms offer numerous benefits, such as increased productivity, accelerated growth, optimized finances, and improved decision-making



According to a survey with 116 responses, 62.9% of respondents believe that security and privacy are the types of improvements needed in digital platforms.

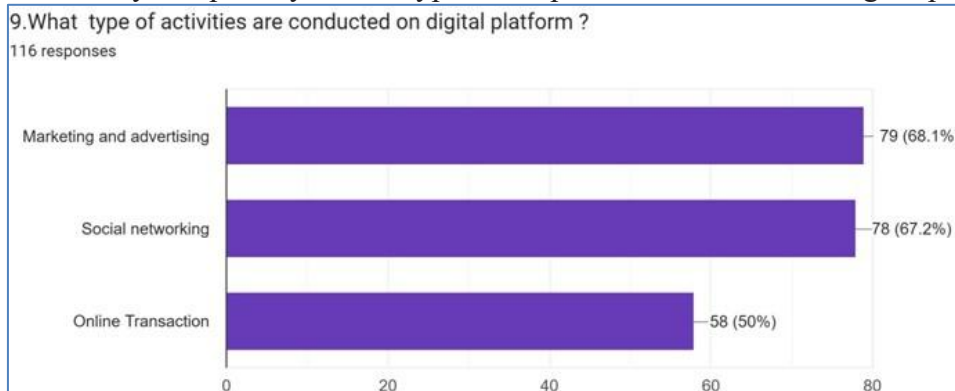


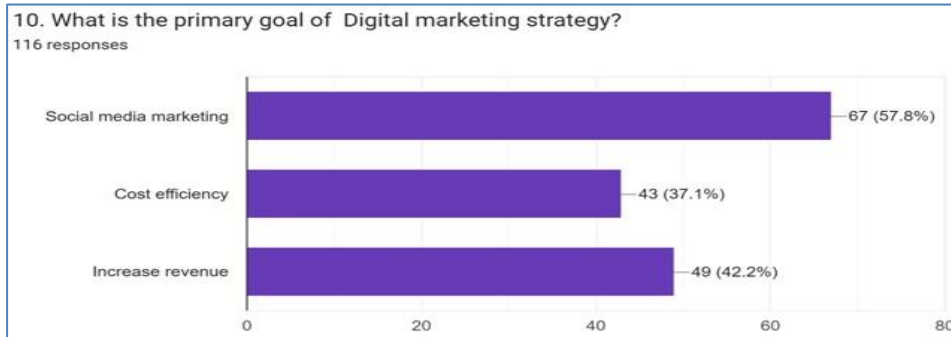
Figure 9 states that every type of activity is conducted on digital platforms. Based on the survey results depicted in the image, the types of activities conducted on digital platforms are:

Marketing and advertising: -79 responses (68.1%)

Social networking: -78 responses (67.2%)

Online transactions: -58 responses (50%)

Figure 10 states that while social media marketing is the most frequently cited goal, increasing revenue and improving goal efficiency are also significant objectives for



digital marketing strategies.

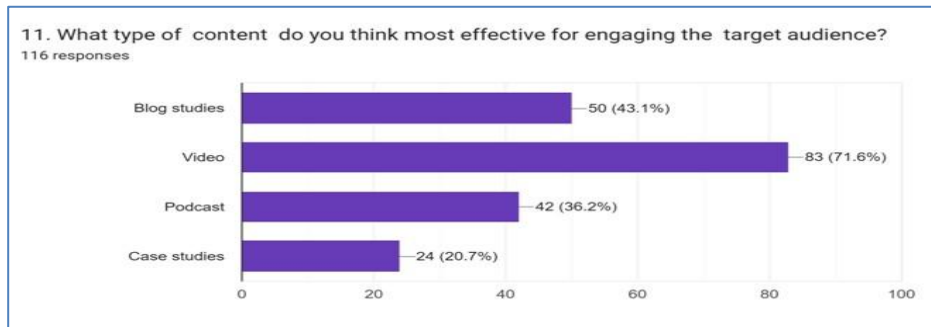


Figure 11 indicates that the survey results indicate that video content is considered the most effective for engaging the target audience, with 83 out of 116 respondents (71.6%) selecting it.

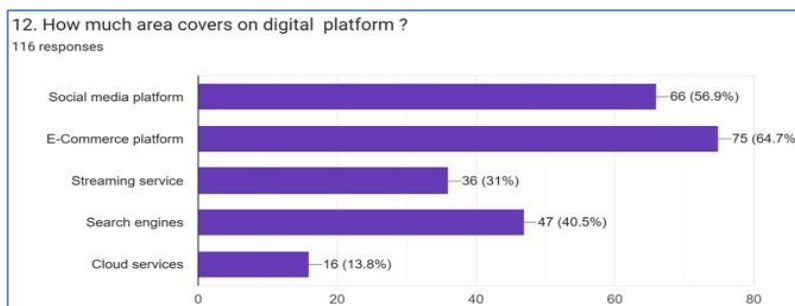


Figure 12 indicates that:

The areas covered on digital platforms, based on the provided data, are:

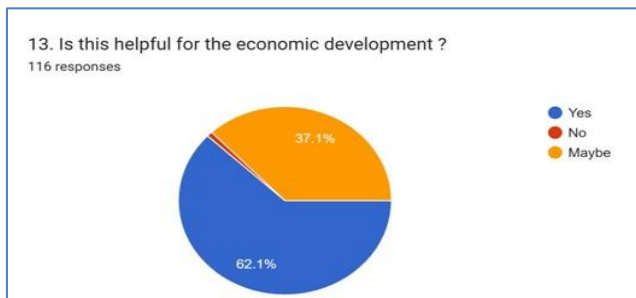
Social media platform: -88 responses (31.5%)

E-commerce platform: -75 responses (26.7%)

Streaming service: -30 responses (21.4%)

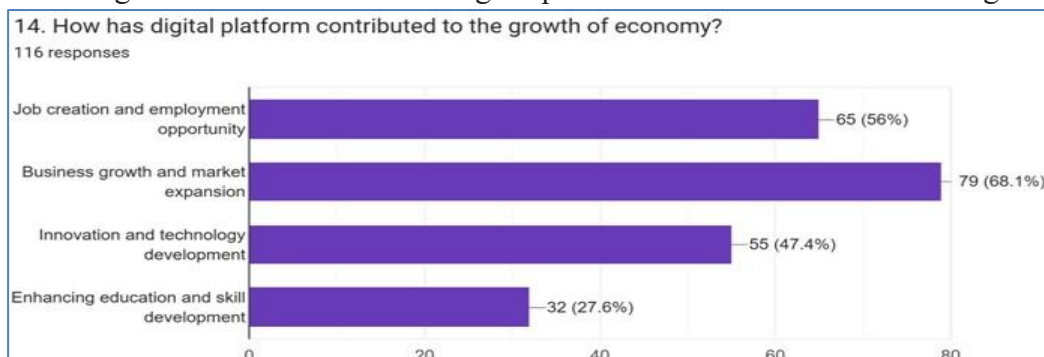
Search engine: -47 responses (16.8%)

Cloud services: -18 responses (6.4%)



Based on a survey with 116 responses, 62.7% of respondents believe that the subject in question is helpful for economic development, while 22% think it is not, and 15.3% are unsure.

Figure 14 indicates that the digital platform contributed to economic growth by



increasing productivity, reducing operational costs, creating jobs, and expanding market reach. India's digital economy accounted for 11.74% of its GDP in 2022-23 and is projected to reach 20% by 2030

From the standpoint of the consumer, digital platforms offer accessibility, speed, and convenience. They save time and effort by enabling users to purchase, pay, and access services at any time and from any location. Consumers are able to do product research, evaluate costs, and make well-informed decisions. By providing individualised experiences through customised ads and recommendations, these platforms increase customer pleasure. Social

networking sites make it simpler to keep in touch by facilitating international contact and community development. In order to keep users informed, digital platforms also offer entertainment, education, and real-time information. The efficiency and security of financial transactions are improved by online banking and electronic payment systems. Digital platforms also foster corporate expansion, increase economic development, and generate employment prospects. Digital platforms have revolutionised modern life by making daily tasks quicker, simpler, and more effective due to their affordability and capacity to streamline tasks.

Suggestion for Enhancing the User Experience on Digital Platforms: - Businesses must prioritise a user-friendly interface with simple navigation, quick loading times, and an intuitive layout in order to improve the overall consumer experience. AI-powered personalised recommendations can increase engagement by recommending pertinent goods and services. Trust is increased by fortifying security with secure payment methods and stringent data privacy regulations. A strong mechanism for collecting consumer feedback promotes reviews and facilitates prompt problem-solving. Smooth communication across websites, applications, and social media is ensured via omnichannel support. Customer retention is improved via loyalty programs that give special discounts, rewards, and customised promotions. Credibility is increased by having clear and open policies about terms, price, and refunds. Chatbots driven by AI offer round-the-clock customer service with timely responses. Customer relationships are strengthened by active social media interaction. Businesses can design a smooth and fulfilling client journey by combining these tactics.

Conclusion: -

According to the survey results, digital platforms improve business operations and customer experiences, which greatly boost economic development. Convenience, affordability, and access to a wider variety of goods and services are among the main benefits. Customer engagement and happiness are increased by features like safe transactions, AI-powered suggestions, and round-the-clock accessibility. Digital platforms also stimulate competition, entrepreneurship, and the creation of new opportunities, all of which contribute to economic growth. However, issues including service dependability, digital literacy gaps, and data security threats require addressing. to gain the trust of their customers, businesses must innovate and improve security measures. All things considered, digital platforms have transformed consumer relationships, provided a host of advantages, and created a more cohesive and effective economy. Ongoing enhancements will maximize their influence on consumers and the economy.

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The book Contemporary Research Perspectives in Commerce covers diverse areas such as accounting, finance, banking, marketing, entrepreneurship, digital business, human resource management, taxation, and other contemporary topics. The research papers included in this volume offer valuable insights and practical perspectives on current developments in business, taxation, banking, and marketing.

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